HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University

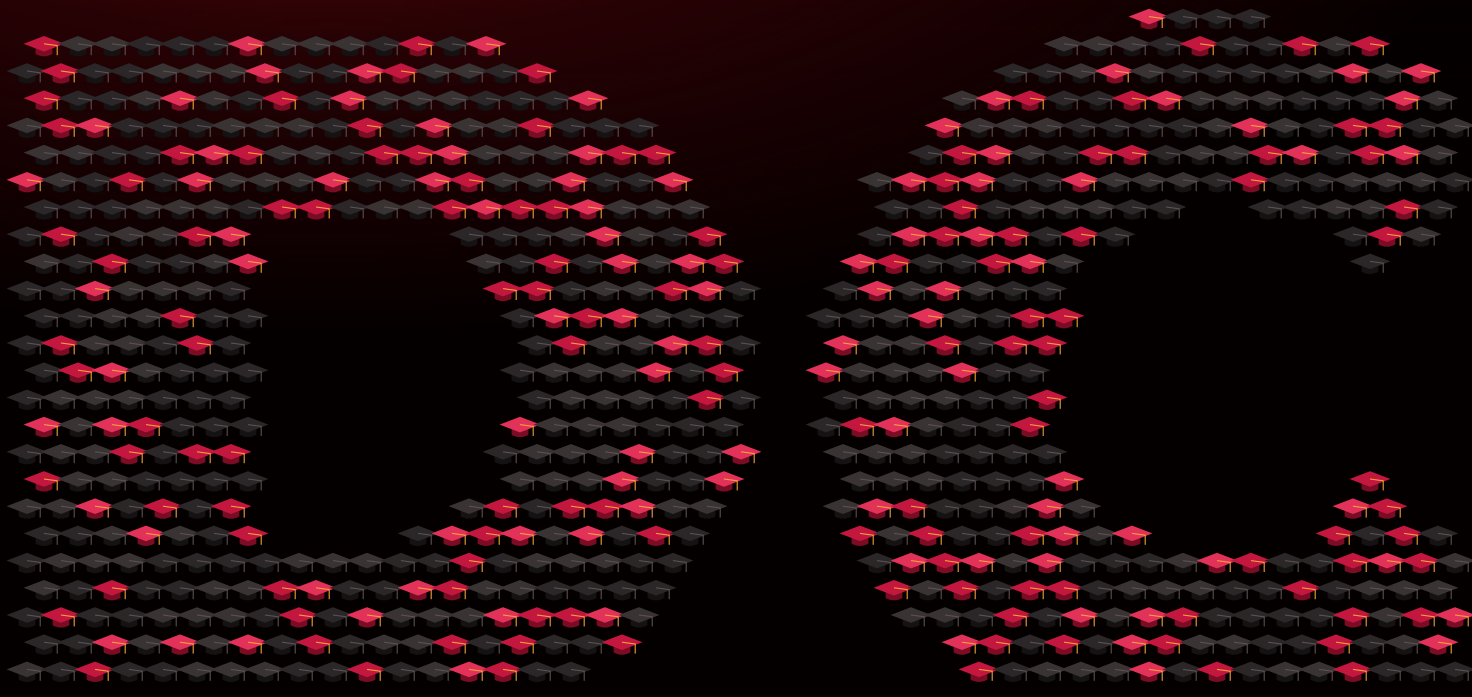
HAI Stanford University Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence

NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 District of Columbia Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **33 in every 100**, mark the international share of District of Columbia's STEM master's degrees.



This page intentionally left blank.

HOOVER INSTITUTION | Stanford University

Stanford University
Human-Centered
Artificial Intelligence

The 2026 District of Columbia Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

Table of Contents

OVERVIEW

At a Glance 6

SECTIONS

Section 1 International Dependence 8
Section 2 STEM Degrees 20
Section 3 Where Students Come From 26
Section 4 K-12 Preparation 34
Section 5 Graduate Research 36
Section 6 Do Graduates Stay? 38
Section 7 Research Funding 40
Section 8 H-1B Jobs and Green Cards 42
Section 9 STEM Workforce 46
Section 10 Patents 48
Section 11 Competitors 50
Section 12 Fields of Study 52
Section 13 Students and Money 62
Section 14 Student Outcomes 70
Section 15 Faculty 74
Section 16 Institutions 78

BACK MATTER

About these Data 82
By the Numbers 84
Sources 93

Authors

Emerson Victoria Johnston is a research assistant with the Hoover Institution's Technology Policy Accelerator. A Knight-Hennessy Scholar, she holds a master's in international policy from Stanford University, and is on leave from its master's program in the history of science, technology, environment, and medicine.

Dr. Amy Zegart is the Morris Arnold and Nona Jean Cox Senior Fellow at the Hoover Institution, director of Hoover's Technology Policy Accelerator, and a senior fellow and associate director at Stanford University's Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence.

Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to District of Columbia: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

How to Cite this Profile

Emerson V. Johnston and Amy Zegart, “The 2026 District of Columbia Talent Profile,” Technology Policy Accelerator, Hoover Institution, and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, November 2026.

Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 District of Columbia Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What District of Columbia's numbers say

1. **International students earn 33% of the District of Columbia's STEM master's degrees,** 19.3 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 38th of 51 on dependence. The share is 36% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 8.0% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **the District of Columbia awarded 656 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.6% of the U.S. total and 29th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +2%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in math & statistics,** where international students earned 75% of master's degrees (99 degrees; U.S. 55%). One STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates is majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** the District of Columbia ranks 2nd of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: the District of Columbia 33%, New Mexico 31%, Nevada 30%, Maine 8.8%, Rhode Island 47%.
5. **10% of the District of Columbia's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 5.3% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (9.14K) than residents left (2.79K), a net gain of 6.35K; the top destination for those leaving was Maryland.

33%

of the STEM master's degrees District of Columbia awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

100K #41
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · +6.9% since 2015

656 #29
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · +1.5% since 2015

33% #38
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · −3.2 pp since 2015

15% #22
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +1.0 pp since 2015

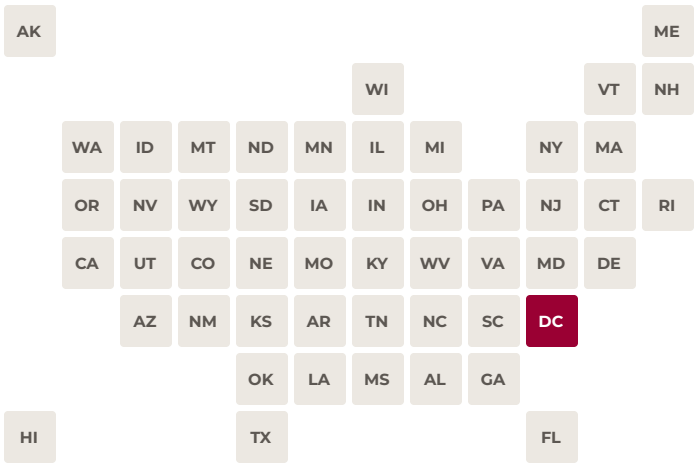
16% #51
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +2.9 pp since 2015

79% #1
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +2.9 pp since 2015

$44K #1
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +36% since 2015

10% #51
First-time students from in state, 2024
+1.7 pp since 2016

$132K #5
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −5.2% since 2016



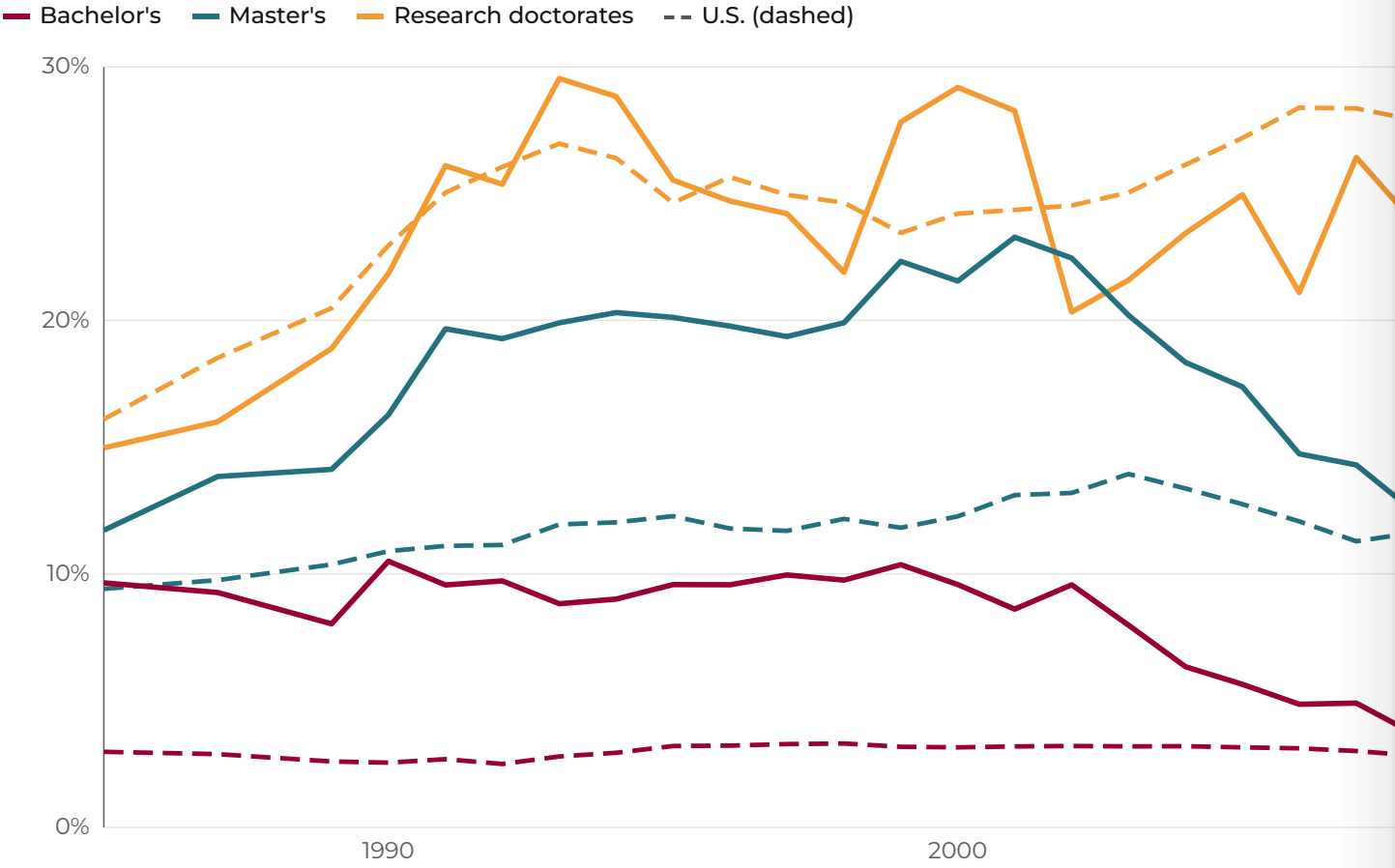
Badges give the District of Columbia's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

The District of Columbia ranks 38th of 51 on the international share of STEM master's, at 33% in 2025 against 52% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of the District of Columbia's Degrees Go to International Students

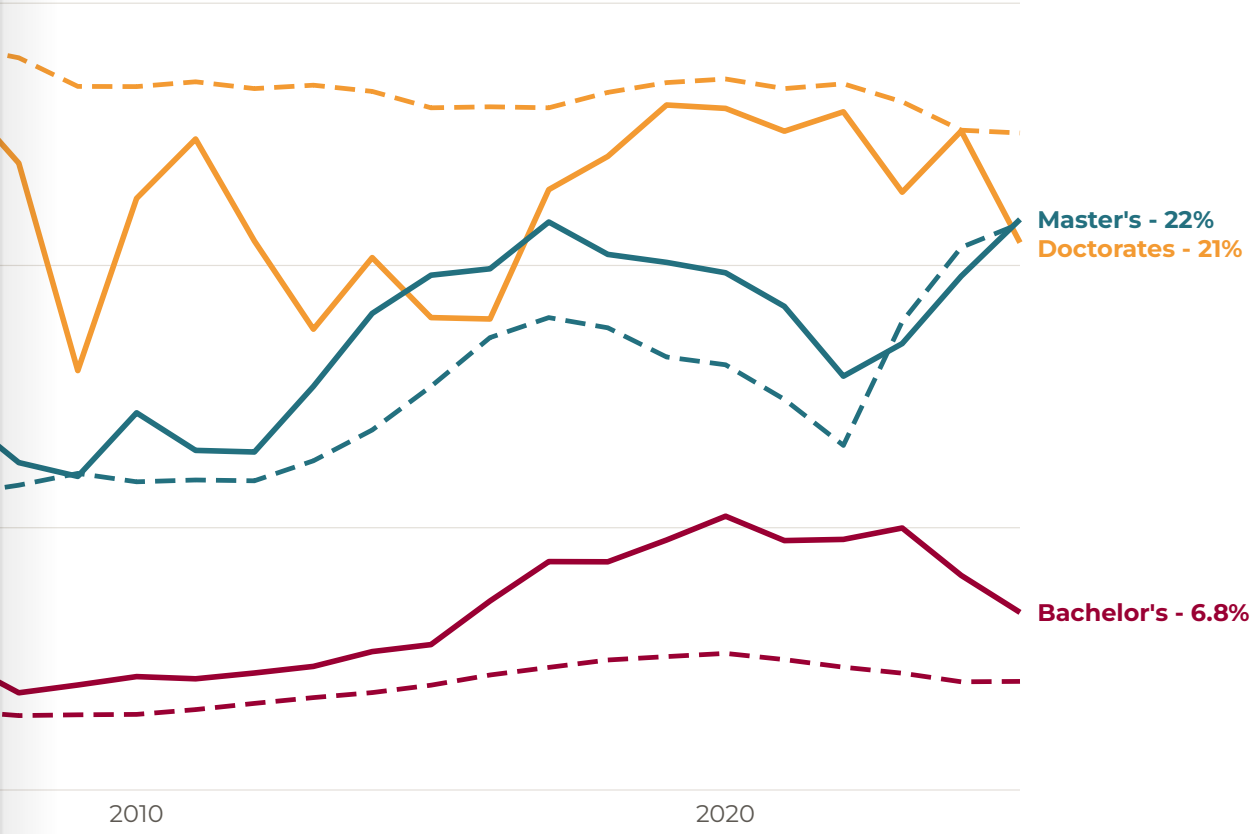


International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025

International students make up 15% of the District of Columbia's graduate enrollment and 5.6% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 6.8% of bachelor's, 22% of master's and 21% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 8.0% of STEM bachelor's, 33% of STEM master's and 36% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.6% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 29th of 51.

s?



5.

15%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **22nd** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

22%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

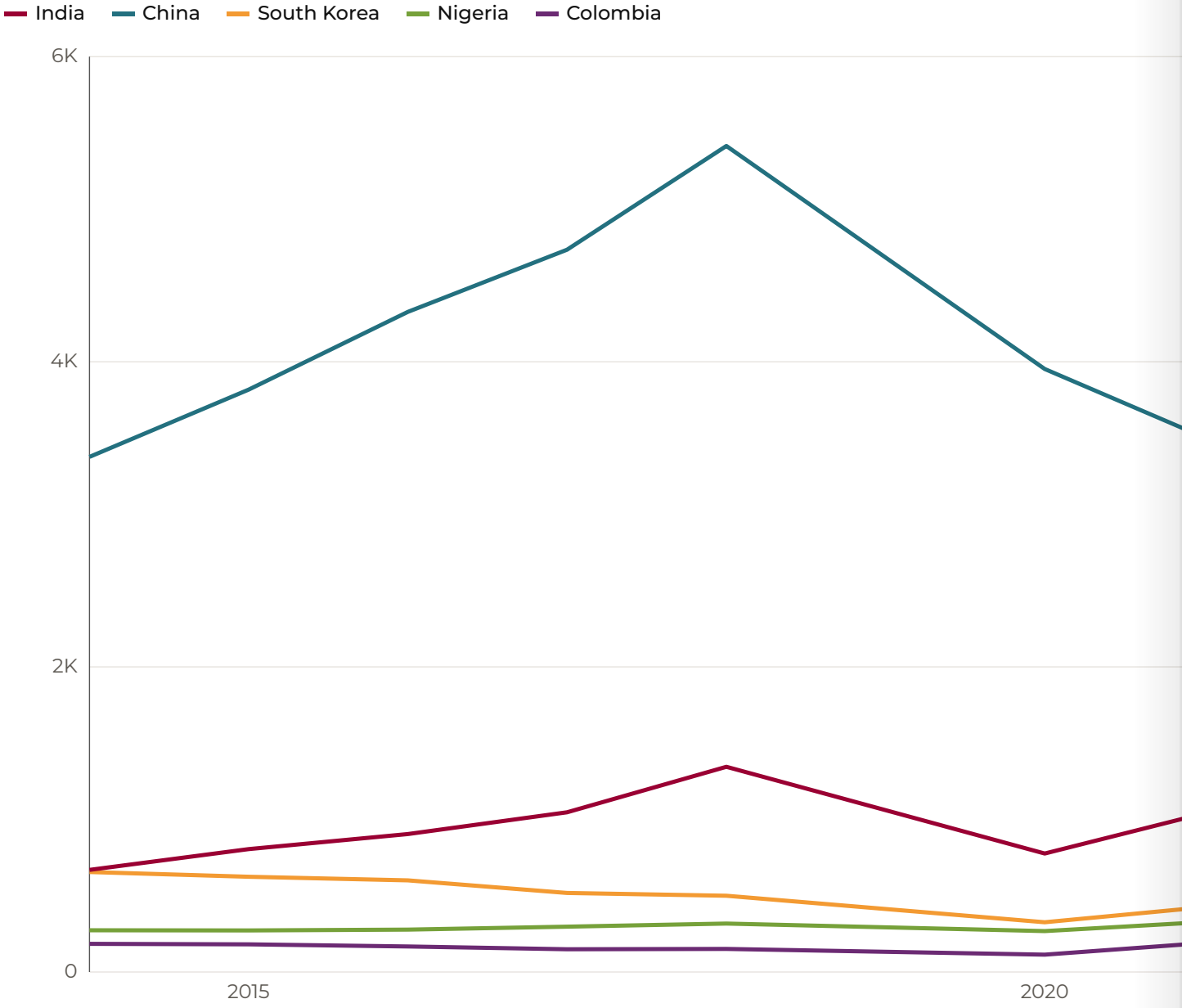
U.S. **22%** · **16th** of 51 · +2.1 pp since 2015

33%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **38th** of 51 · −3.2 pp since 2015

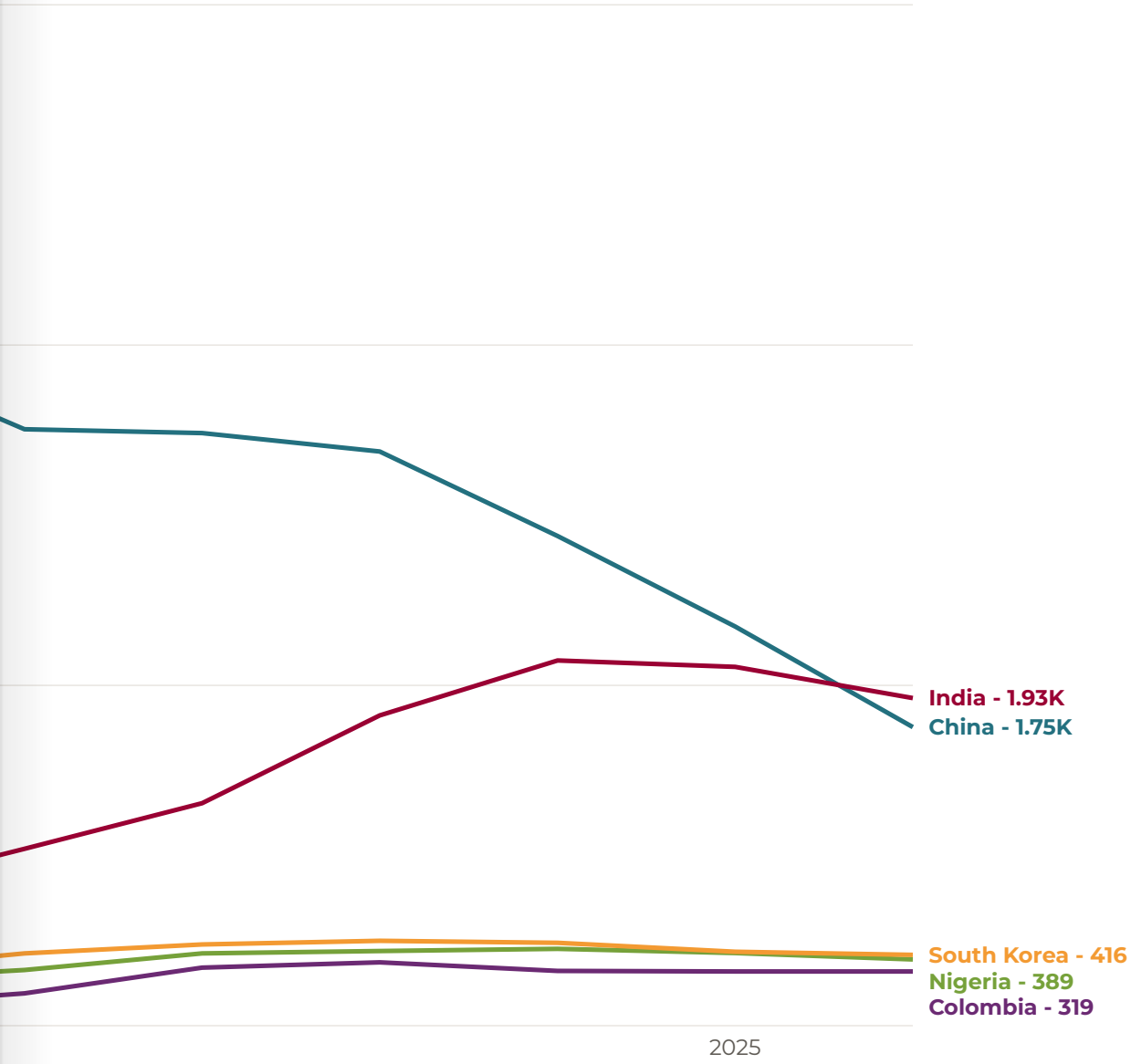
Figure 2 Where Do the District of Columbia's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the mor

In October 2026, the District of Columbia had 11.2K active international students in SEVIS, 25th of 51. India accounted for 17% of them and China for 16%, against 27% and 18% nationally.

Students came from 173 countries, but the two largest supplied 33%. The state's total is down 6% since 2015, when it stood at 12K.



nth closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

11.2K

Active international students, October 2026

25th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

17%

From India

U.S. **27%**

29%

In STEM fields

U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

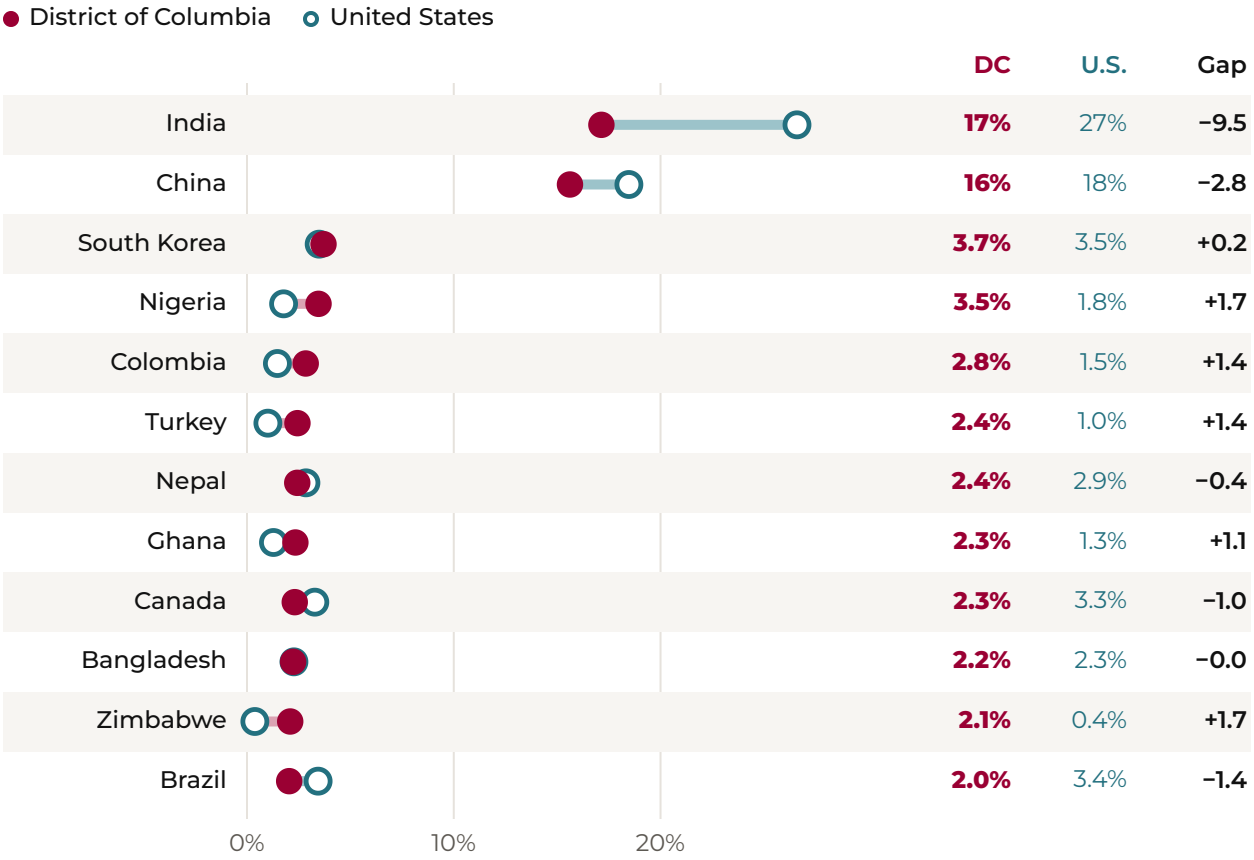
How Does the District of Columbia's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, the District of Columbia had **11.2K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 25th among the 50 states and DC and **0.9%** of the U.S. total. They came from 173 countries.

India supplied **17%** of them, against 27% nationally, and China **16%**, against 18%. South Korea (3.7%), Nigeria (3.5%), and Colombia (2.8%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **33%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 34th among the states, against 43% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is the District of Columbia's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

11.2K
Active international students, October 2026
25th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

17%
From India
U.S. **27%**

16%
From China
U.S. **18%**

173
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 8.4% from 2025 and down 6.4% since 2015, when it stood at 12K. Its share of all U.S. international students is down 0.1 points since 2015, to **0.9%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from India went from 805 to 1.93K, China's from 3.82K to 1.75K, and South Korea's from 624 to 416.

Over the same years, the number from Nigeria went from 272 to 389 and Colombia's from 181 to 319. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in the District of Columbia, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	12K	12.3K	**11.2K**	−6.4%	1.19M	25th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	1.0%	1.0%	**0.9%**	−0.1 pp	–	25th
Countries of citizenship represented	167	177	**173**	+3.6%	219	17th
Share from the two largest countries of origin	43%	36%	**33%**	−10.7 pp	45%	34th
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
India	805	2.11K	**1.93K**	+139%	27%	17%
China	3.82K	2.35K	**1.75K**	−54%	18%	16%
South Korea	624	434	**416**	−33%	3.5%	3.7%
Nigeria	272	427	**389**	+43%	1.8%	3.5%
Colombia	181	319	**319**	+76%	1.5%	2.8%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply the District of Columbia's International STEM Students?

3.24K of the District of Columbia's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **29%** of the total against 63% nationally, down 2.3% since 2015.

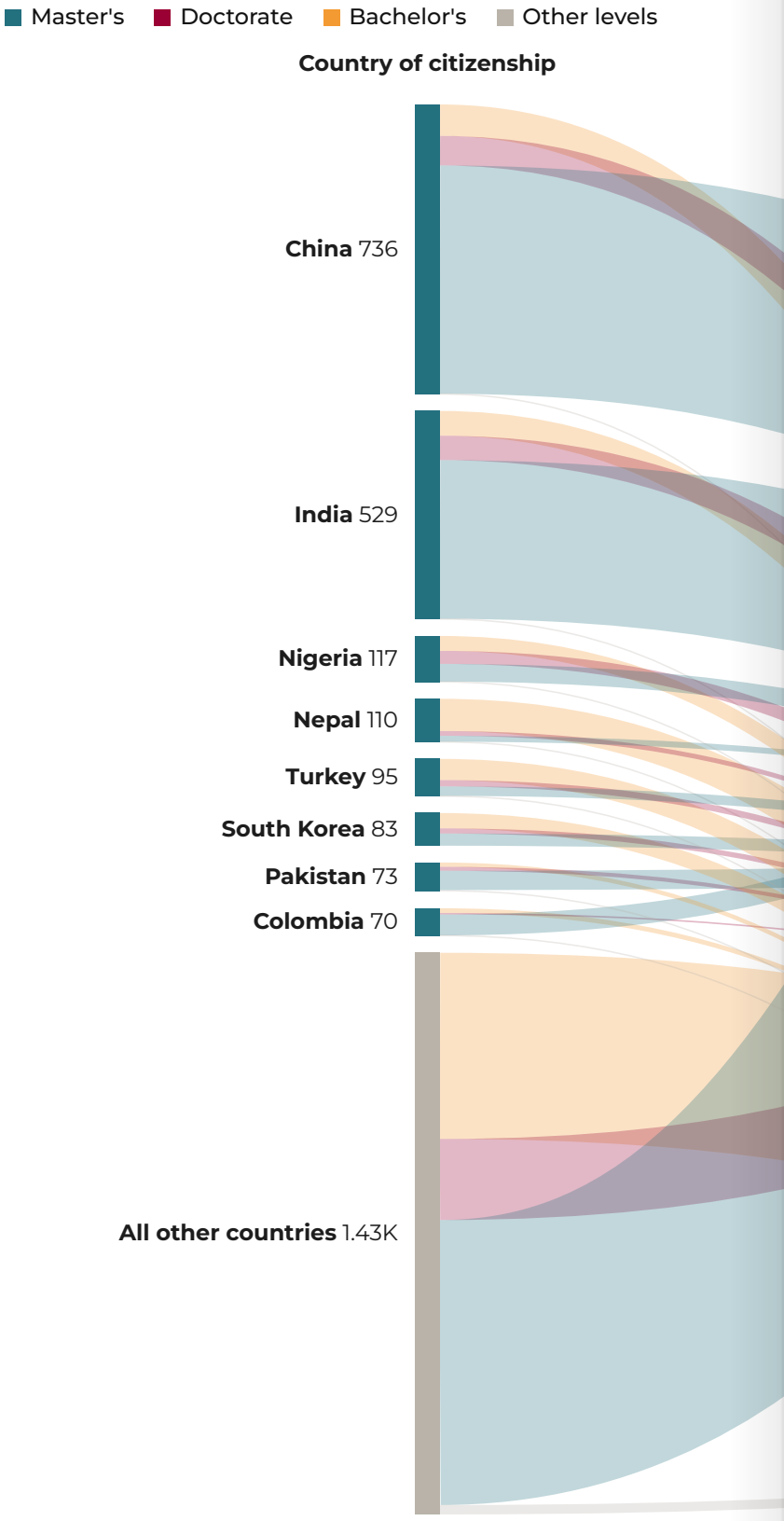
Master's students were the largest group, **1.92K**. China supplied 30% of them and India 21%.

STEM doctoral students went from 614 in 2015 to **431**, and STEM master's students from 1.97K to 1.92K.

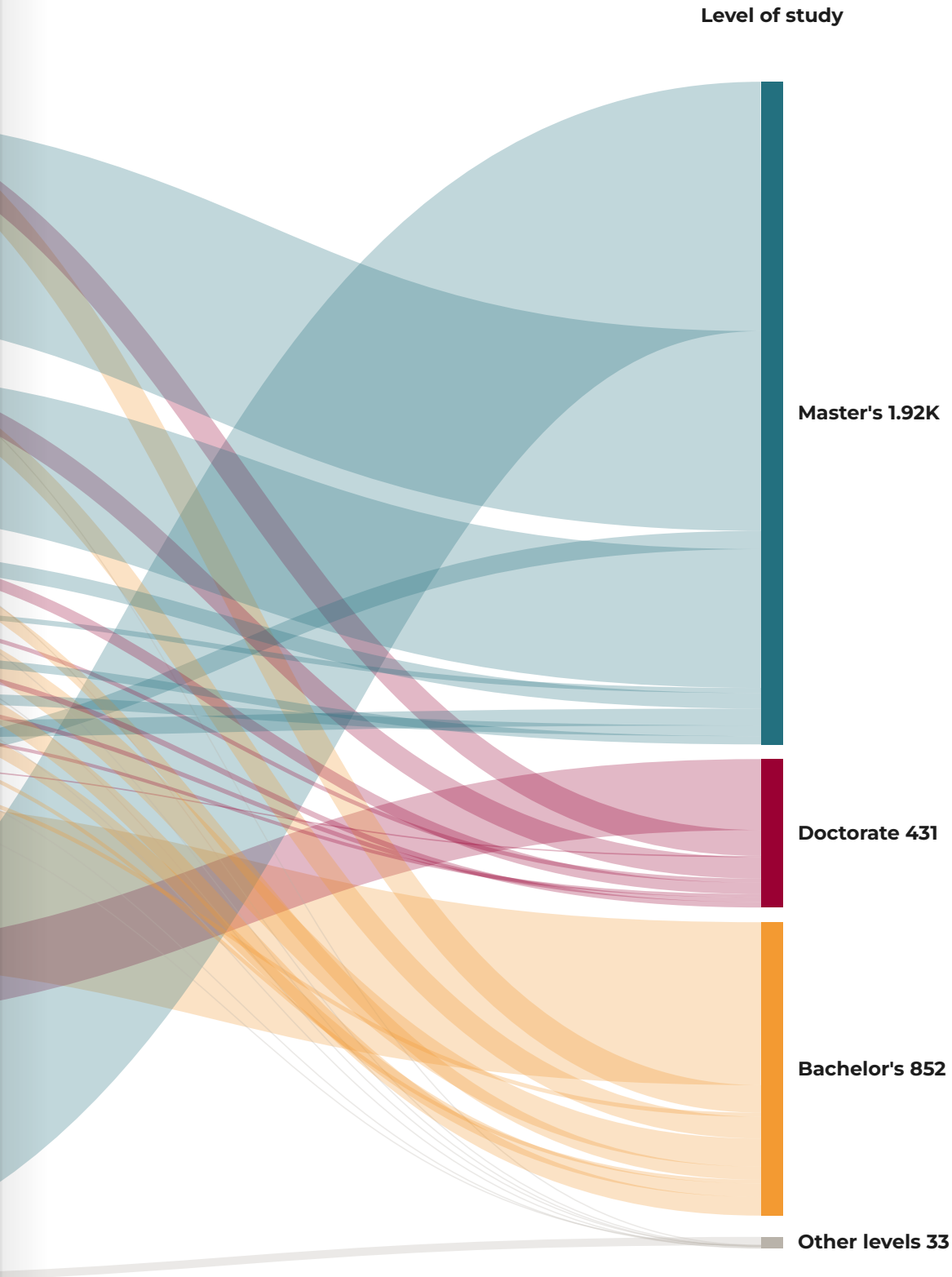
3.24K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **34th** of 51 · −2.3% since 2015

29%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

1.92K
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **27th** of 51 · −2.2% since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship an
2026.



d level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October

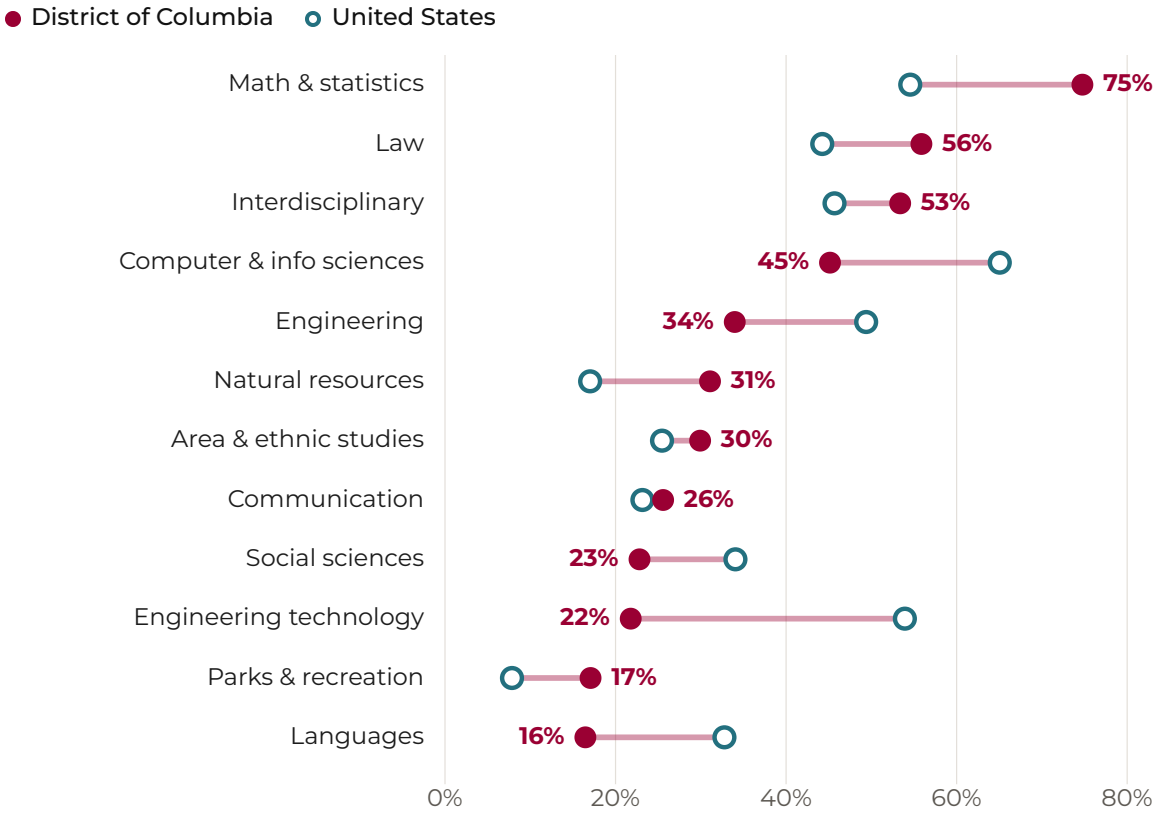
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are the District of Columbia's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in the District of Columbia in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in math & statistics (75%, against 55% for the U.S.), law (56%, against 44% for the U.S.), and interdisciplinary (53%, against 46% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

22%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **16th** of 51

33%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **38th** of 51

45%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **35th** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: the District of Columbia first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 75% of the master's degrees in math & statistics, against 55% for the U.S.

Fields with an international majority. International students earned more than half of the master's degrees in one STEM field.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	11% / 8.6%	**45% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	12% / 7.2%	**34% / 49%**	57% / 55%
Engineering technology	– / 4.5%	**22% / 54%**	2.3% / 42%
Math & statistics	12% / 17%	**75% / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	5.2% / 6.0%	**45% / 33%**	35% / 38%
Biological sciences	5.0% / 3.4%	**16% / 23%**	31% / 23%
Natural resources	1.2% / 2.0%	**31% / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	5.2% / 7.3%	**5.6% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in the District of Columbia / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

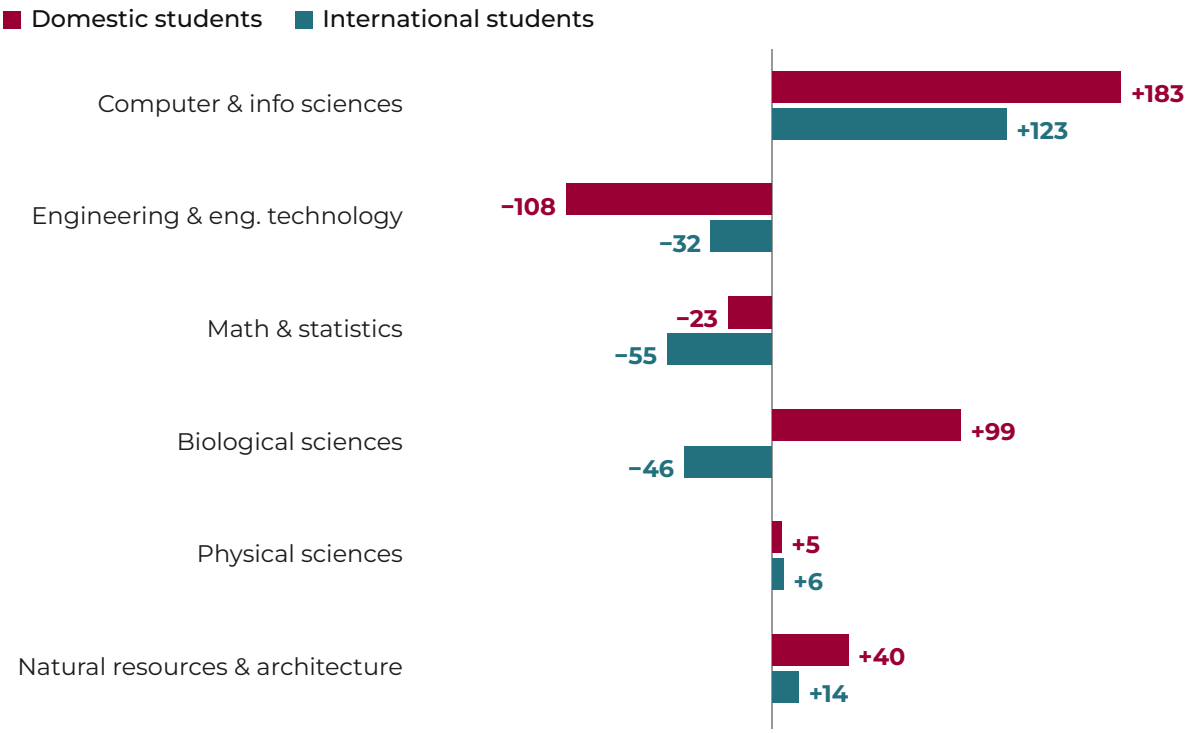
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has the District of Columbia's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in the District of Columbia between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 2K in 2025 and 1.79K in 2015, a change of +10 for international students and +196 for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

656
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **29th** of 51

17%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **37th** of 51

0.6%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
29th of 51

8.8
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **7th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in the District of Columbia in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 17% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 37th among the states, up 1.1 points from 16% in 2024 and up 1.0 point since 2015, when it was 16%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	416	**722**	+74%	326	49%	45%
Engineering & eng. technology	500	**360**	−28%	110	28%	31%
Math & statistics	177	**99**	−44%	74	73%	75%
Biological sciences	564	**617**	+9.4%	101	26%	16%
Physical sciences	27	**38**	–	17	–	45%
Natural resources & architecture	110	**164**	+49%	28	13%	17%

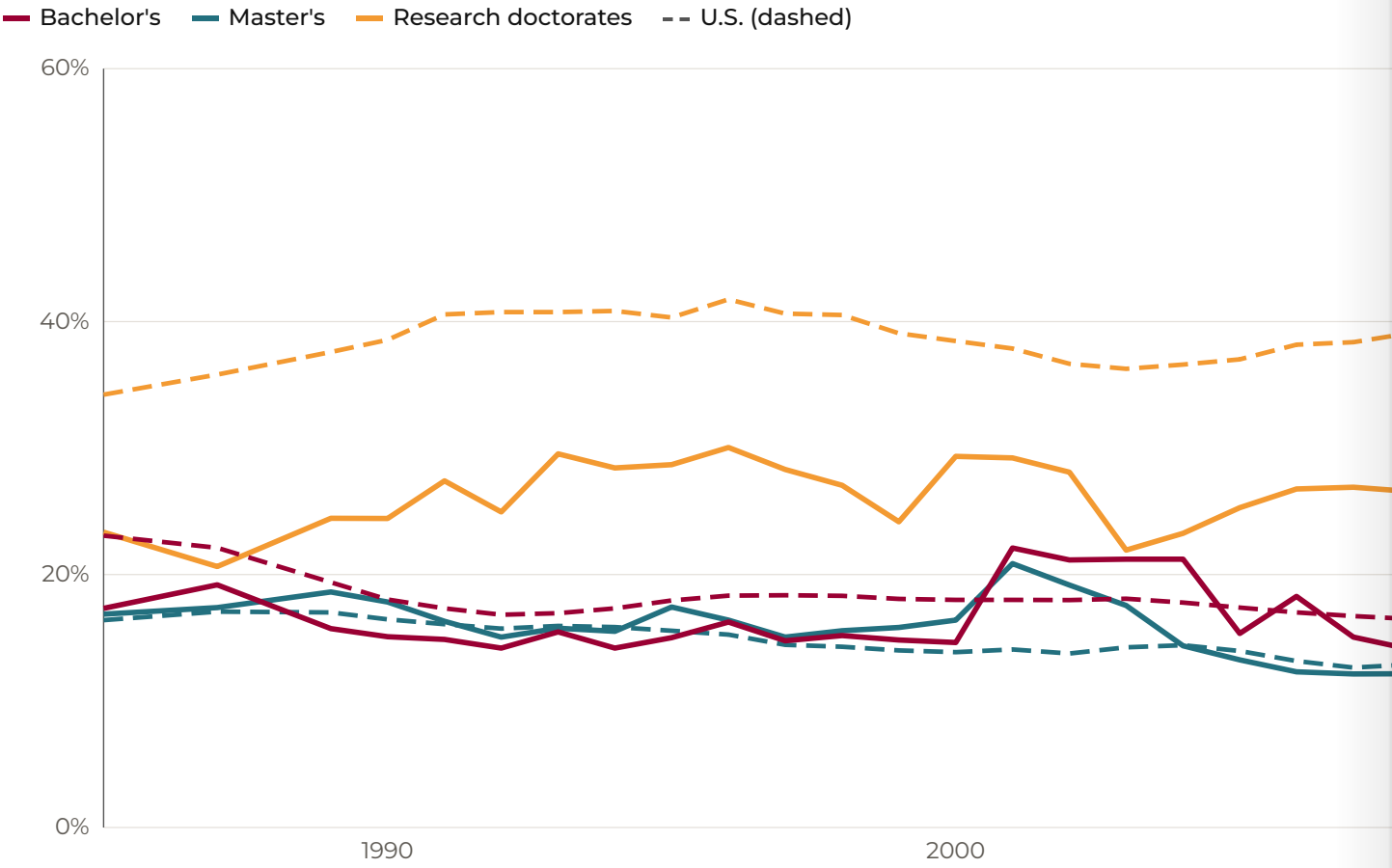
STEM master's degrees awarded in the District of Columbia, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

The District of Columbia ranks 51st of 51 on the STEM share of bachelor's, at 16% in 2025 against 24% for the U.S.

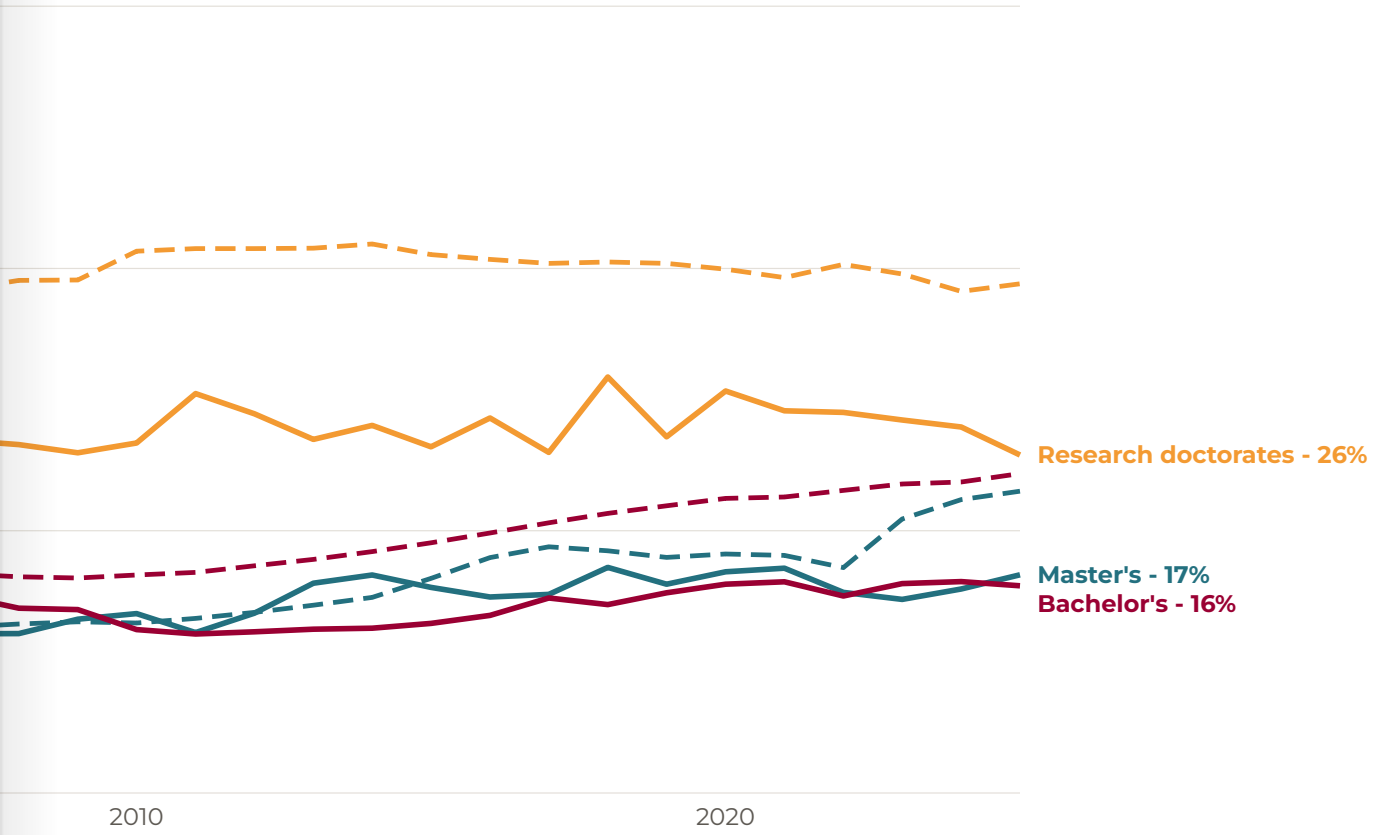
Figure 7 How Much of the District of Columbia's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 16% of the District of Columbia's bachelor's degrees, 17% of its master's and 26% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 1.0 points since 2015, and the state ranks 37th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 51st of 51.



16%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **51st** of 51 · +2.9 pp since 2015

17%

STEM share of master's, 2025

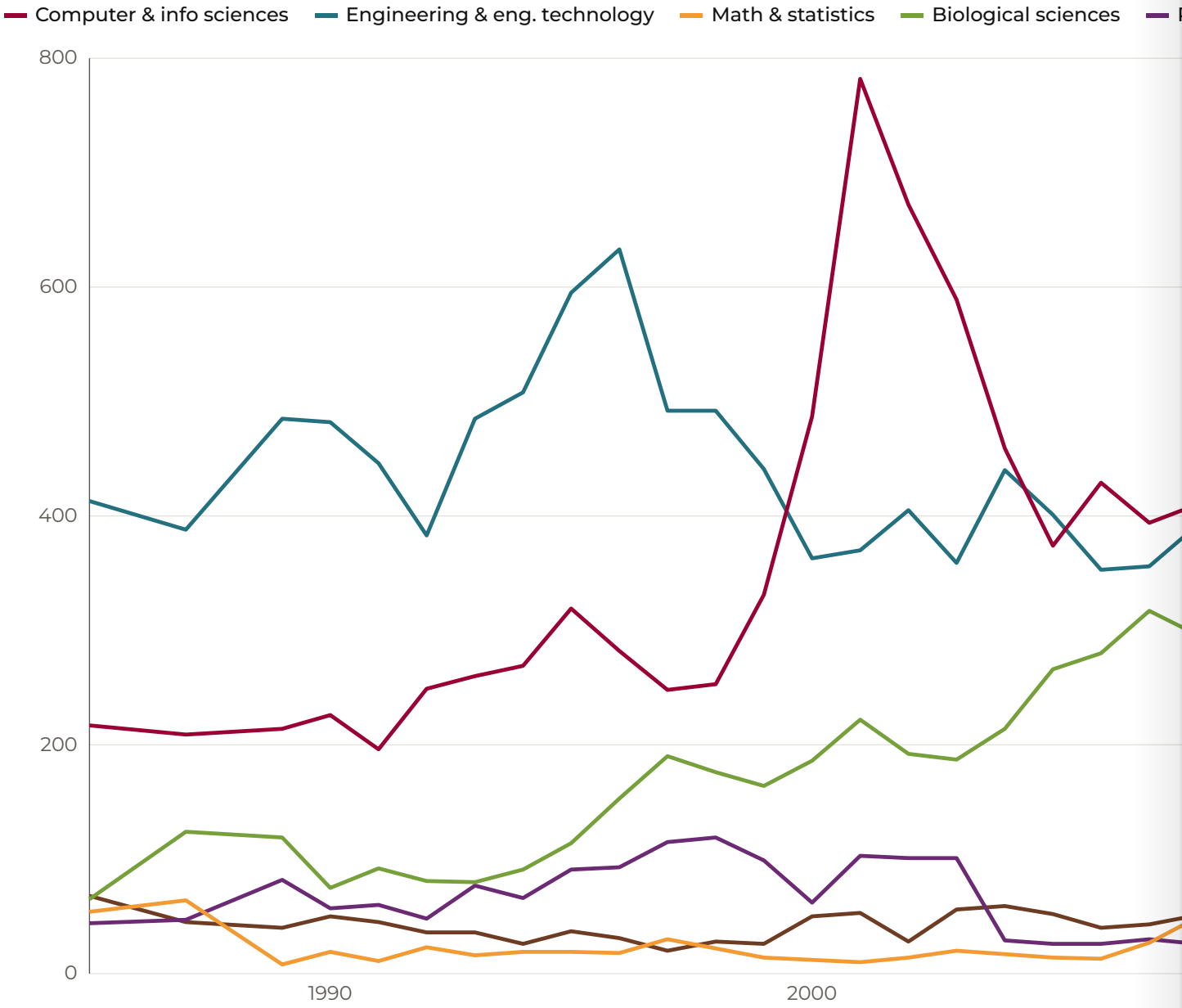
U.S. **23%** · **37th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

26%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **45th** of 51 · −0.6 pp since 2015

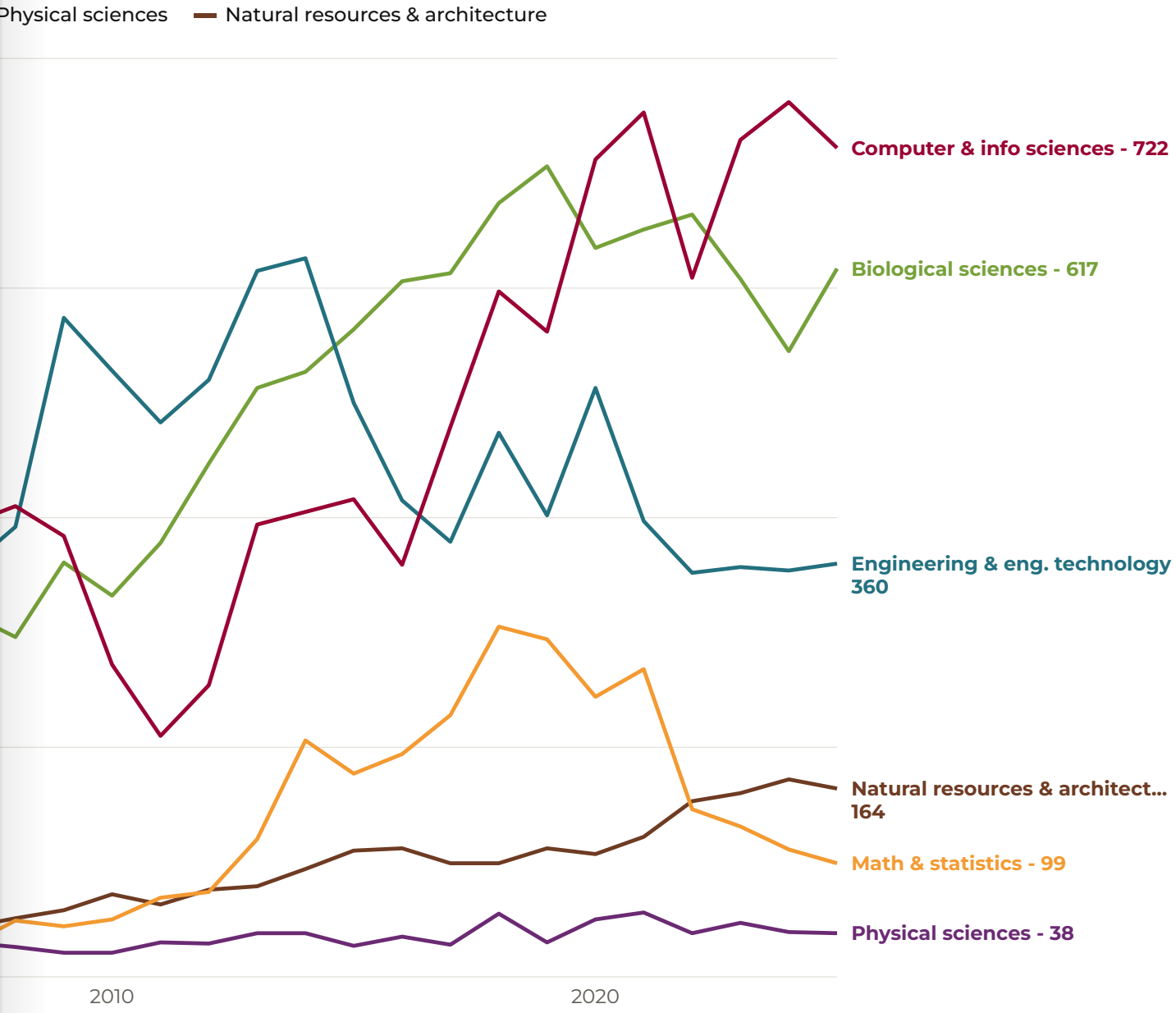
Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce the District of Columbia's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 722, followed by biological sciences (617) and engineering & eng. technology (360). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 74% since 2015.

International students earned 656 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.6% of the national total (29th of 51).



656

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **29th** of 51 · +1.5% since 2015

0.6%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

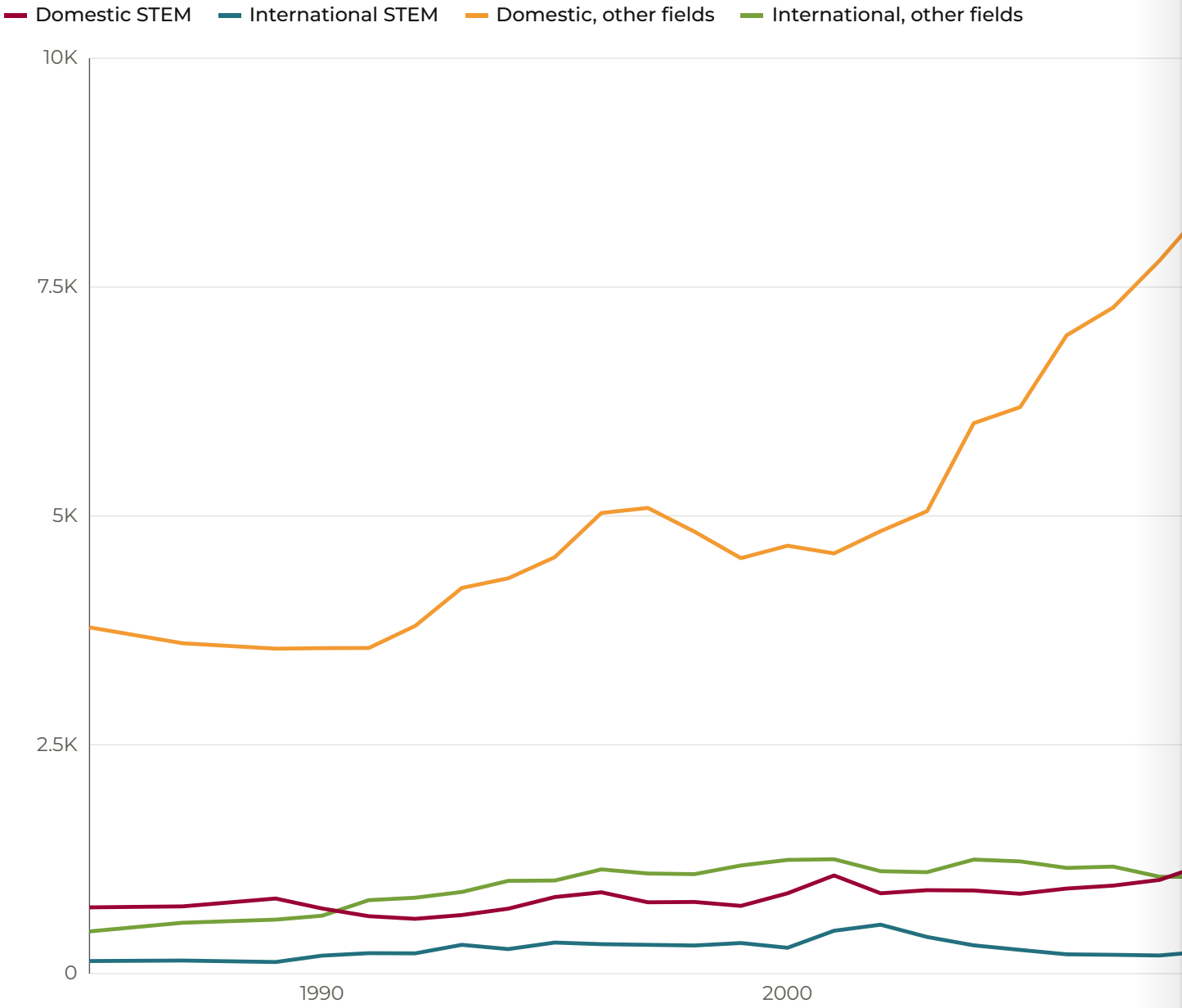
29th of 51 · −0.6 pp since 2015

45%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **35th** of 47 · −3.6 pp since 2015

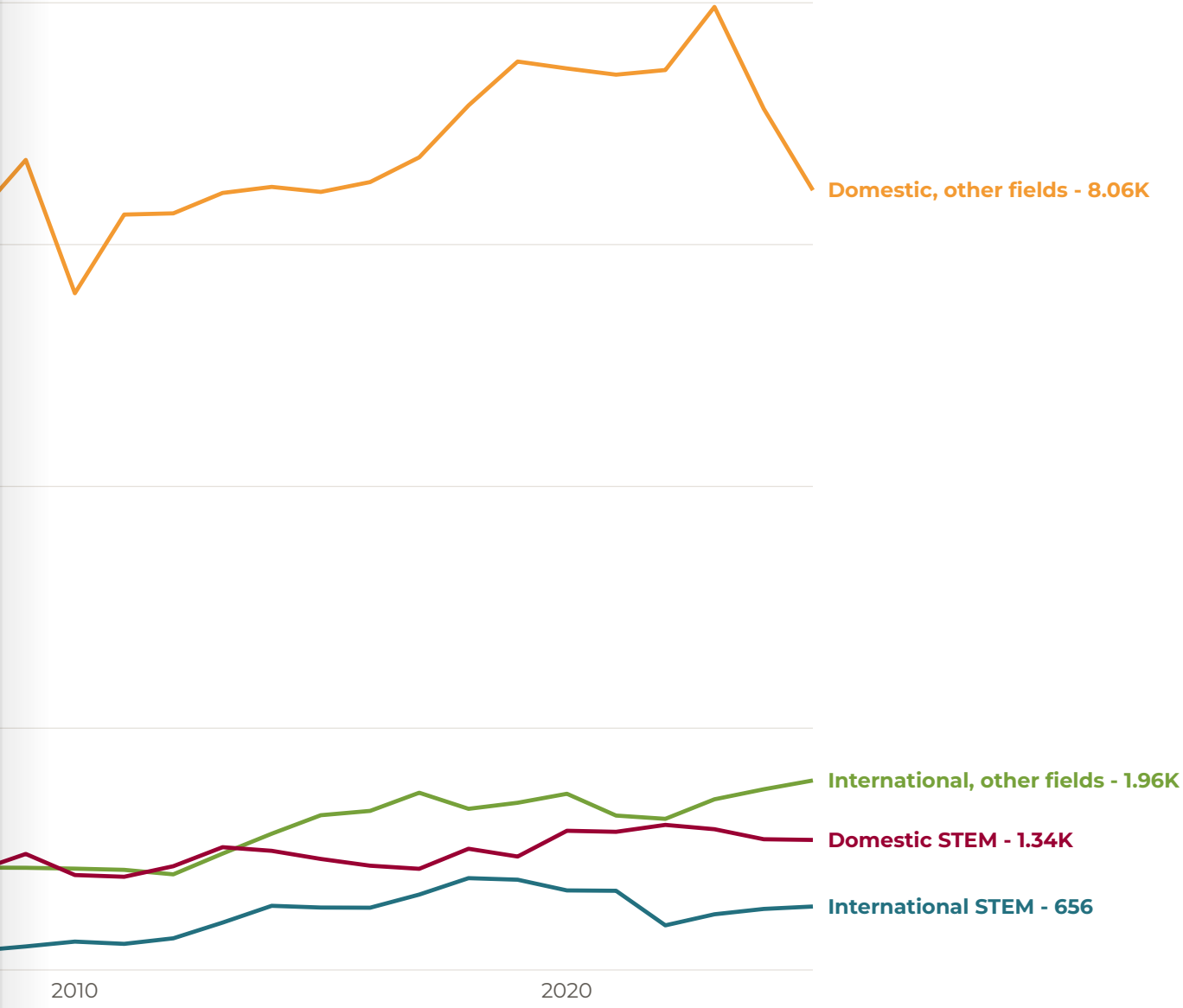
Figure 9 Who Earns the District of Columbia's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 10 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 196 more to domestic students.

International students earn 33% of the District of Columbia's STEM master's but 20% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).



22%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **16th** of 51 · +2.1 pp since 2015

33%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **38th** of 51 · −3.2 pp since 2015

8.8

STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025

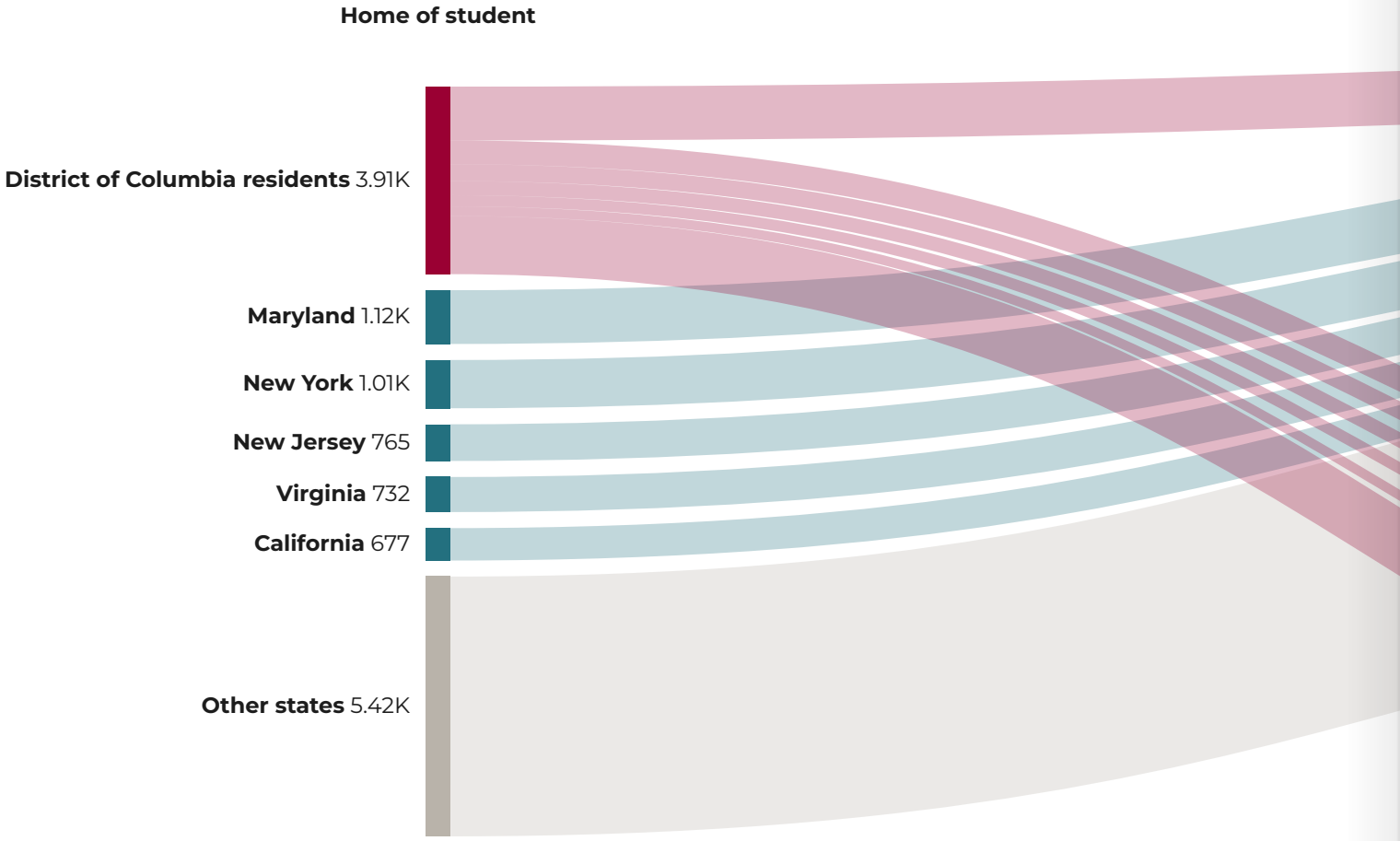
U.S. **6.4** · **7th** of 51 · −1.7 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

The District of Columbia ranks 51st of 51 on the share of first-time students who are in-state residents, at 10% in 2024.

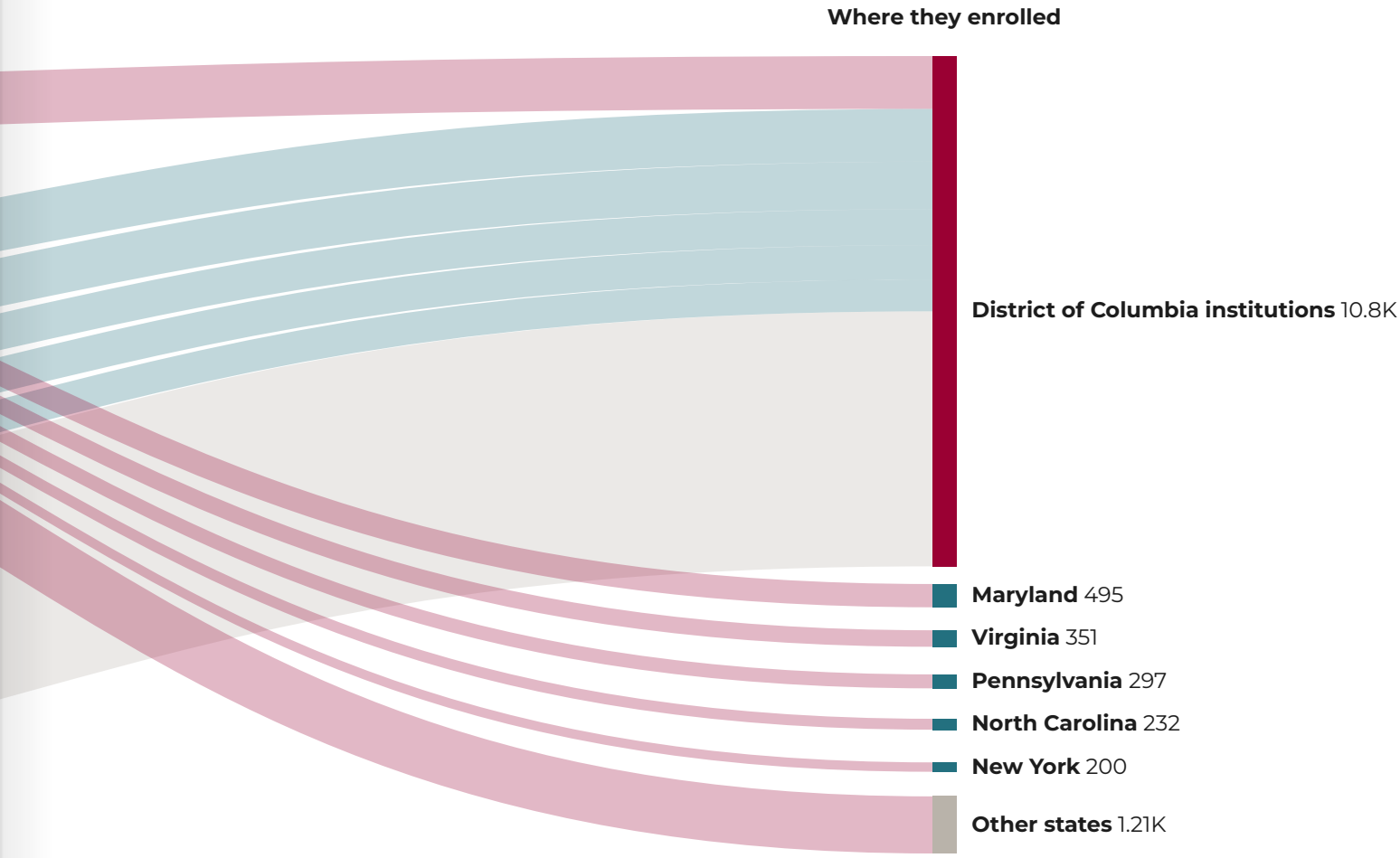
Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest s
Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

1.12K residents stayed in the District of Columbia for college in fall 2024; 9.14K students arrived from other states and 583 from abroad, while 2.79K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 10% of the state's first-time students are residents.



ources and destinations (more when states tie at the printed figure), the rest grouped; ties are ordered by exact count.

10%

First-time students from in state, 2024

51st of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2016

5.3%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

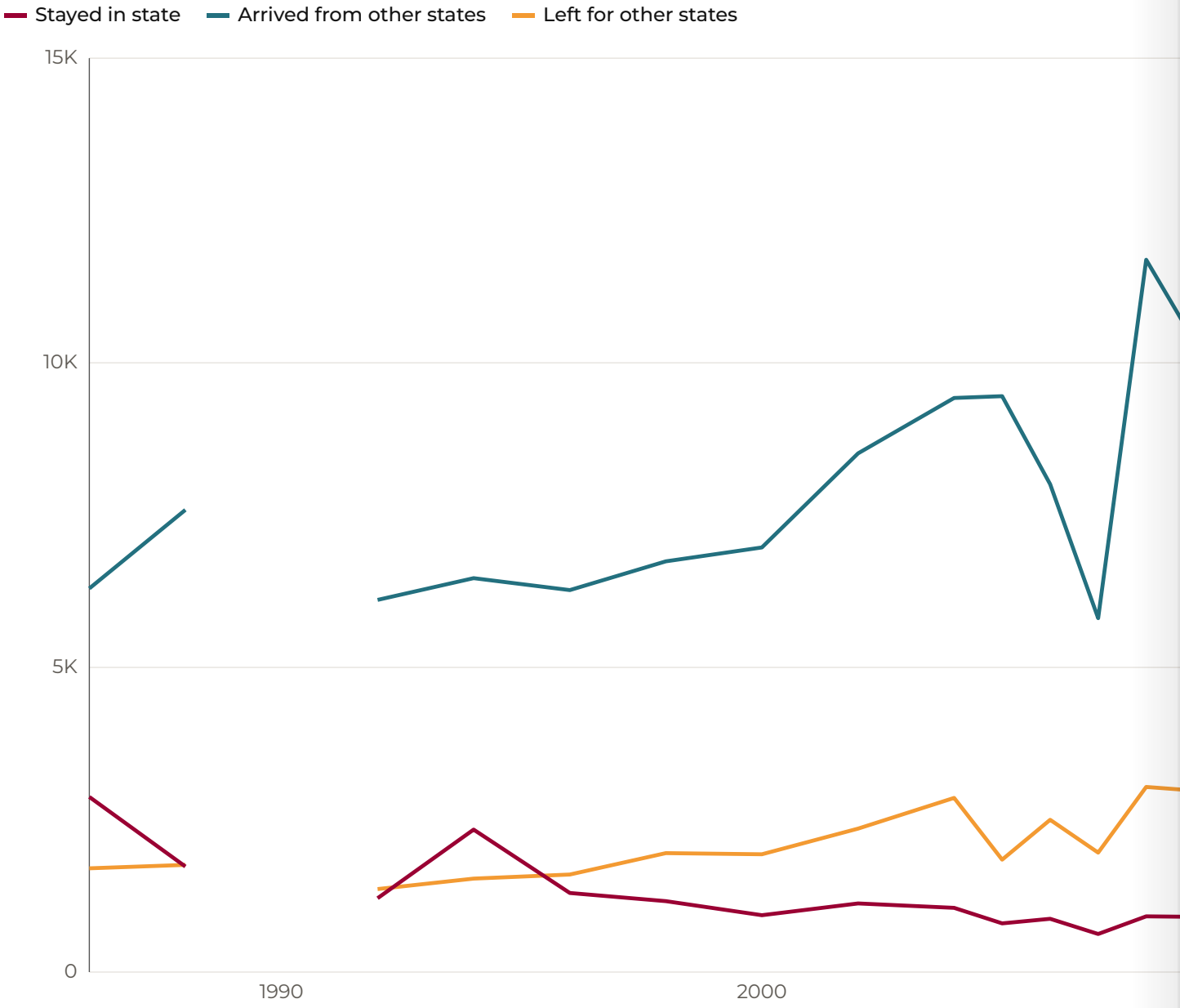
U.S. **3.1%** · **6th** of 51 · −1.9 pp since 2016

+162

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

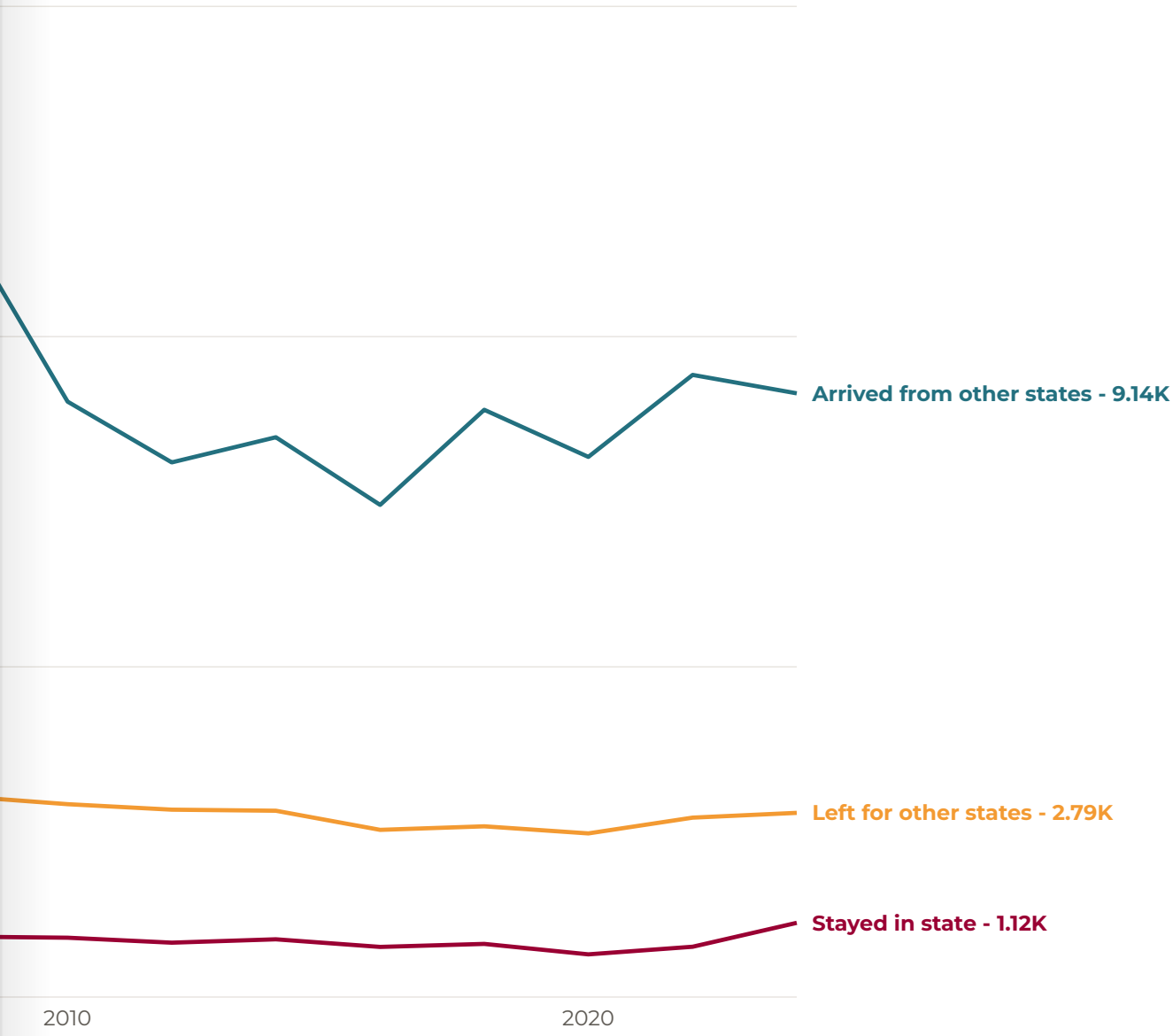
1st of 51 · +12.9 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is up 48%, arrivals from other states are up 23%, and residents leaving are up 10%.



Net migration was +162 per 100 resident first-time students (1st of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Maryland (495).

Figure 12

Where Do the District of Columbia's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at the District of Columbia's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

9.72K

First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024

Abroad **583**

5.3%

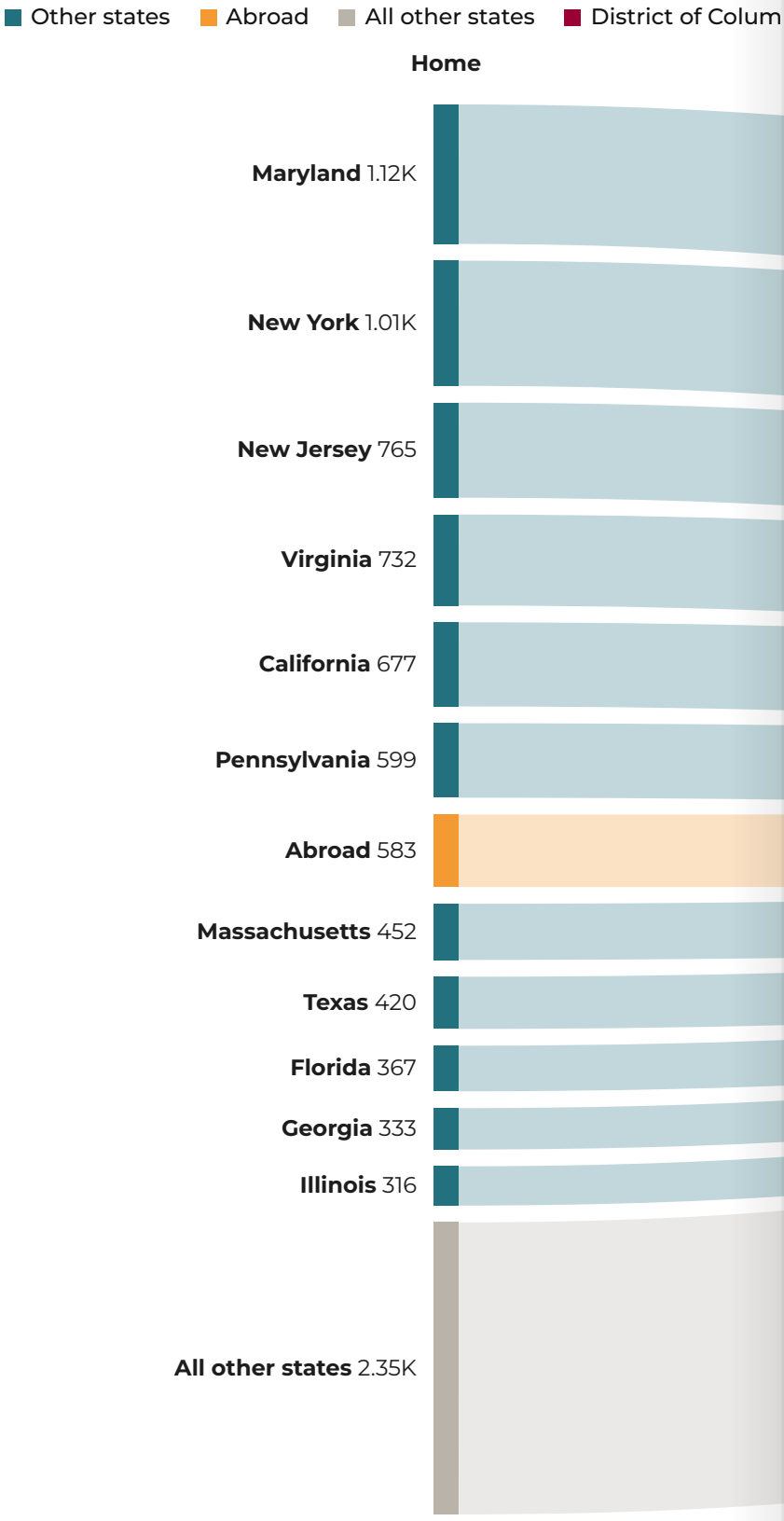
First-time students from abroad, 2024

U.S. **3.1%** · **6th** of 51 · −1.9 pp since 2016

10%

First-time students from in state, 2024

51st of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flow

bia institutions

Enrolled in

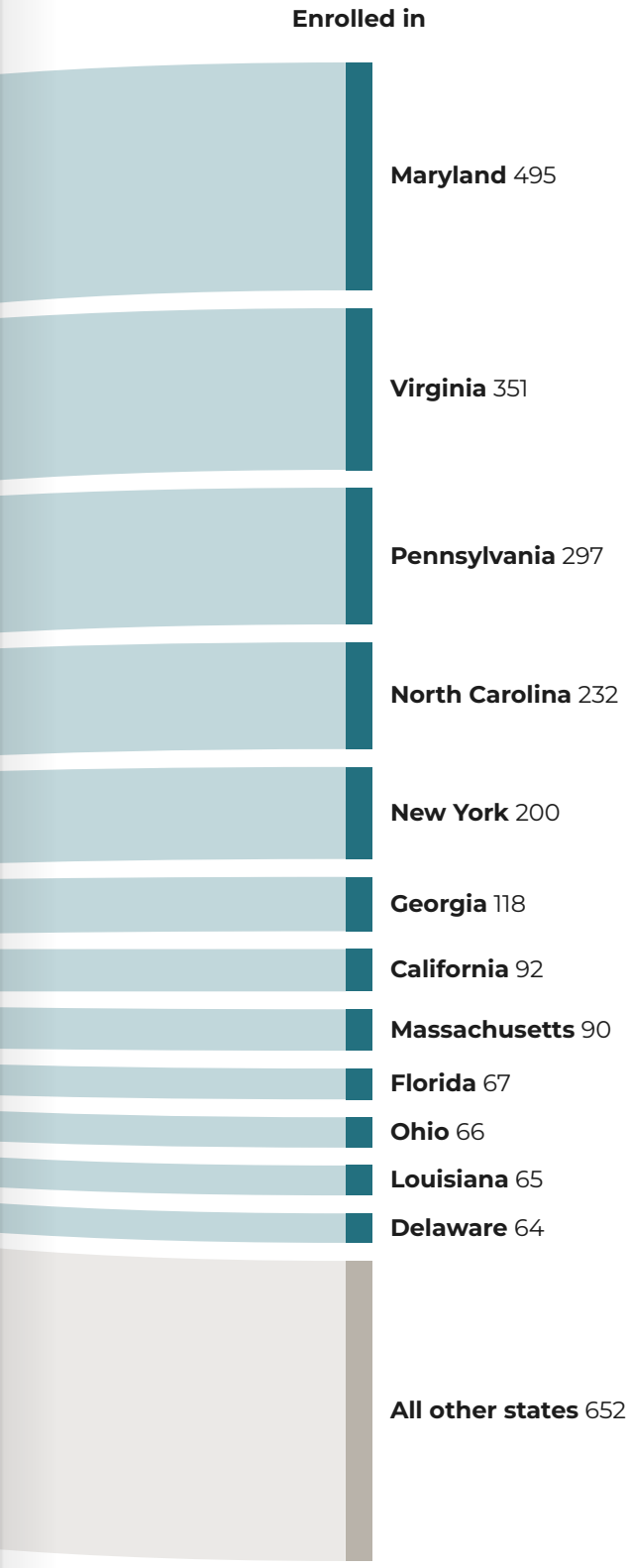


District of Columbia
institutions 9.72K

ws (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ord



ered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do the District of Columbia's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where the District of Columbia residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 2.79K in fall 2024, up 2.6% from 2.72K in fall 2022 and up 10% since fall 2016, when it was 2.53K.

2.79K

Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024

Arrived from other states **9.14K** · **9.72K** with abroad

+162

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

1st of 51 · +12.9 since 2016

495

Went to Maryland

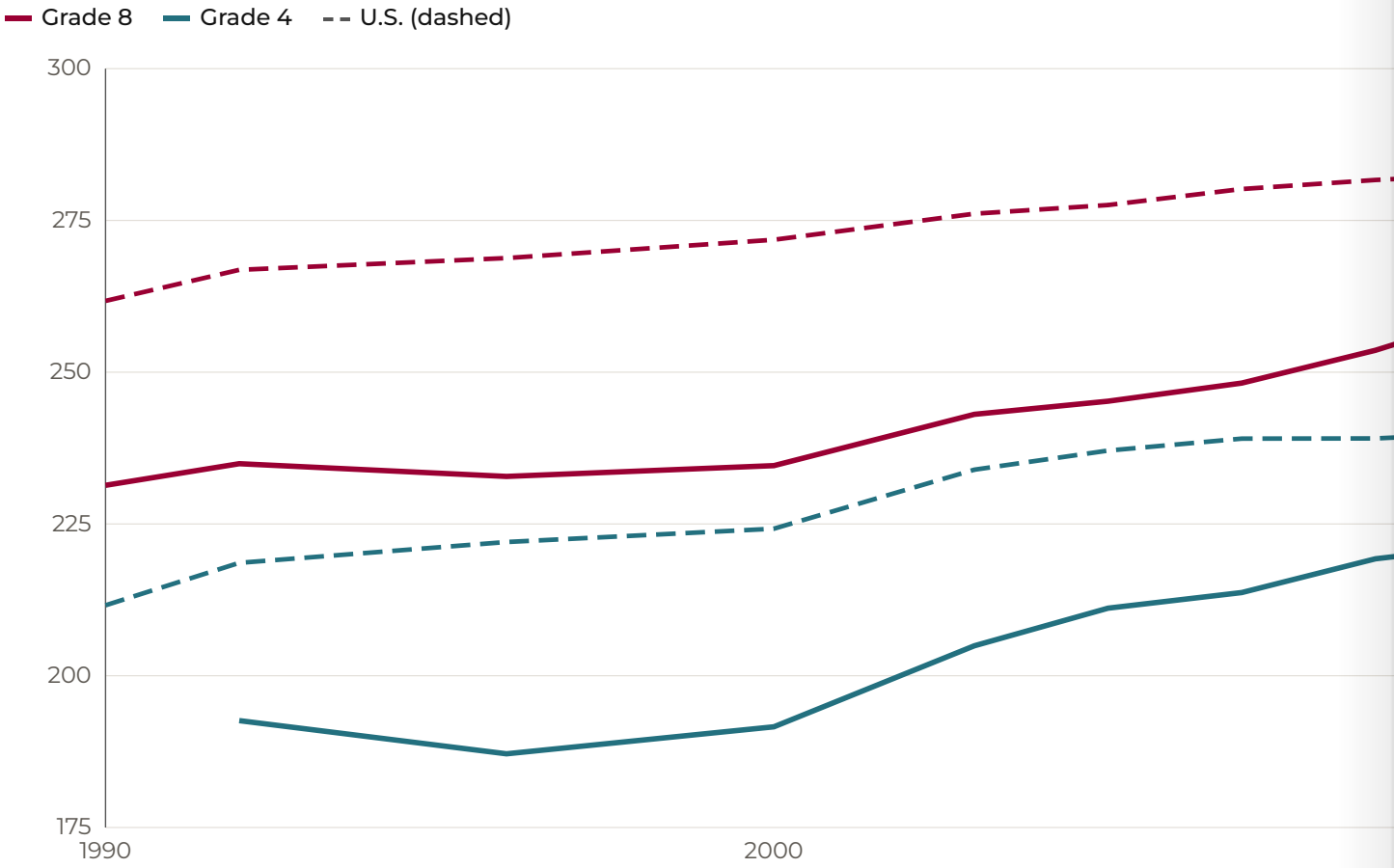
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

The District of Columbia ranks 49th of 51 on the average grade 8 mathematics score, at 262 in 2024 against 272 for the U.S.

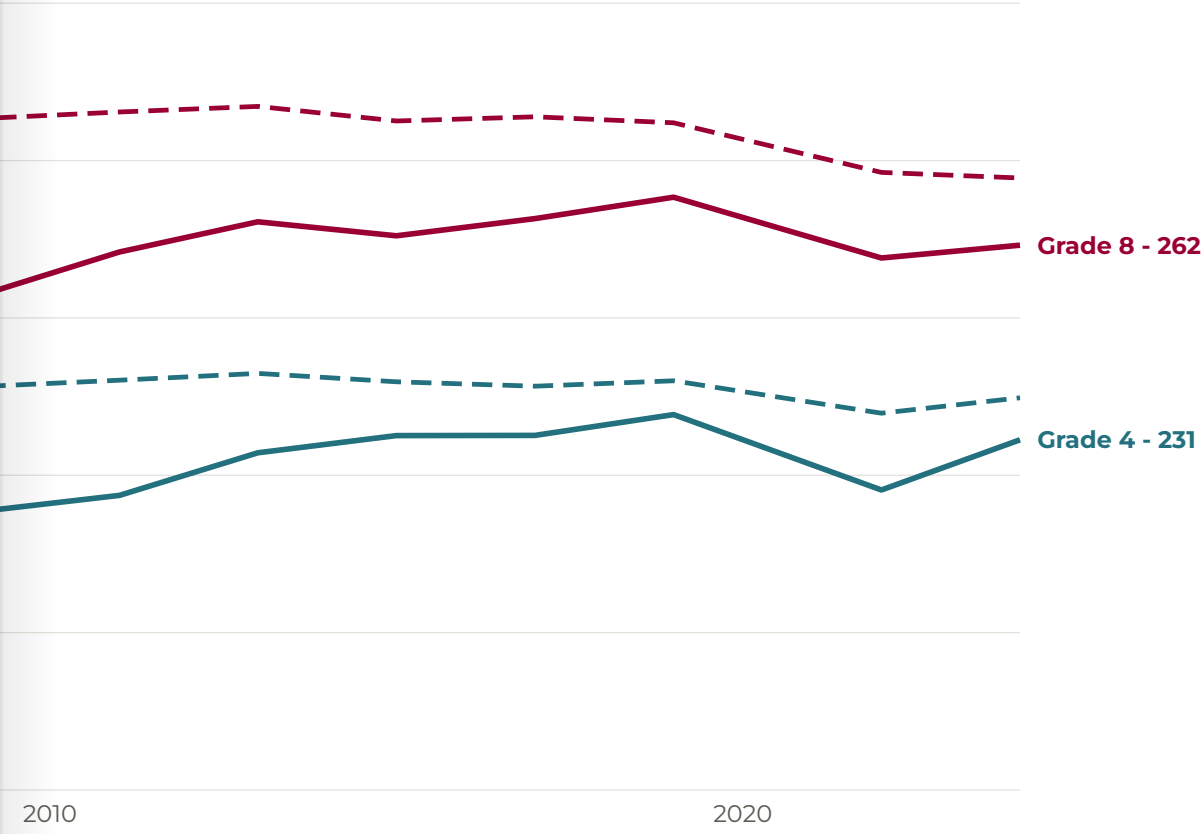
Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are the District of Columbia's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, N

The talent pipeline starts in school. The District of Columbia's eighth graders averaged 262 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 49th of 51 among the states.

20% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.



lational Assessment of Educational Progress.

262

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **49th** of 51 · –1.5 since 2015

20%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **45th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

251

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

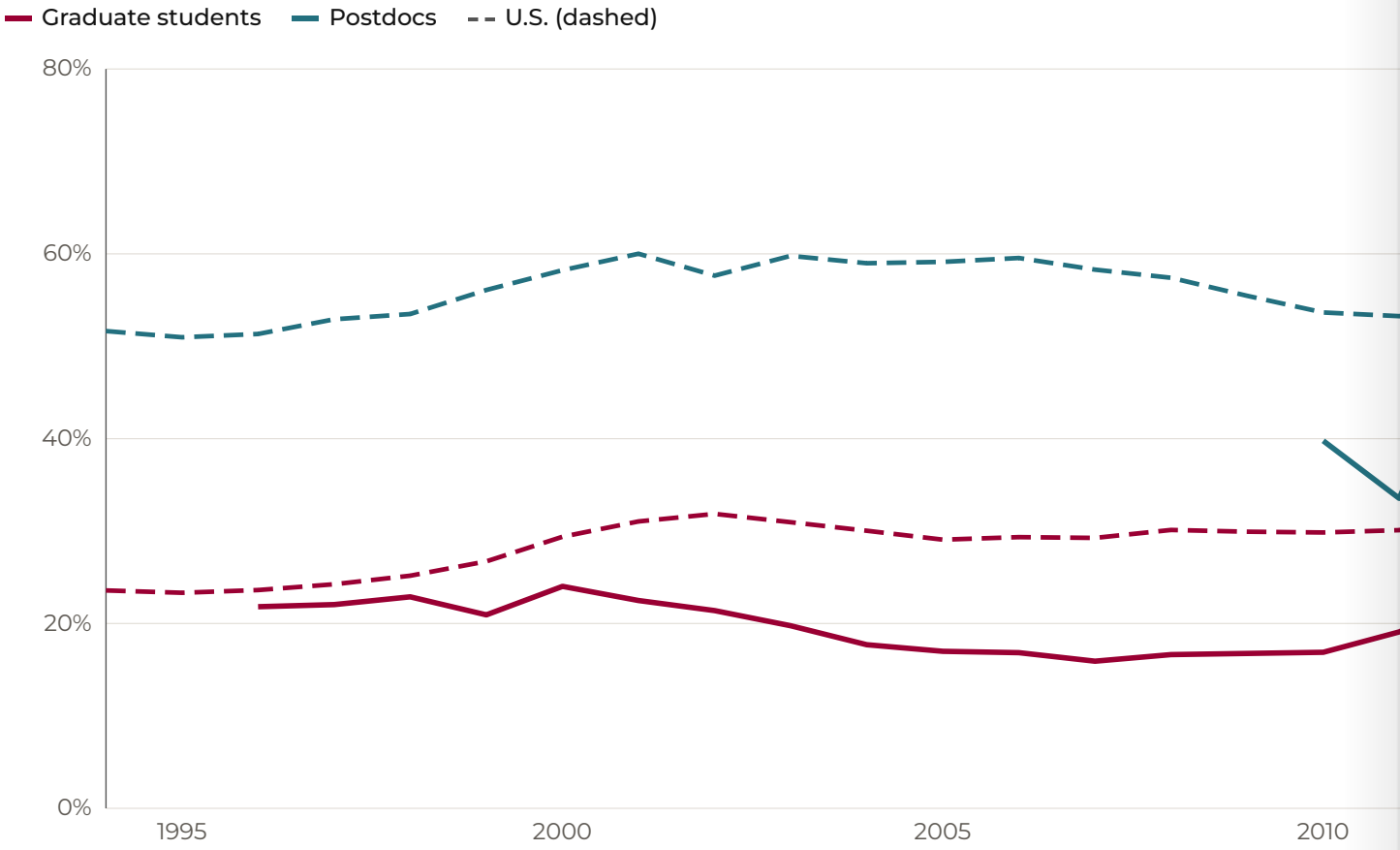
U.S. **257** · **45th** of 51 · +3.6 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

The District of Columbia ranks 33rd of 51 on the temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students, at 30% in 2016 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of the District of Columbia's Science and Engineering Graduate St



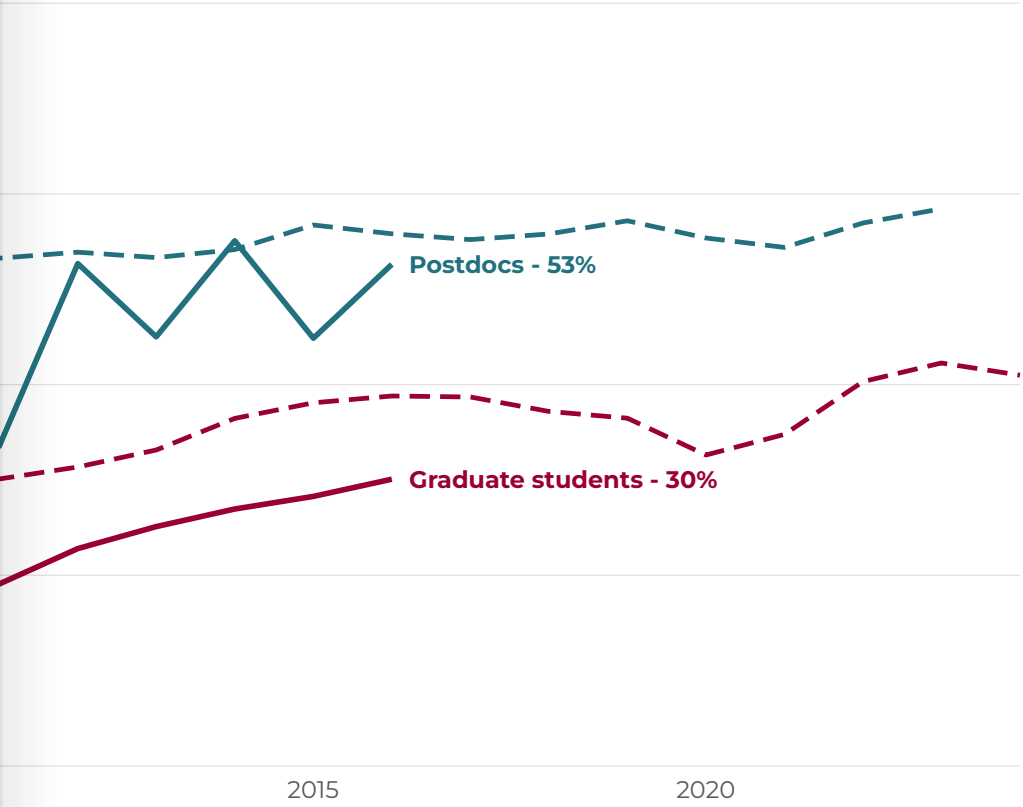
Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's sta
Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 30% of the District of Columbia's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 33rd of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 53% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 525 research doctorates in 2025, 0.9% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

tudents Hold Temporary Visas?



te; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate

30%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **33rd** of 51 · +1.8 pp since 2015

53%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **27th** of 51 · +7.8 pp since 2015

525

Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

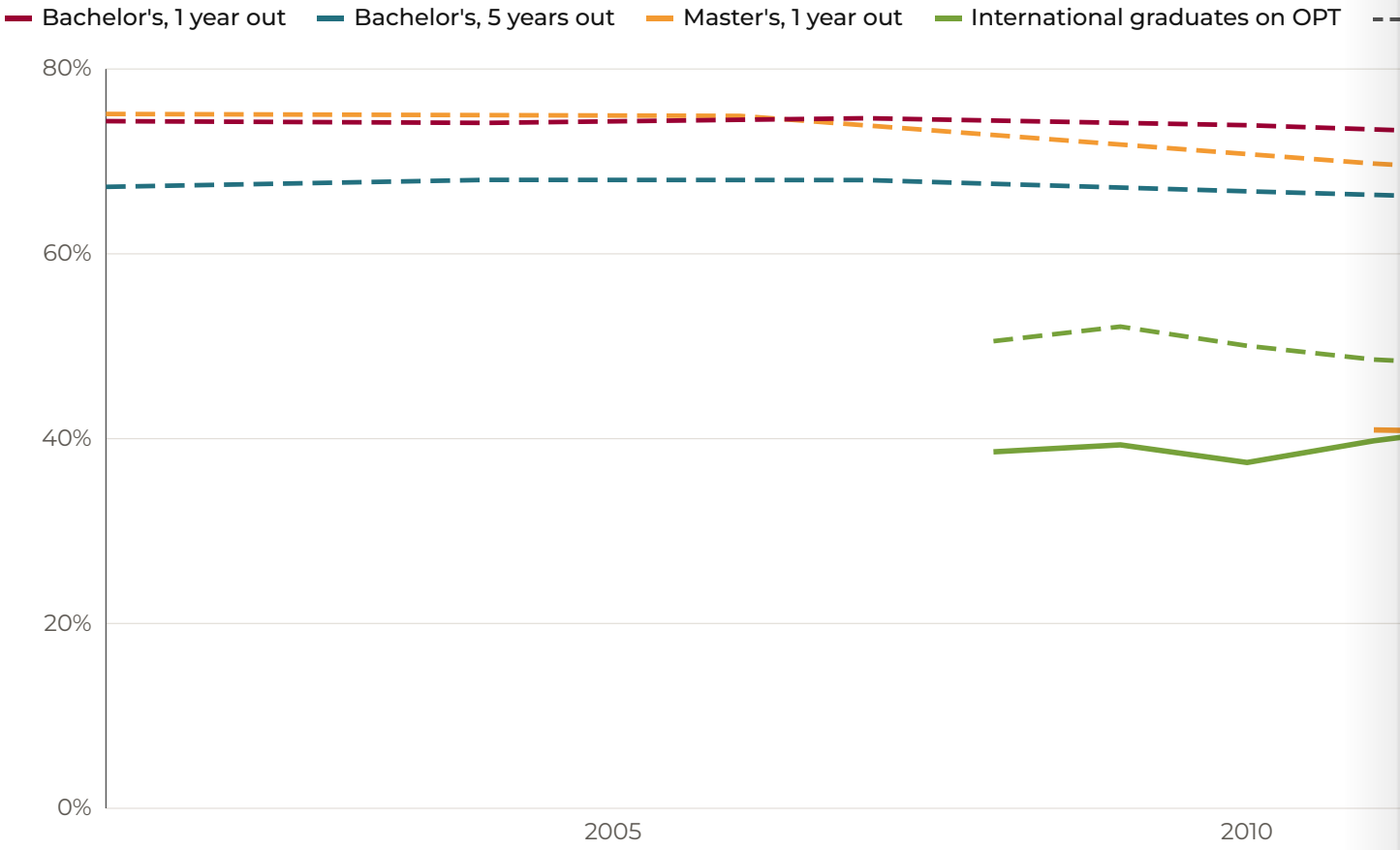
U.S. **59K** · **29th** of 51 · −8.9% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

The District of Columbia ranks 51st of 51 on net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents, at −15.9 in 2025.

Figure 16 How Many of the District of Columbia's Graduates Go On to Work in the State



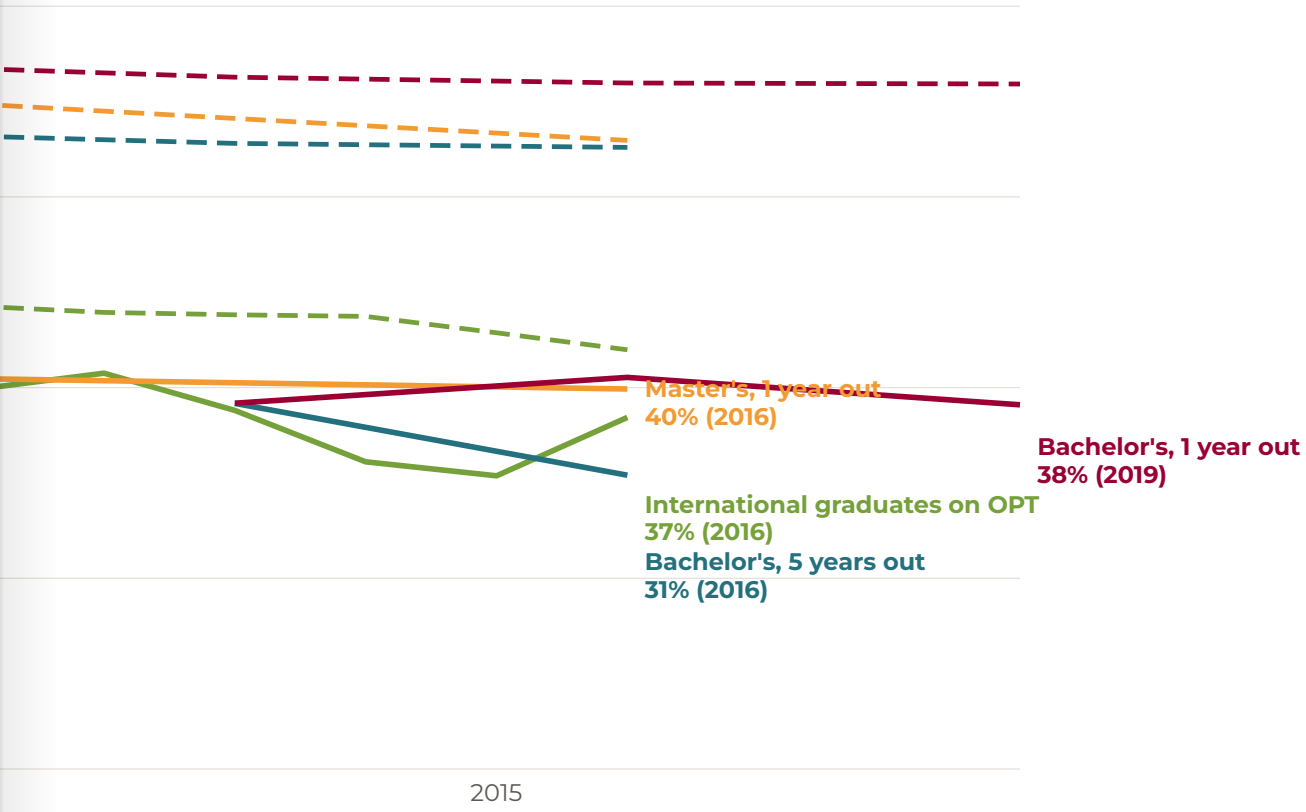
Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or particip

Of the District of Columbia's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 38% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 31%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 37% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state lost 15.9 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

e?

U.S. (dashed)



au, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the
pating states dashed.

38%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **31st** of 33 · −2.9 pp since 2016

37%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **22nd** of 51 · +6.1 pp since 2015

−15.9

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

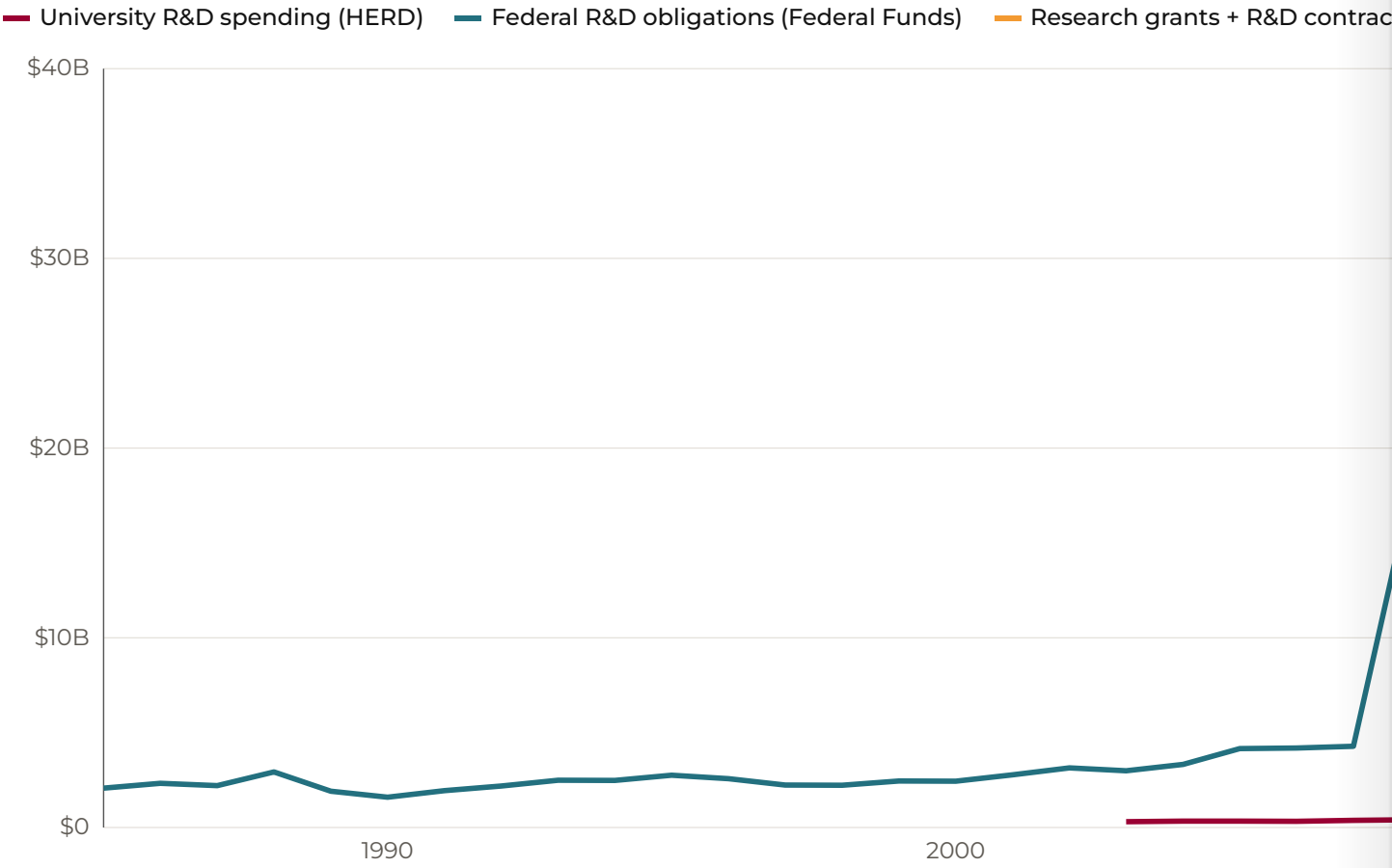
51st of 51 · +6.2 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

The District of Columbia ranks 5th of 51 on federal R&D obligations to the state, at $10.2B in 2024 against $193B for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into the District of Columbia?

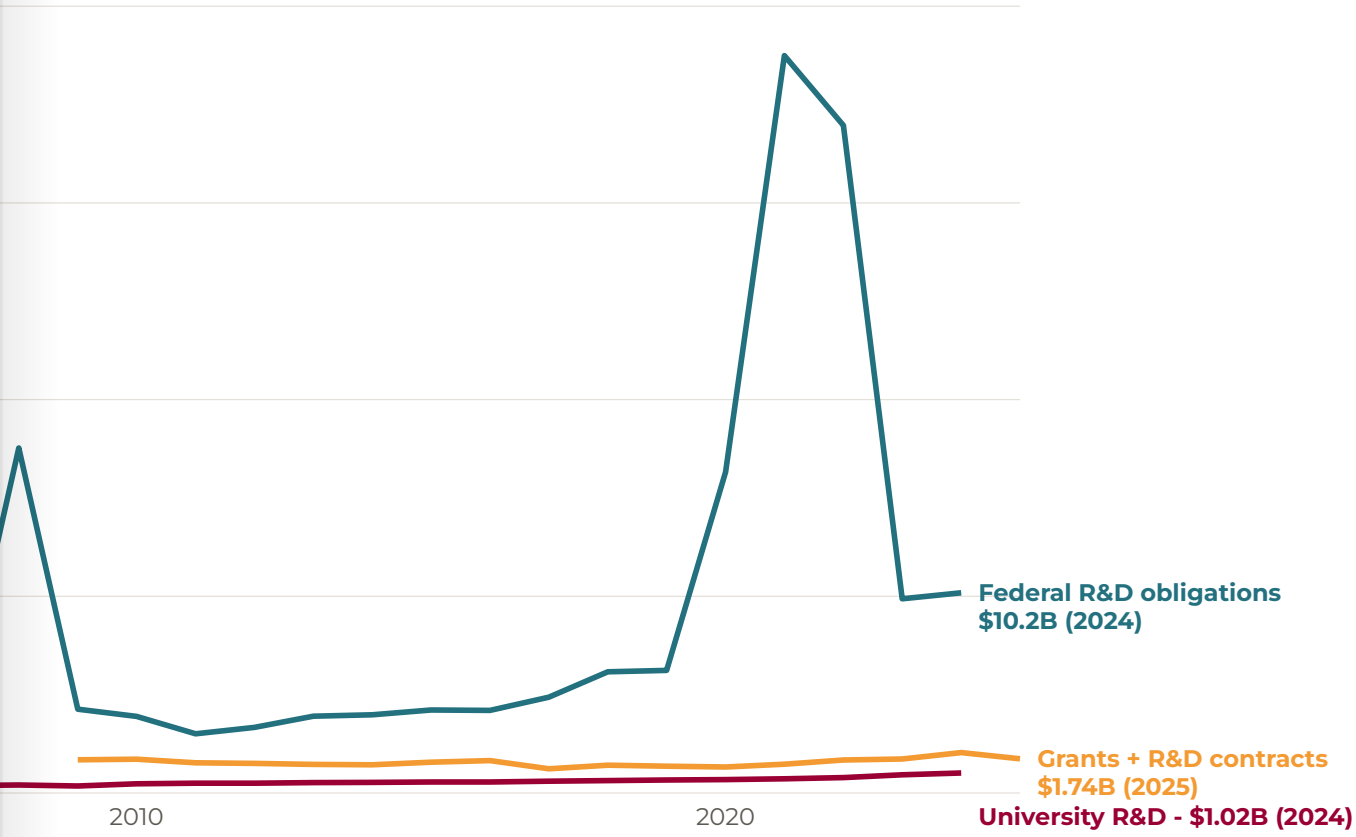


Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. Univers
Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage wide

The District of Columbia's universities spent $1.02B on research and development in FY2024, 30th of 51 among the states; 45% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $10.2B for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

ts (USAspending)



sity R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey).
ens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

$1.02B

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **30th** of 51 · +82% since 2015

45%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **43rd** of 51 · −9.5 pp since 2015

$10.2B

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

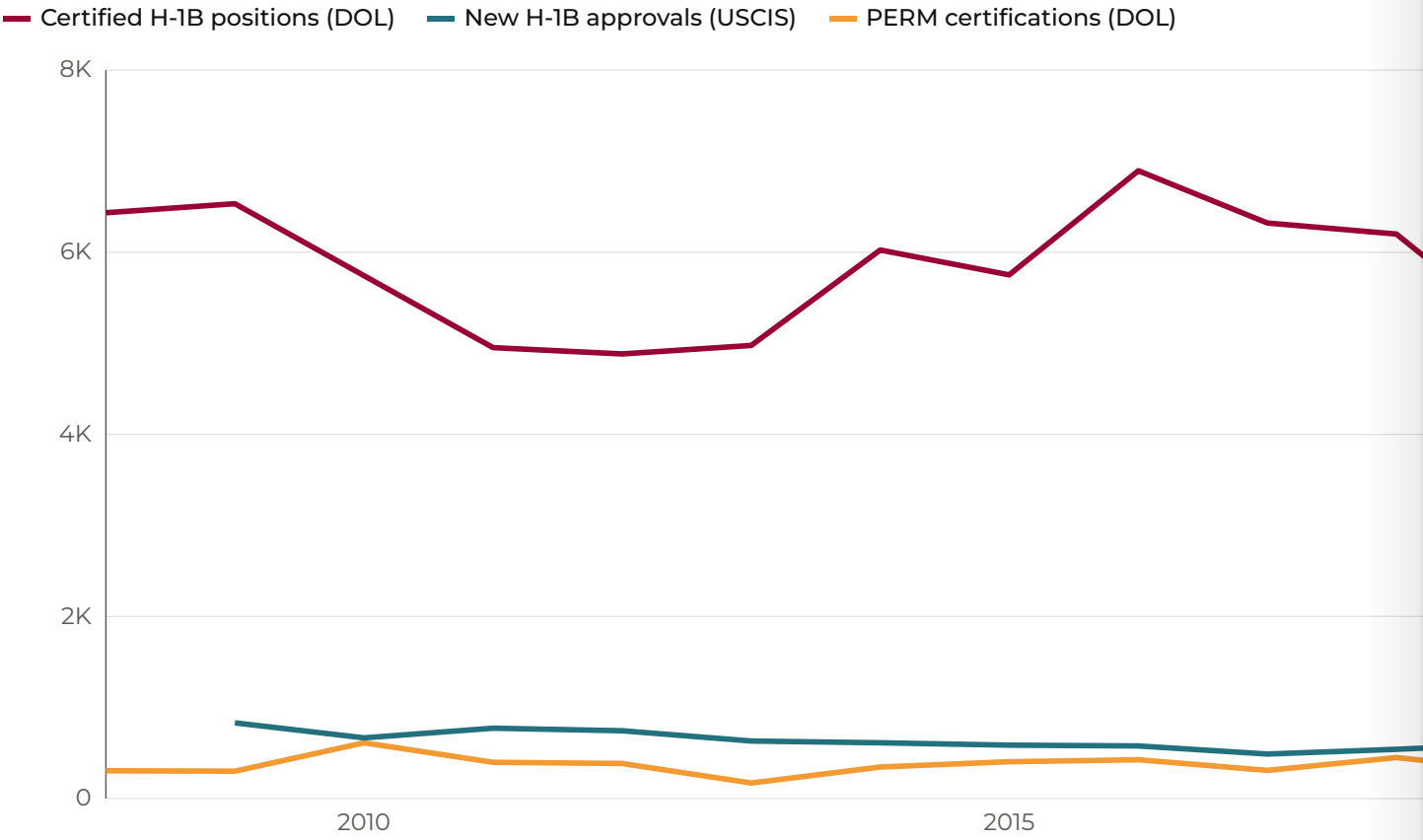
U.S. **$193B** · **5th** of 51 · 2.41× since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

The District of Columbia ranks 36th of 51 on green-card labor certifications, at 486 in 2025 against 138K for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does the District

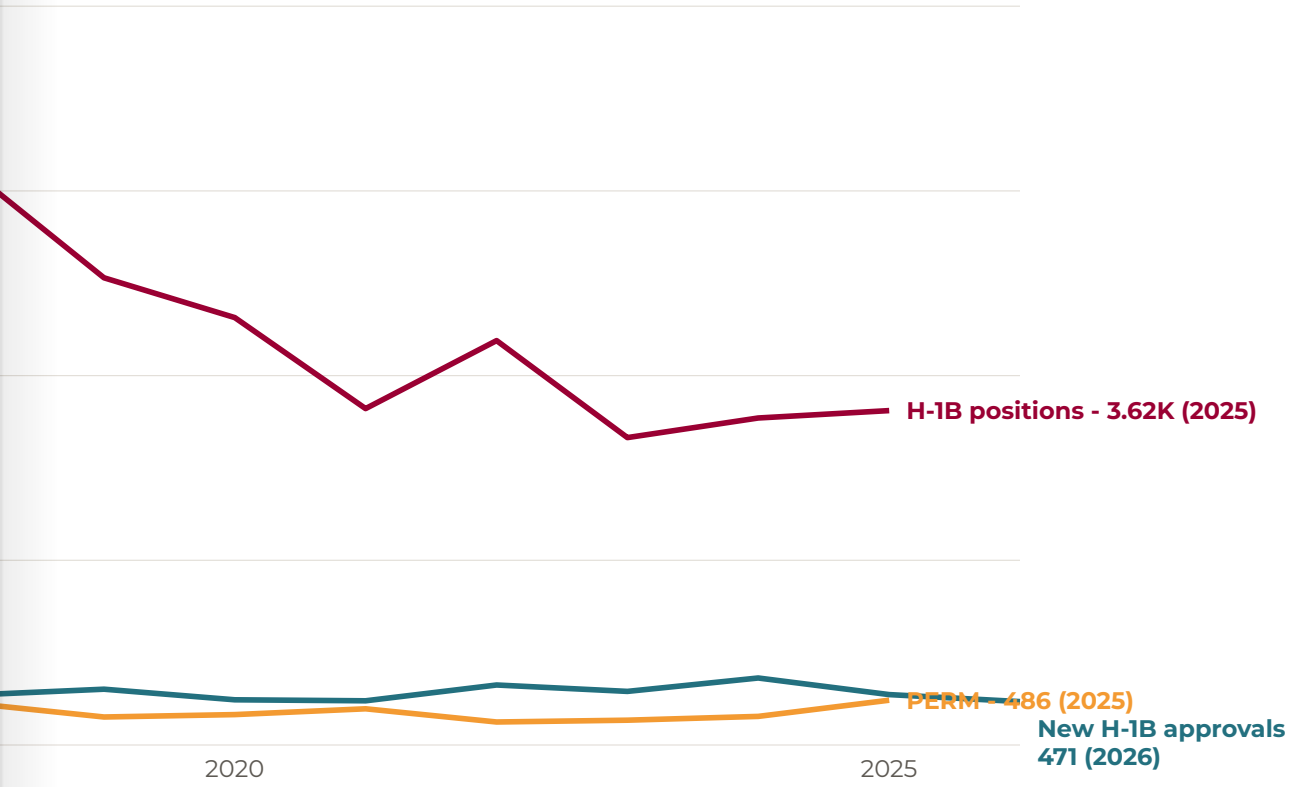


Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal
from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 3.62K H-1B positions at the District of Columbia worksites in FY2025, 27th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 471 new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 867 continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 486 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 12% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

of Columbia Generate?



year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data

3.62K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **27th** of 51 · −37% since 2015

486

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

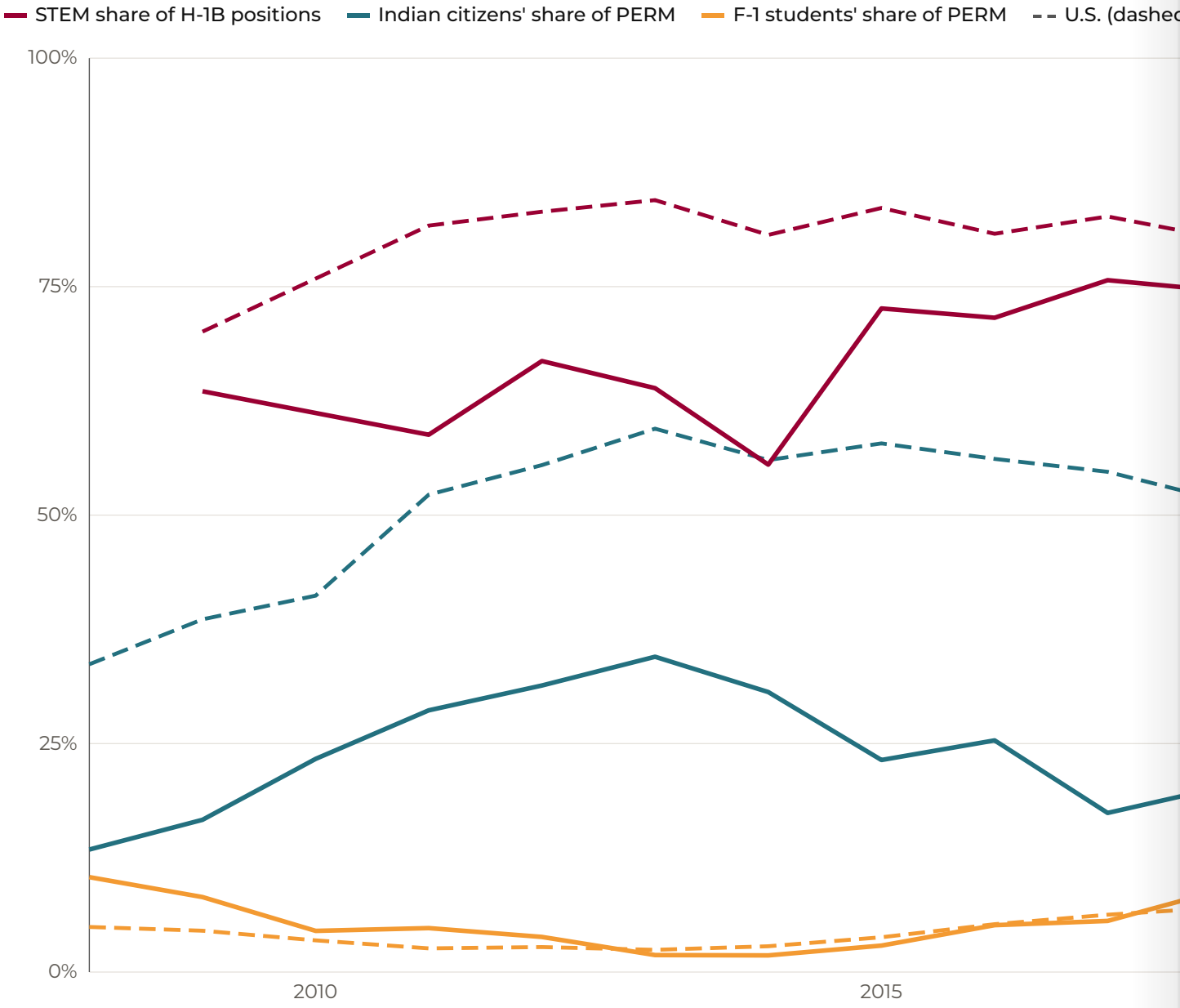
U.S. **138K** · **36th** of 51 · +20% since 2015

12%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **17th** of 51 · +8.8 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds the District of Columbia's Skilled-Visa Jobs?

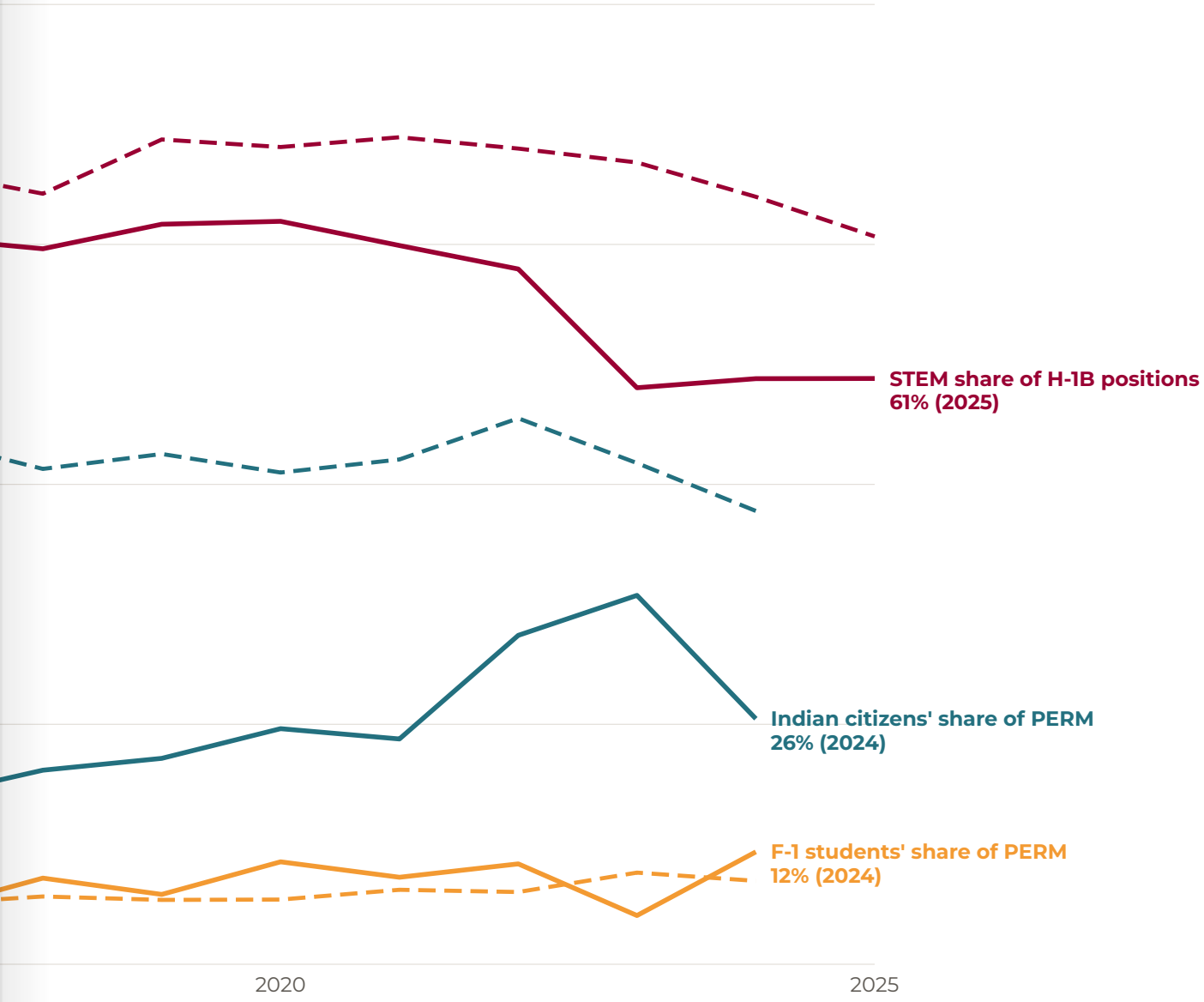


State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from D

61% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 26% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

d)



OL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

61%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **31st** of 51 · −11.6 pp since 2015

26%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **35th** of 51 · +2.4 pp since 2015

$112K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

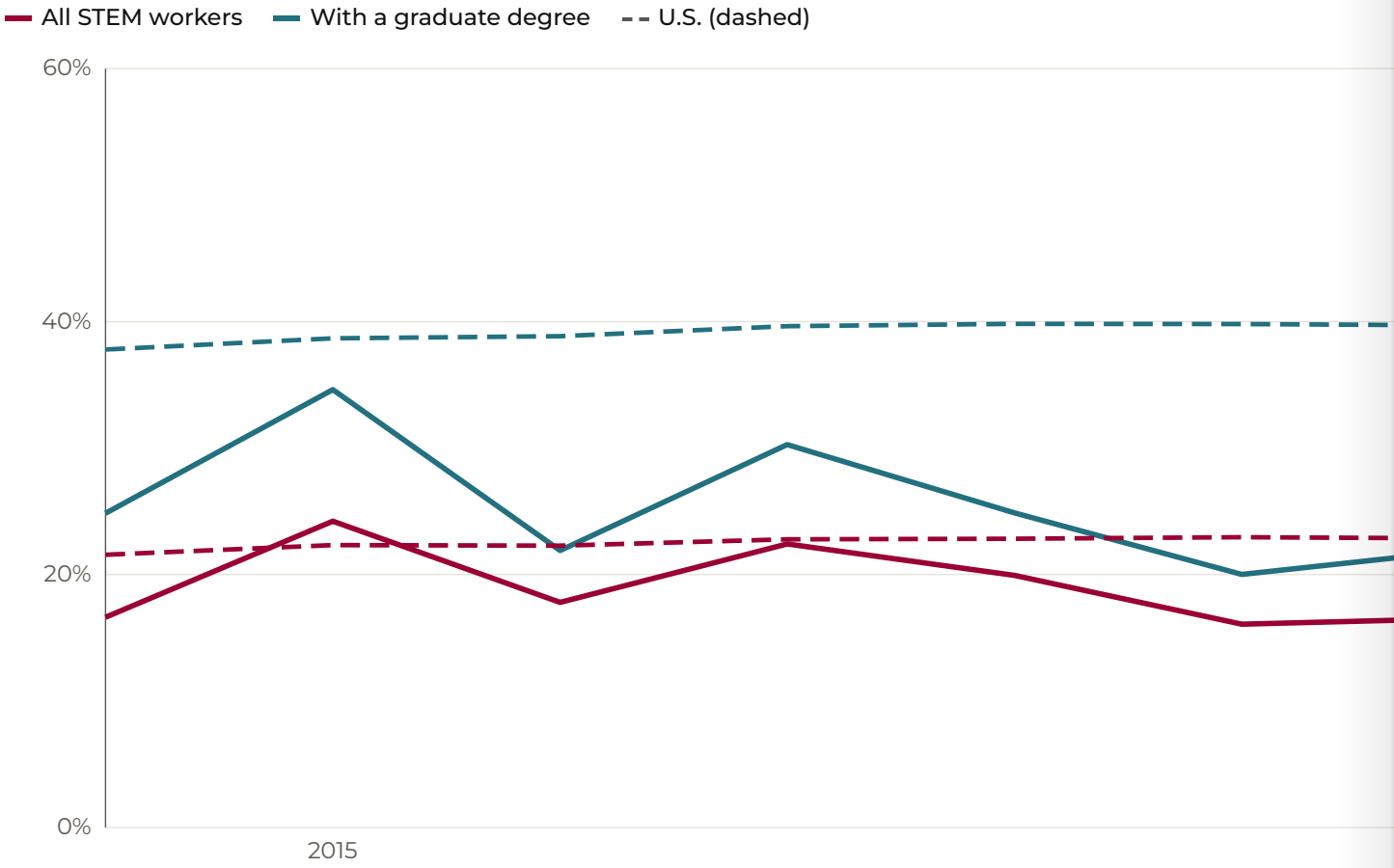
U.S. **$119K** · **13th** of 51 · +55% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

The District of Columbia ranks 32nd of 44 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree, at 24% in 2024 against 41% for the U.S.

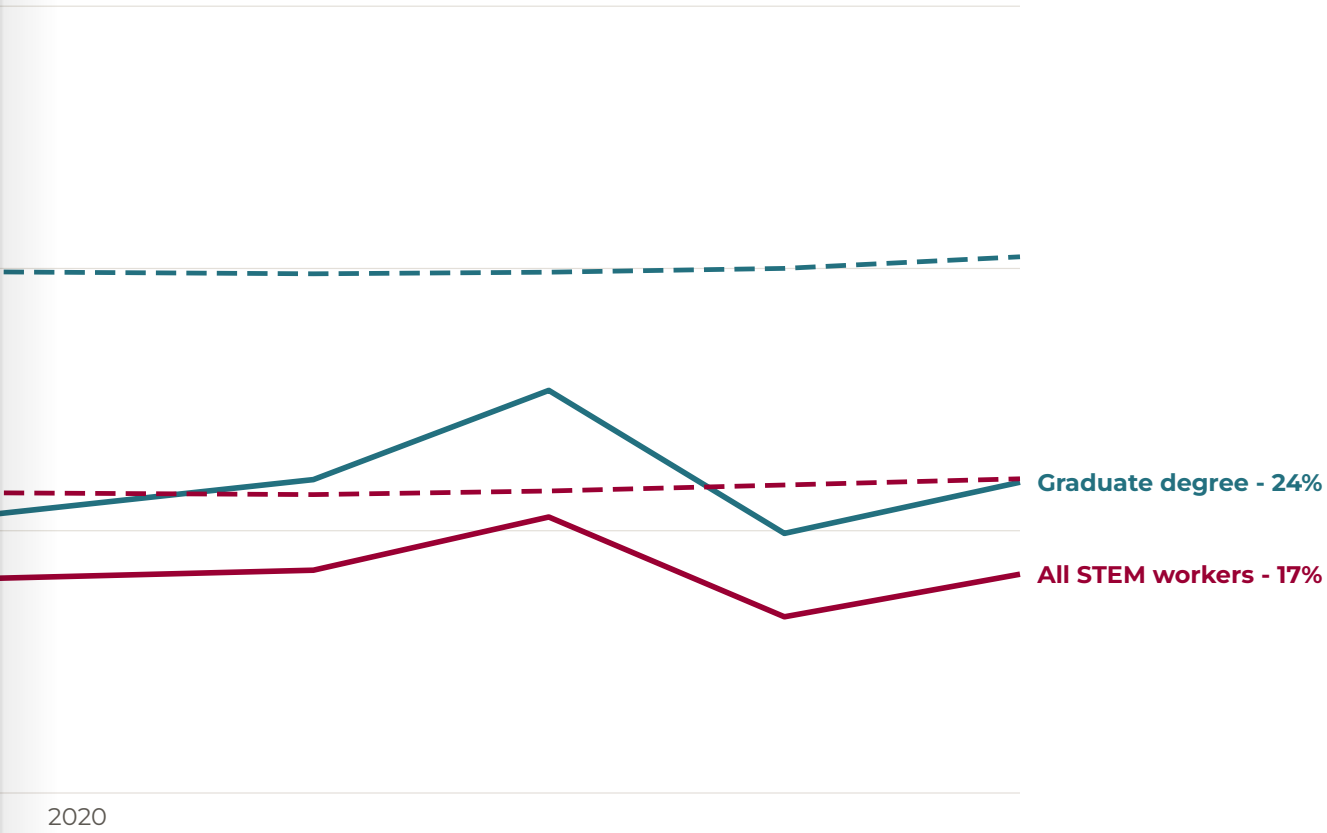
Figure 20 How Much of the District of Columbia's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resti
Community Survey.

In 2024, 17% of the people working in STEM occupations in the District of Columbia were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 20th of 51).

The share rises with education: 24% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 8.2% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.



ng on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American

17%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **20th** of 51 · −7.5 pp since 2015

24%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **32nd** of 44 · −10.9 pp since 2015

8.2%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

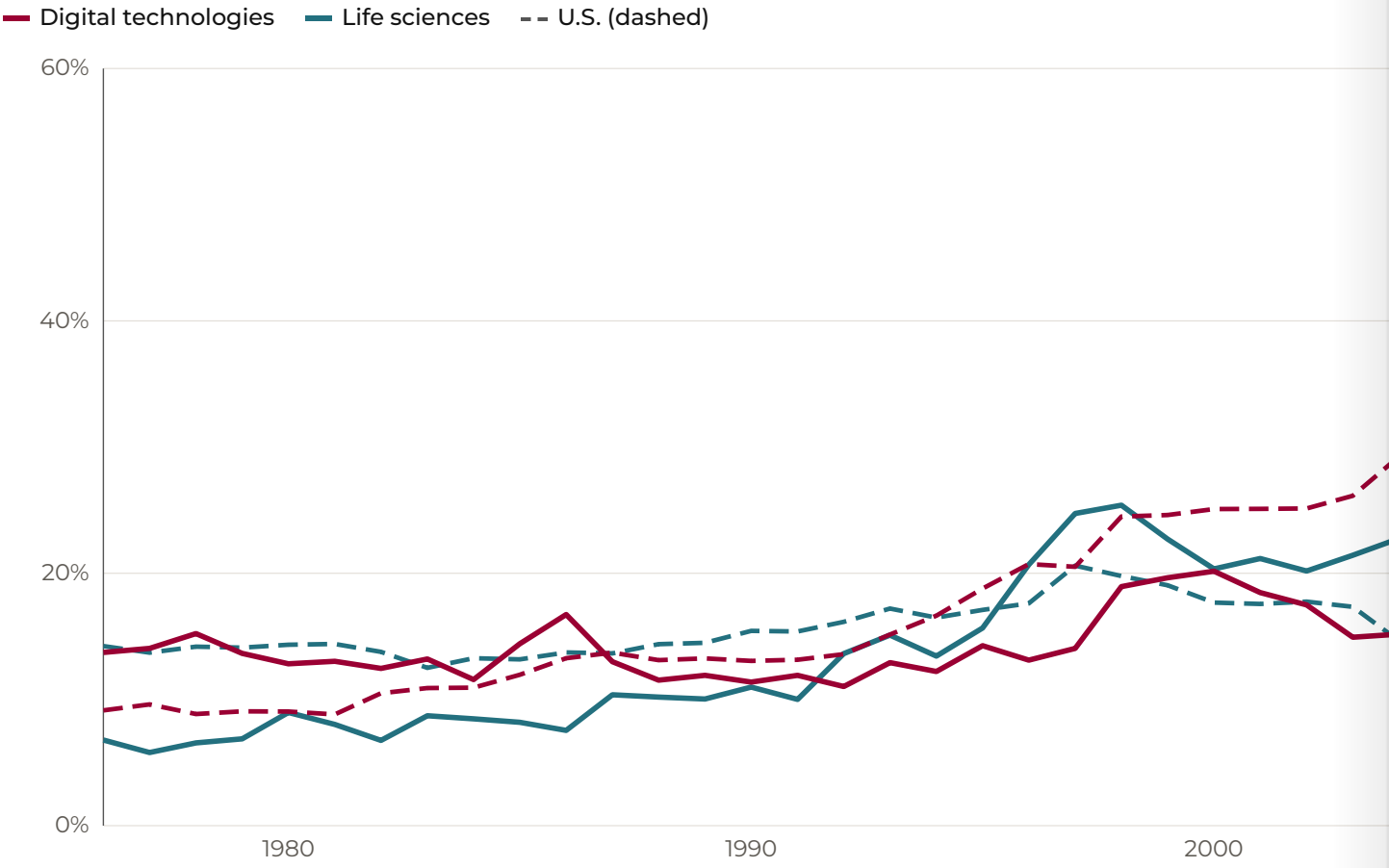
U.S. **11%** · **19th** of 51 · −6.0 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

The District of Columbia ranks 11th of 51 on the share of the state's patents in life sciences, at 27% in 2025 against 17% for the U.S.

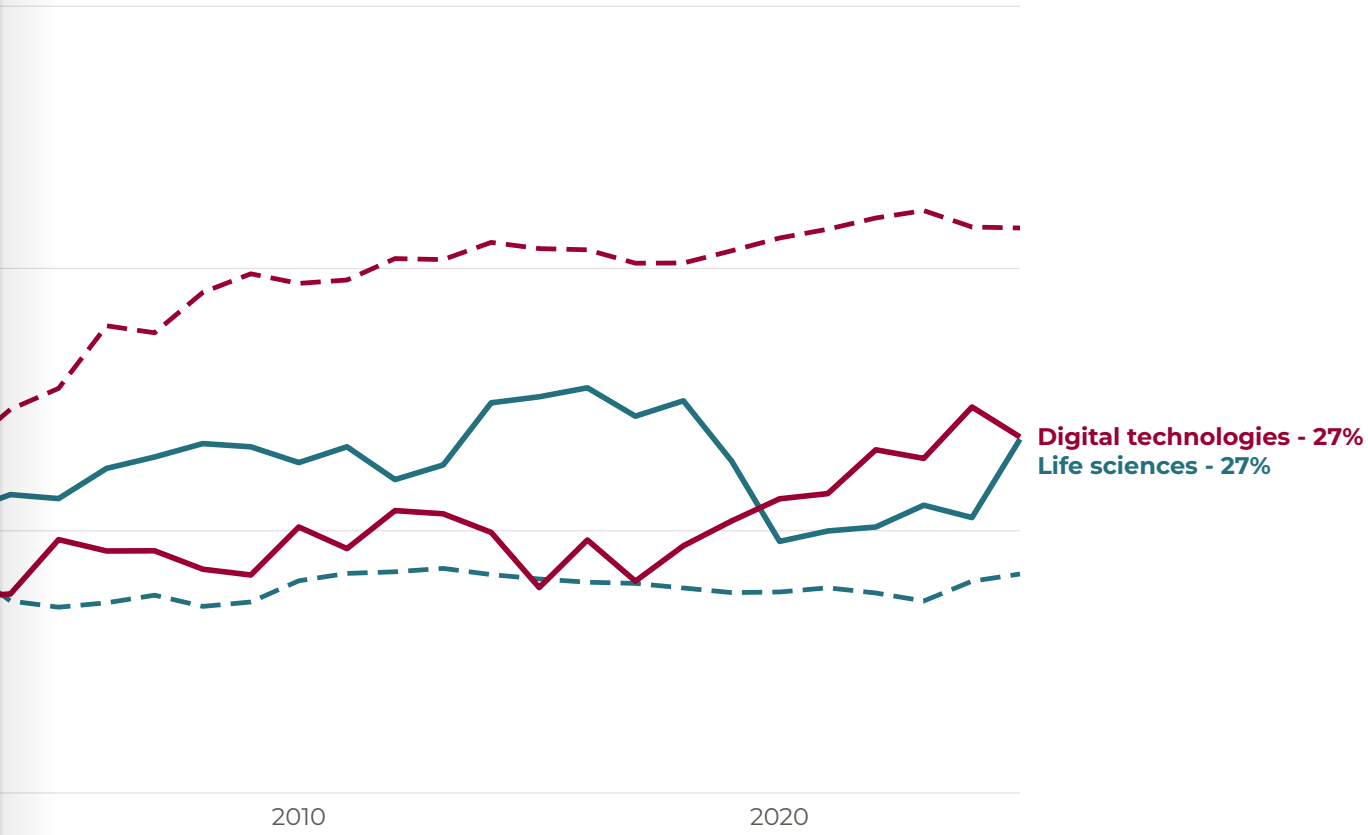
Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does the District of Columbia Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed

Organizations and people in the District of Columbia were granted 538 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.4% of all patents with a U.S. owner (32nd of 51).

27% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 27% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).



d. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

538

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **32nd** of 51 · −51% since 2015

27%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **20th** of 51 · +11.5 pp since 2015

27%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

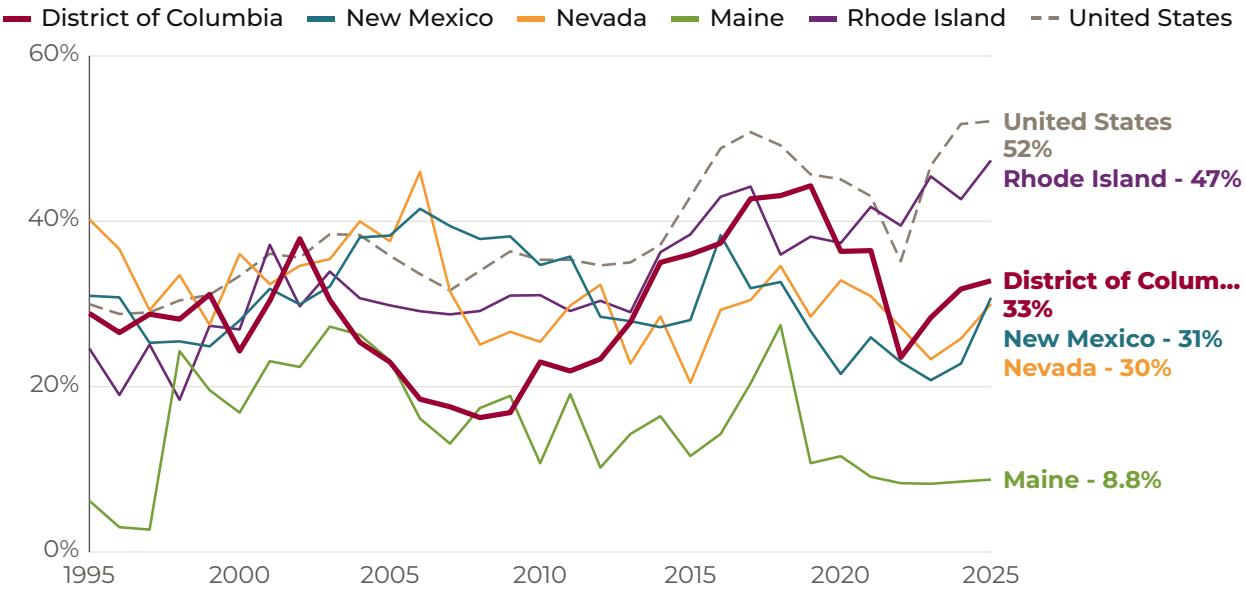
U.S. **17%** · **11th** of 51 · −3.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

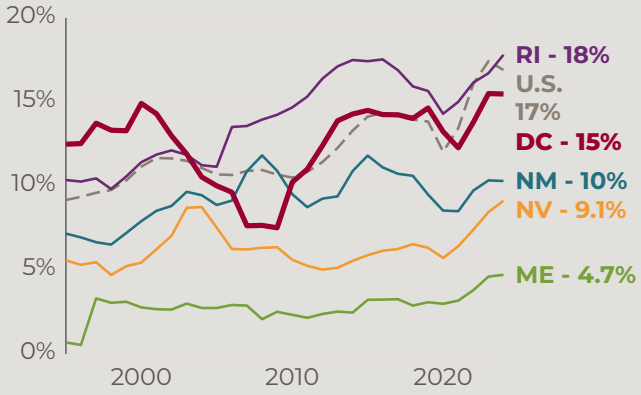
The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are New Mexico, Nevada, Maine, and Rhode Island. The District of Columbia ranks 2nd of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Rhode Island is the most dependent at 47%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are the District of Columbia and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



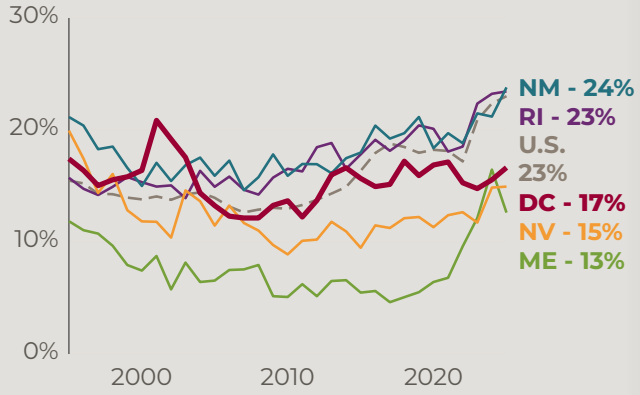
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



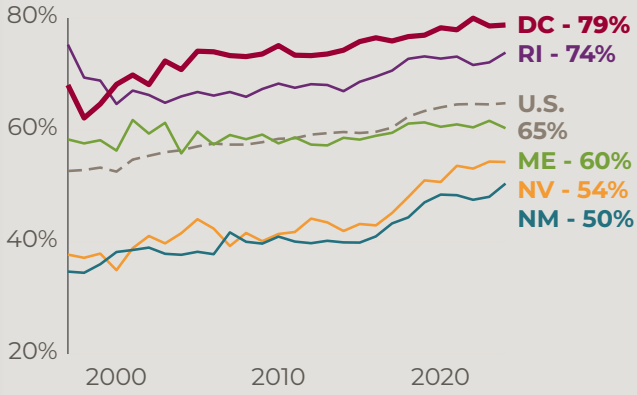
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Table 4 How Does the District of Columbia Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	DC	NM	NV	ME	RI	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**100K**	114K	121K	80.9K	75.6K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**42%**	13%	10%	12%	16%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**16%**	22%	20%	24%	23%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**17%**	24%	15%	13%	23%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**656**	237	117	28	406	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**0.6%**	0.2%	0.1%	0.0%	0.3%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**33%**	31%	30%	8.8%	47%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**36%**	34%	48%	39%	38%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**15%**	10%	9.1%	4.7%	18%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**5.6%**	1.7%	0.8%	2.3%	5.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**79%**	50%	54%	60%	74%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$6.33K**	$7.98K	$6.6K	$11.4K	$15.5K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$44K**	$23K	$10.8K	$10.2K	$8.67K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$132K**	$84.6K	$110K	$93.7K	$120K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**10%**	85%	91%	63%	41%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**+162**	−5	−18	+16	+58	–

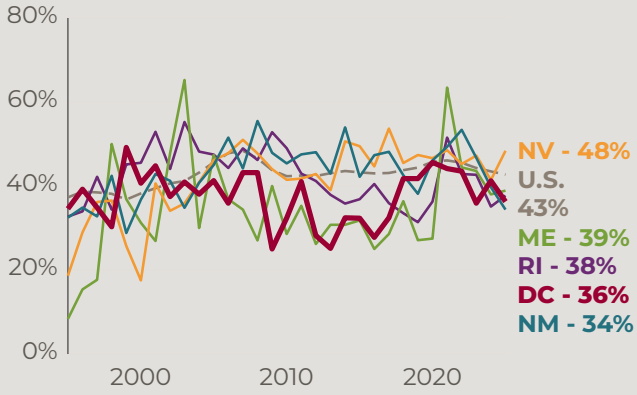
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM doctorates

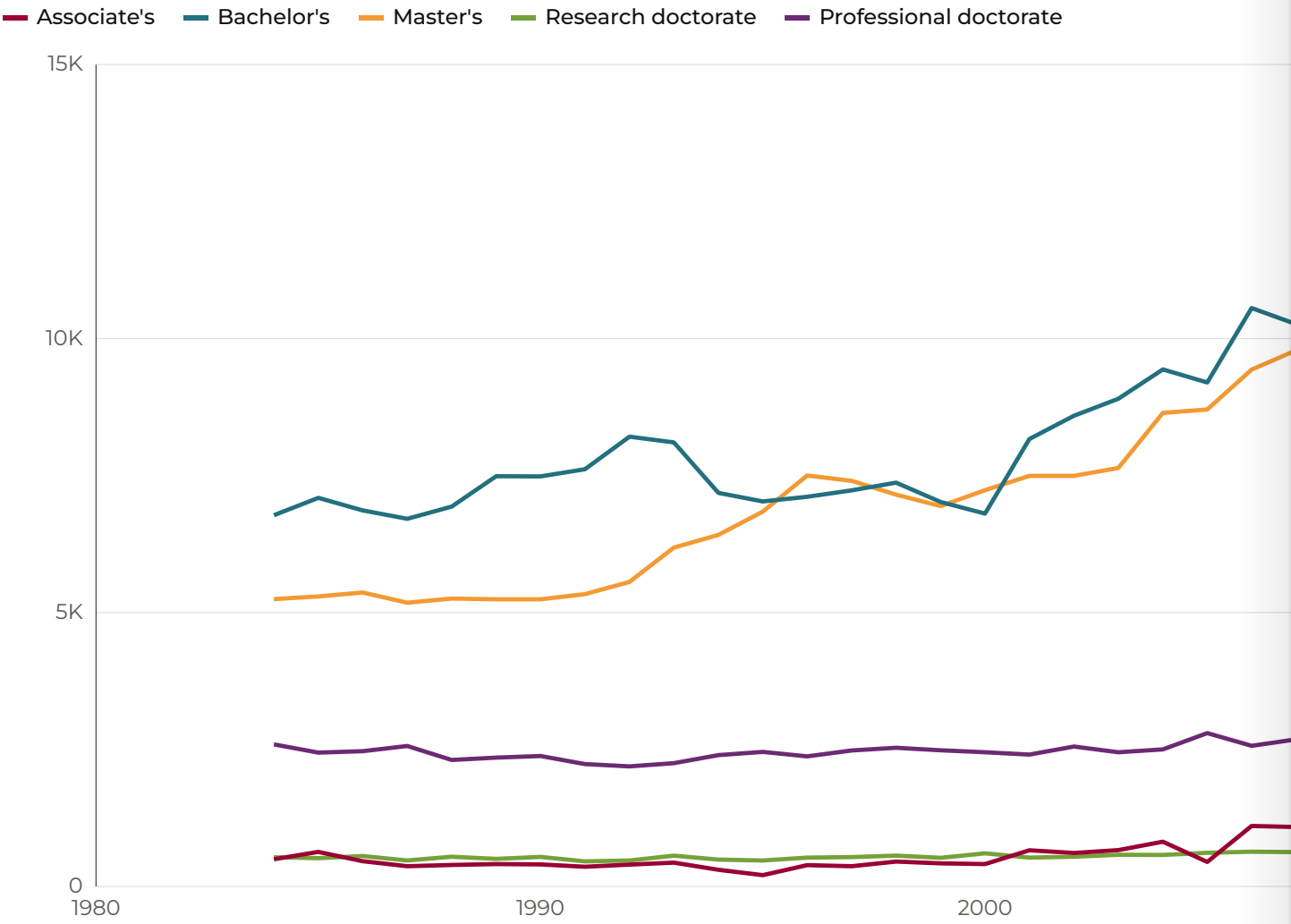


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

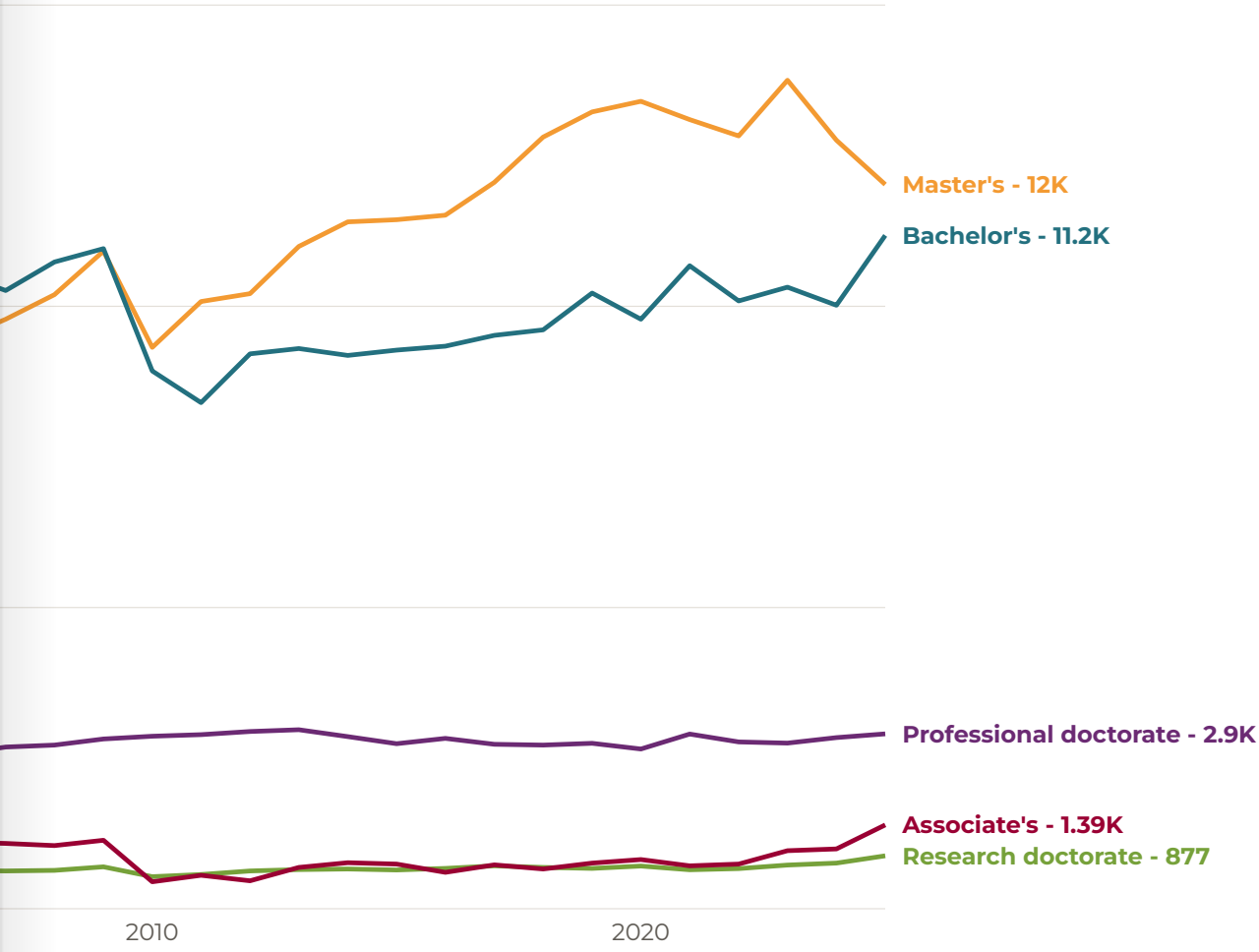
Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does the District of Columbia Award?



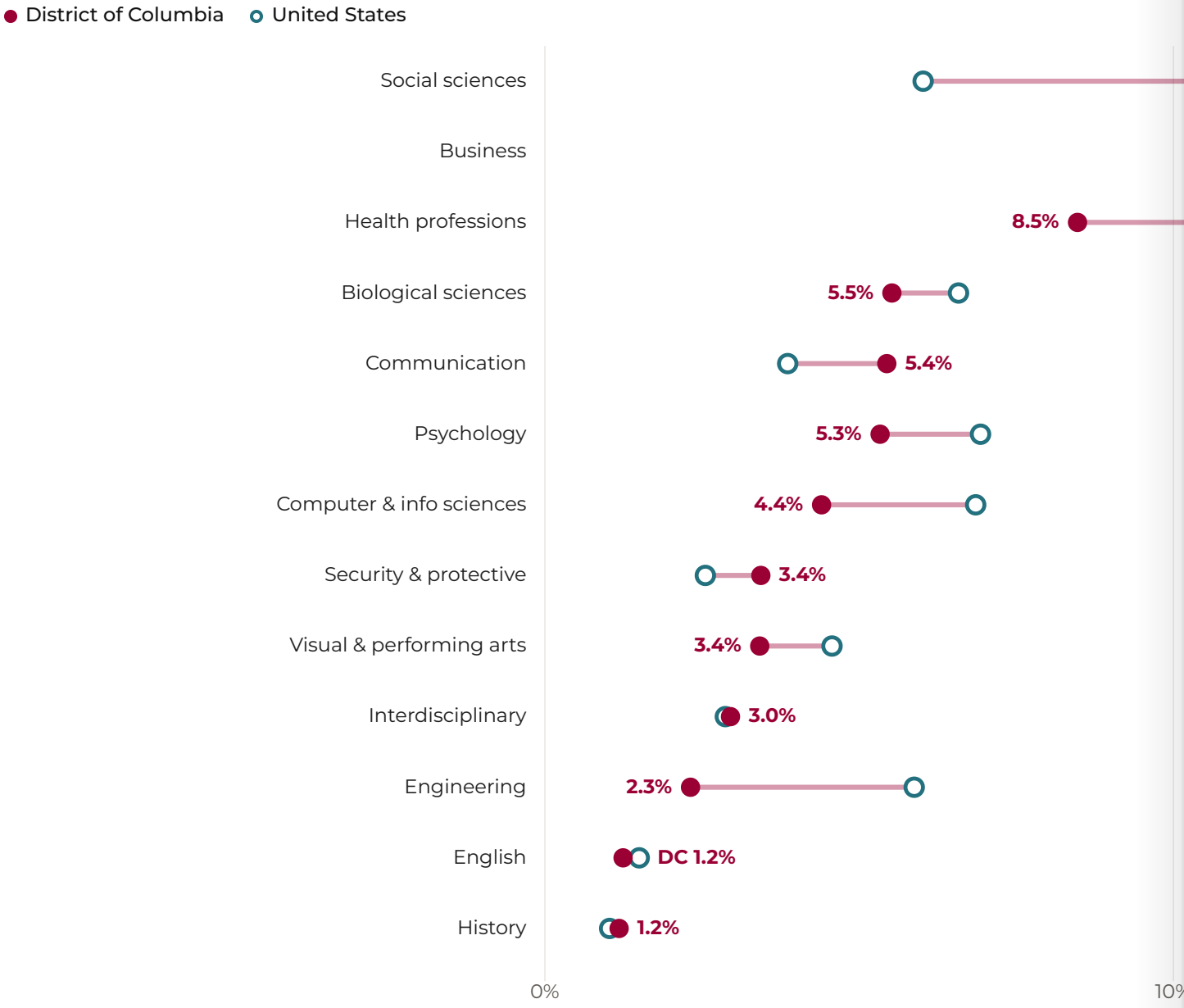
Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, the District of Columbia's institutions awarded 1.39K associate's degrees, 11.2K bachelor's degrees, 12K master's degrees, 877 research doctorate degrees, 2.9K professional doctorate degrees.



Since 2015: associate's up 88%; bachelor's up 21%; master's up 5%; research doctorate up 36%; professional doctorate up 6%. The state awards 19.1 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

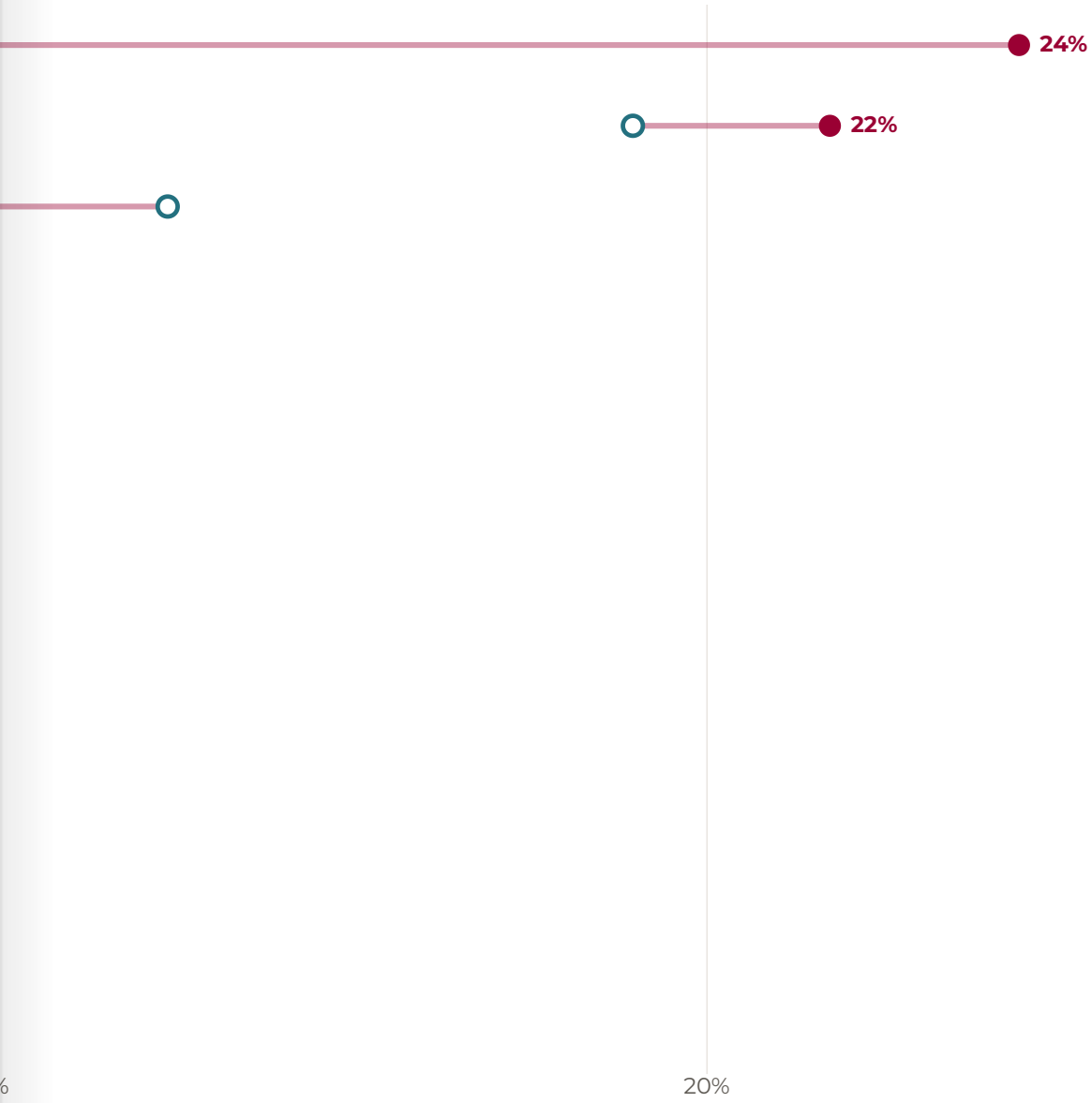
Figure 28 What Do the District of Columbia's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

The District of Columbia's largest bachelor's fields are social sciences (24%; U.S. 6.0%), business (22%; U.S. 19%), health professions (8.5%; U.S. 13%).

Relative to the nation, the District of Columbia's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in social sciences (4.04× the U.S. share), area & ethnic studies (3.37× the U.S. share), philosophy & religion (1.63× the U.S. share).



4.4%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **33rd** of 51 · +2.1 pp since 2015

2.3%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

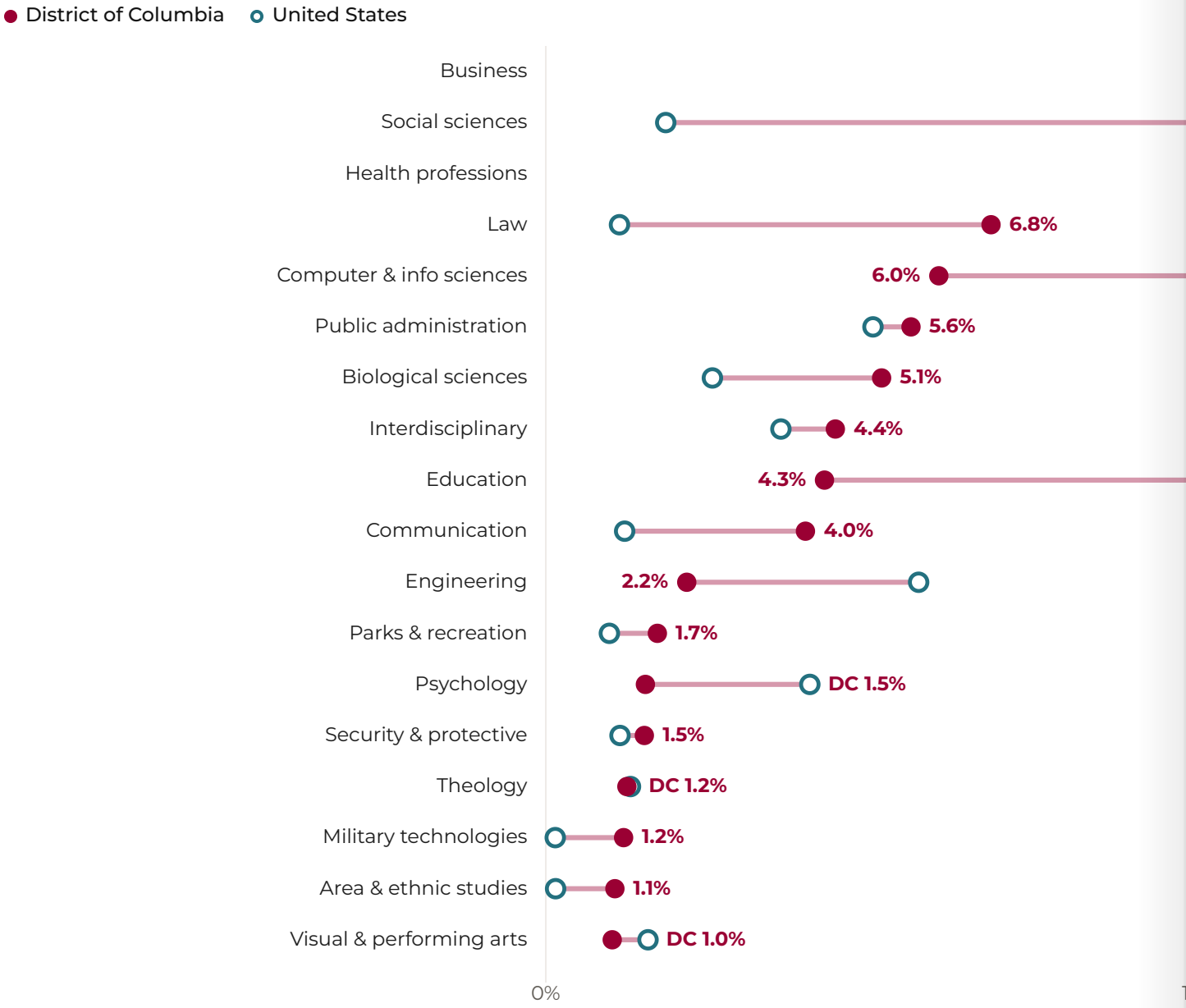
U.S. **6.8%** · **50th** of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2015

22%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **12th** of 51 · +2.8 pp since 2015

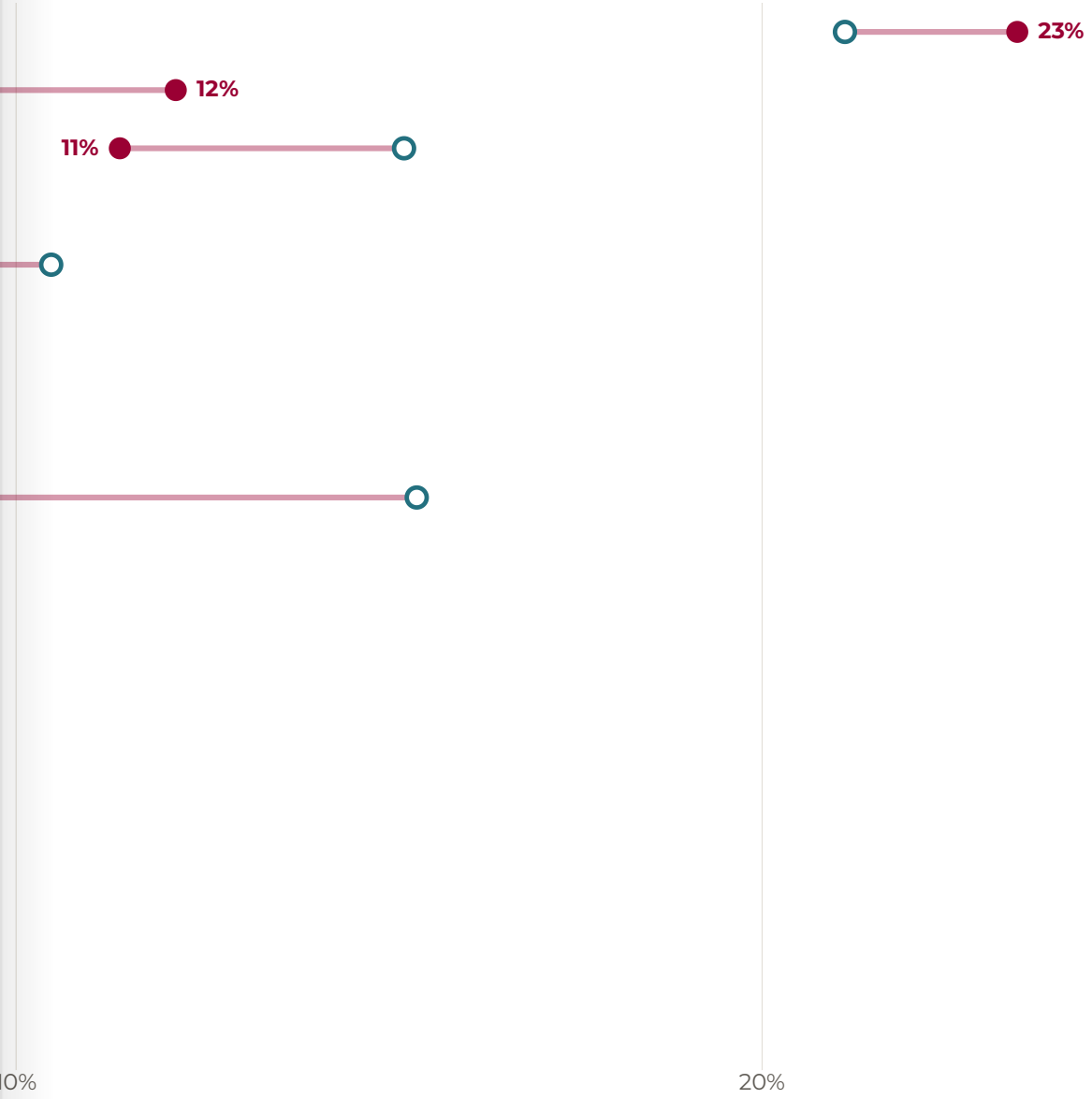
Figure 29 What Do the District of Columbia's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

The District of Columbia's largest master's fields are business (23%; U.S. 21%), social sciences (12%; U.S. 1.8%), health professions (11%; U.S. 15%).

International students earn 22% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 17% of them.



17%

STEM share of master's, 2025

U.S. **23%** · **37th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

22%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

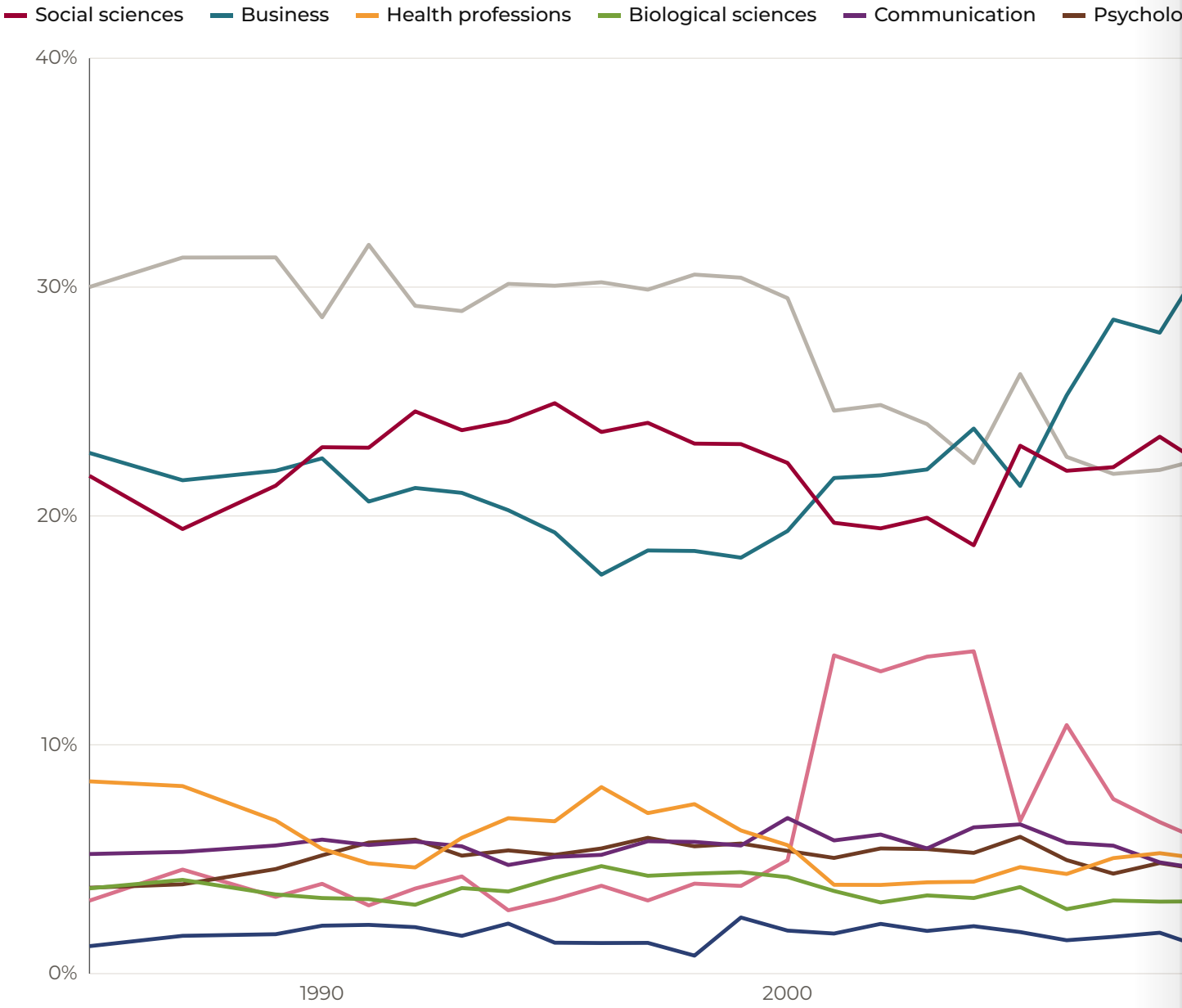
U.S. **22%** · **16th** of 51 · +2.1 pp since 2015

45%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

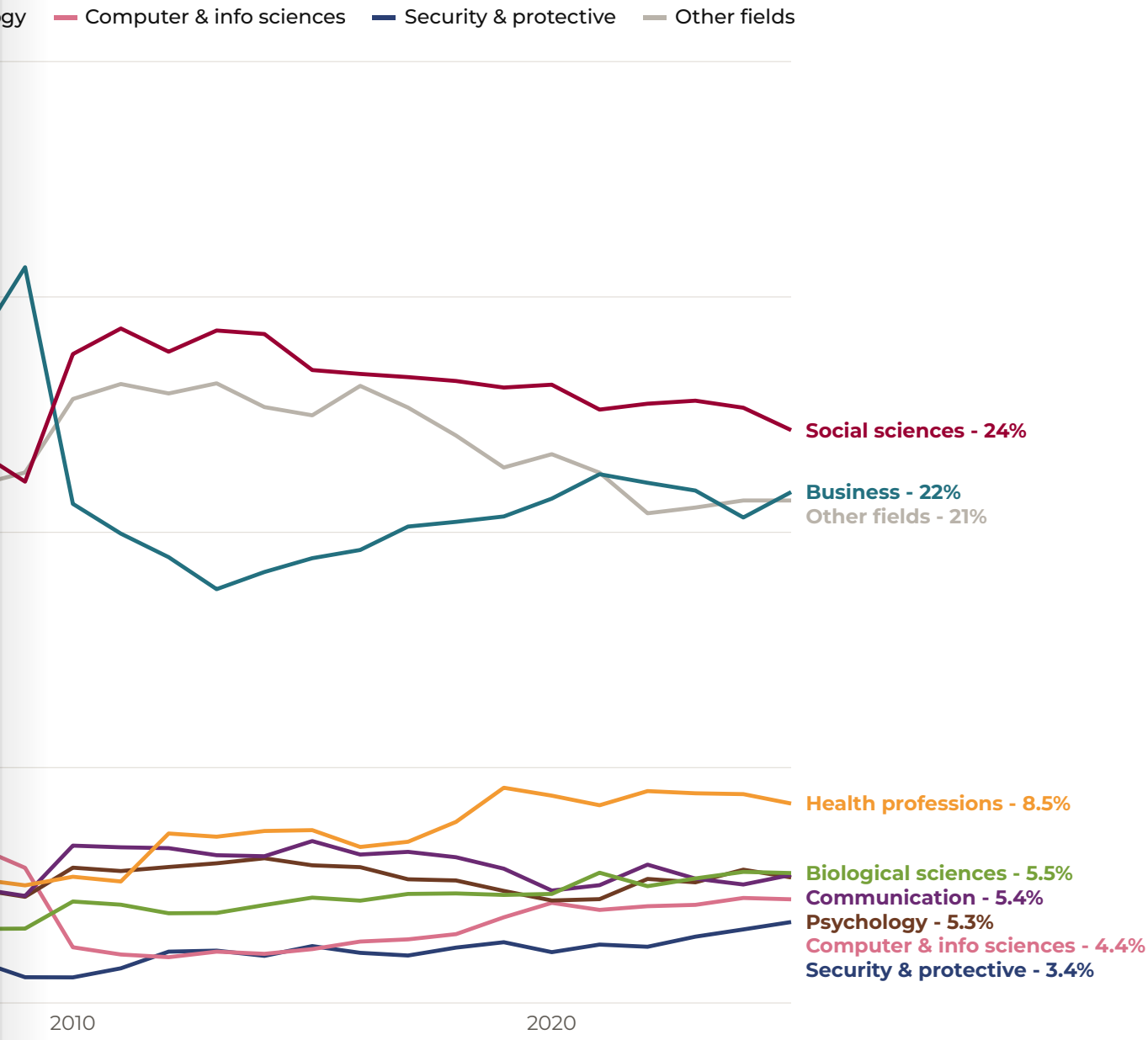
U.S. **65%** · **35th** of 47 · −3.6 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has the District of Columbia's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, business has gained the most ground, 2.8 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while social sciences lost the most (2.6 points).



The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is the District of Columbia Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of the District of Columbia's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Social sciences (4.04, with 24% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 6.0% for the U.S.), area & ethnic studies (3.37, with 1.0% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.3% for the U.S.), and philosophy & religion (1.63, with 0.9% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.6% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is the District of Columbia Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Social sciences	**4.04**	24%	6.0%	2.72K
Area & ethnic studies	**3.37**	1.0%	0.3%	110
Philosophy & religion	**1.63**	0.9%	0.6%	102
Communication	**1.41**	5.4%	3.9%	608
Security & protective	**1.35**	3.4%	2.6%	384
History	**1.15**	1.2%	1.0%	132
Business	**1.14**	22%	19%	2.43K
Interdisciplinary	**1.03**	3.0%	2.9%	330
Math & statistics	**0.91**	1.1%	1.2%	119
Biological sciences	**0.84**	5.5%	6.6%	617

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

16%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **51st** of 51

4.4%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **33rd** of 51

2.3%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **50th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. The share was 2.3% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 50th among the states, down 0.4 points from 2.7% in 2024 and down 0.5 points since 2015, when it was 2.8%.

Health professions. The share was 8.5% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 46th among the states, down 0.4 points from 8.9% in 2024 and up 1.1 points since 2015, when it was 7.3%.

Table 6 the District of Columbia at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	13%	16% 2024	**16% 2025**	+2.9 pp	24%	51st
Bachelor's in computer science	2.3%	4.5% 2024	**4.4% 2025**	+2.1 pp	6.9%	33rd
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	2.8%	2.7% 2024	**2.3% 2025**	−0.5 pp	6.8%	50th
Bachelor's in business	19%	21% 2024	**22% 2025**	+2.8 pp	19%	12th

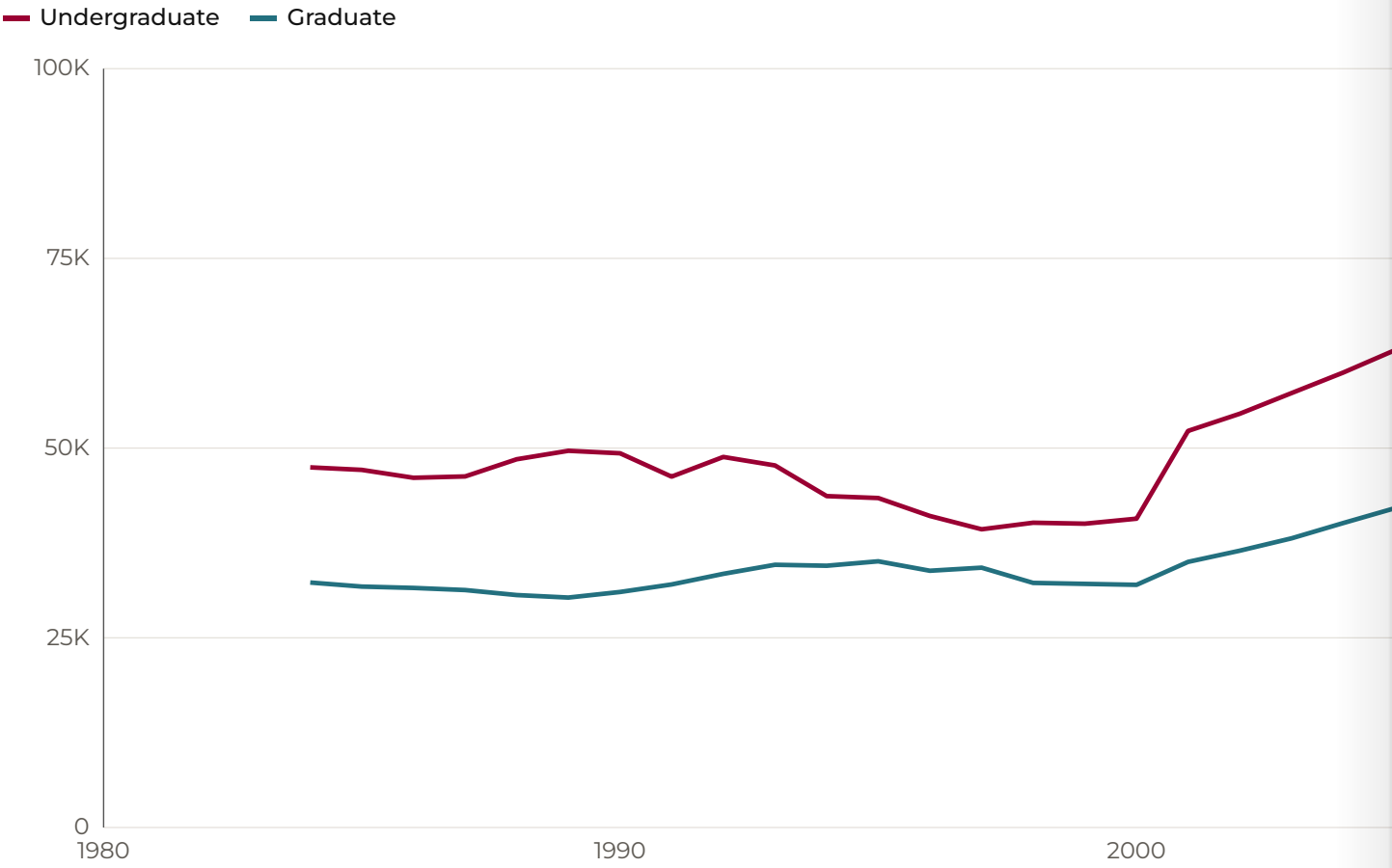
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

The District of Columbia ranks 1st of 51 on the share of students who are graduate students, at 42% in 2024 against 17% for the U.S.

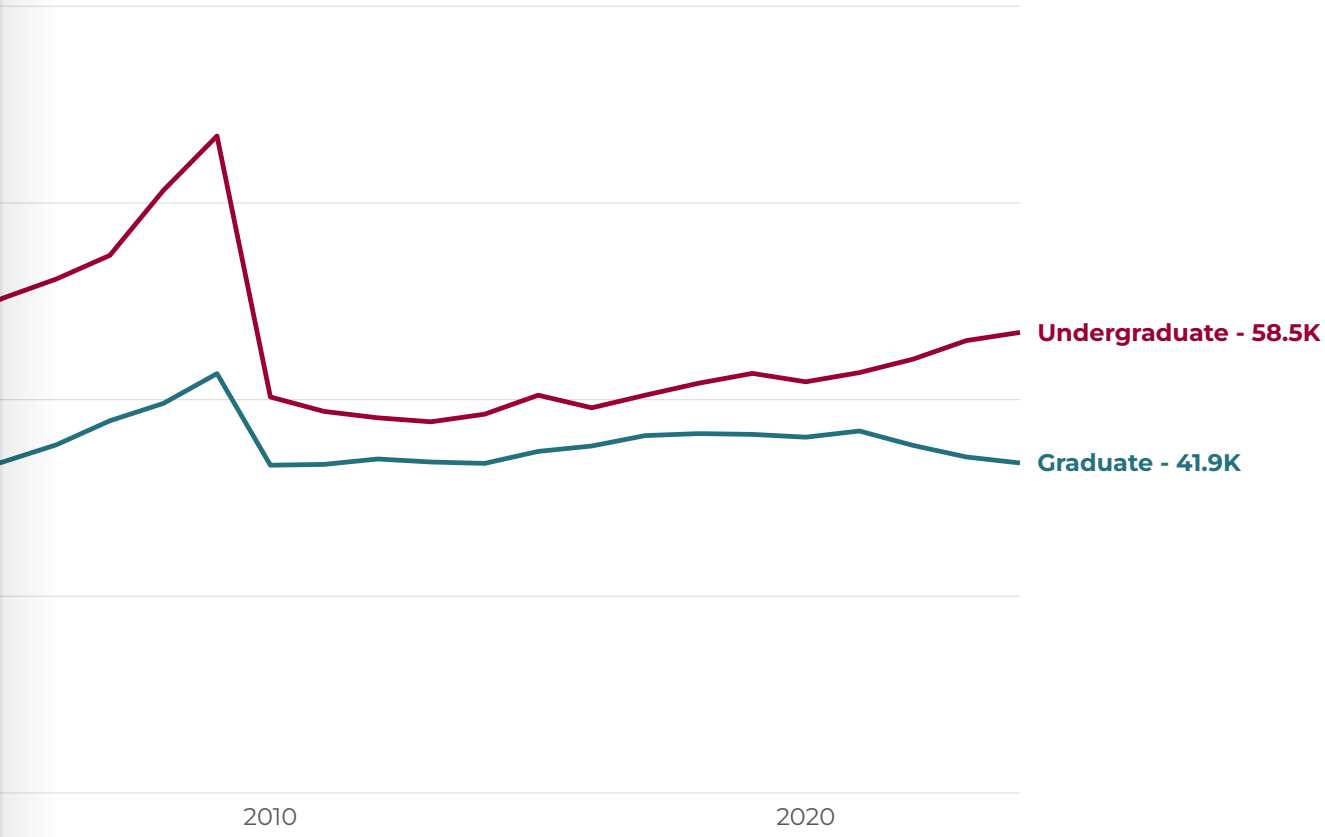
Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, the District of Columbia enrolled 58.5K undergraduates and 41.9K graduate students, 100K in all (41st of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is up 16% since 2015 and graduate enrollment down 3% since 2015. Graduate students are 42% of all students (U.S. 17%).



100K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **41st** of 51 · +6.9% since 2015

42%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **1st** of 51 · −4.5 pp since 2015

32%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **40th** of 51 · −0.4 pp since 2015

SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

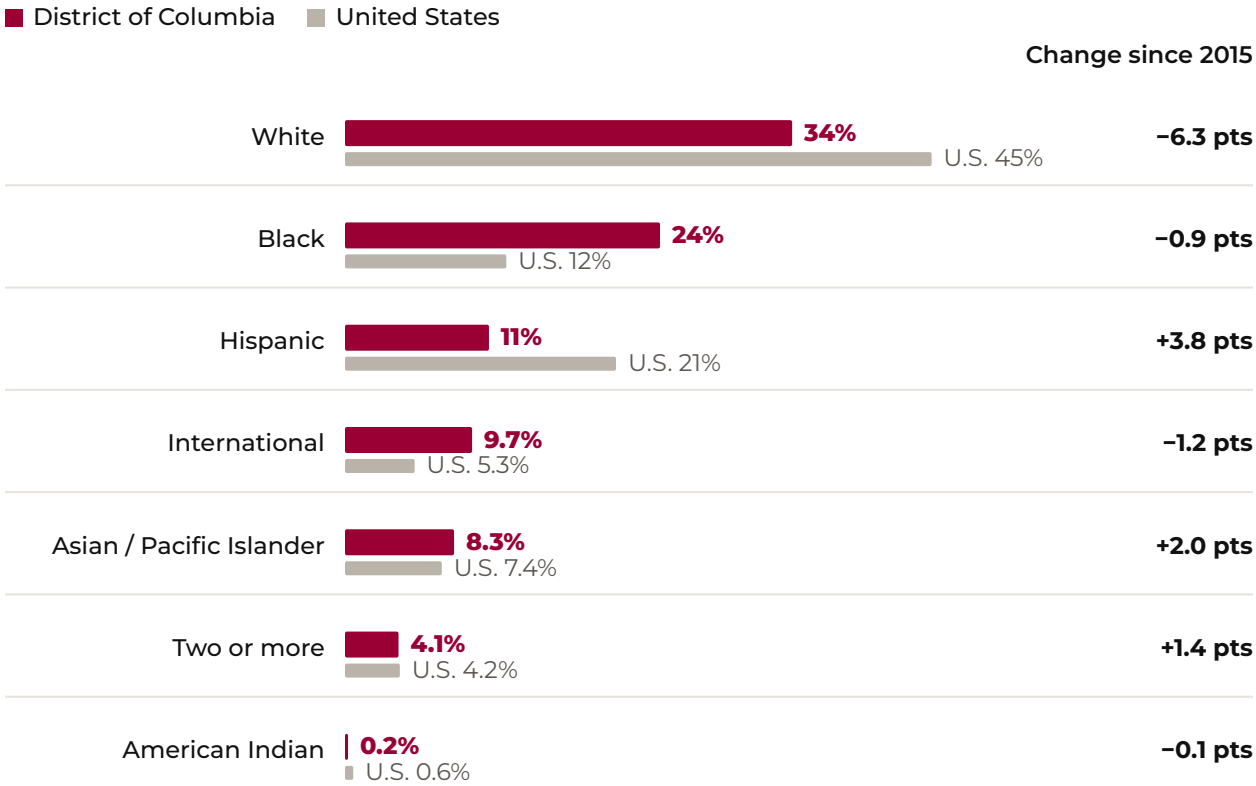
Who Enrolls in the District of Columbia, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at the District of Columbia's degree-granting institutions, **34%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 6.3 points since 2015.

Black students were **24%** (U.S. 12%), down 0.9 points since 2015, and Hispanic students were **11%** (U.S. 21%), up 3.8 points since 2015.

International students were **9.7%** (U.S. 5.3%), down 1.2 points since 2015, and Asian and Pacific Islander students were **8.3%** (U.S. 7.4%), up 2.0 points since 2015. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race.

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in the District of Columbia?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

34%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −6.3 pp since 2015

24%
Black students
U.S. **12%** · −0.9 pp since 2015

82%
At private nonprofit institutions
−2.4 pp since 2015

14%
At for-profit institutions
+3.6 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, private nonprofit institutions enrolled **82%** of students, down 2.4 points from 84% in 2015. For-profit institutions enrolled **14%** of students, up 3.6 points from 10% in 2015.

Public 4-year institutions enrolled **4.2%** of students, down 1.3 points from 5.4% in 2015, and public 2-year institutions enrolled none of the state's students.

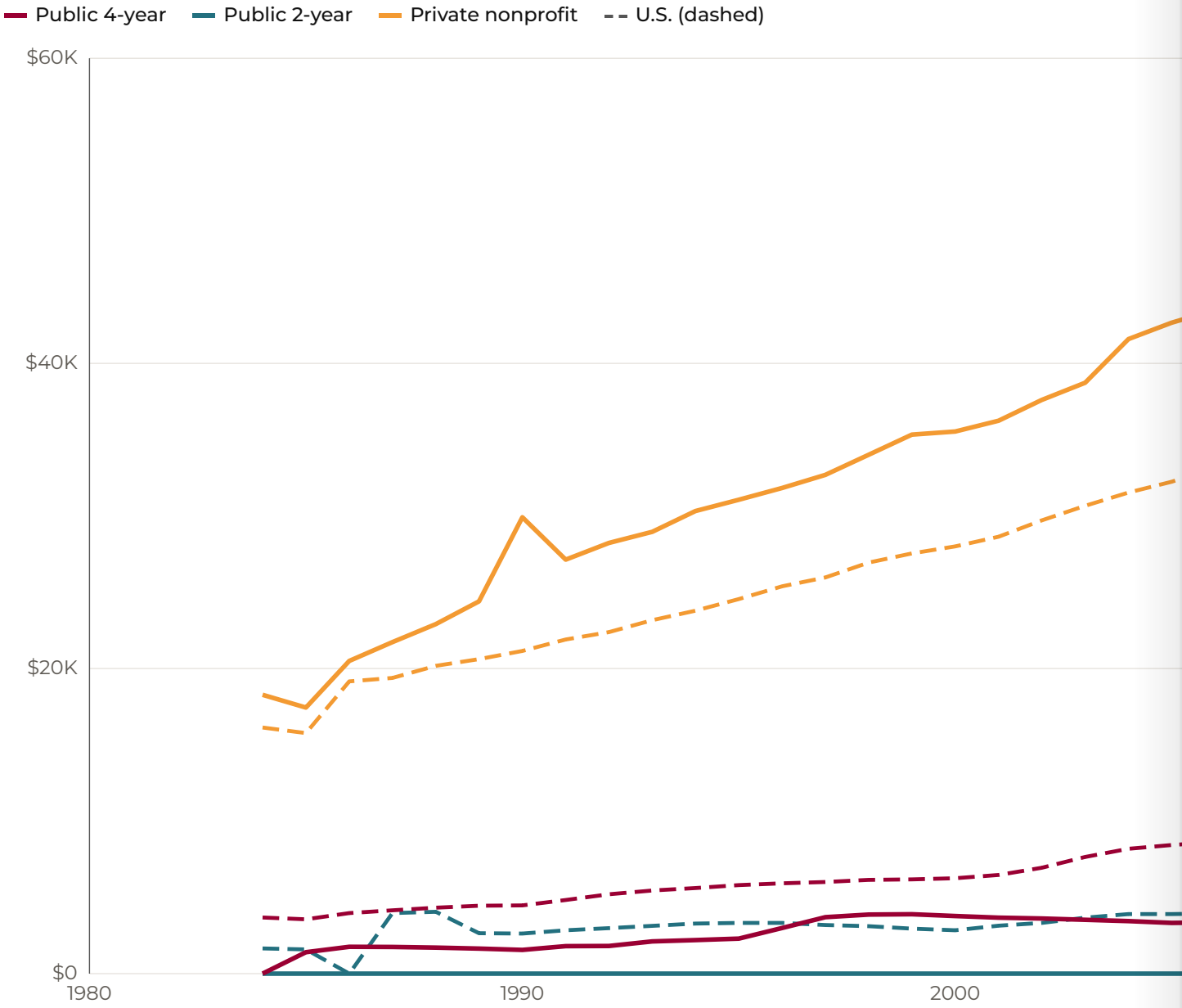
Public institutions together enrolled **4.2%** of students, against 73% nationally, 51st among the states.

Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

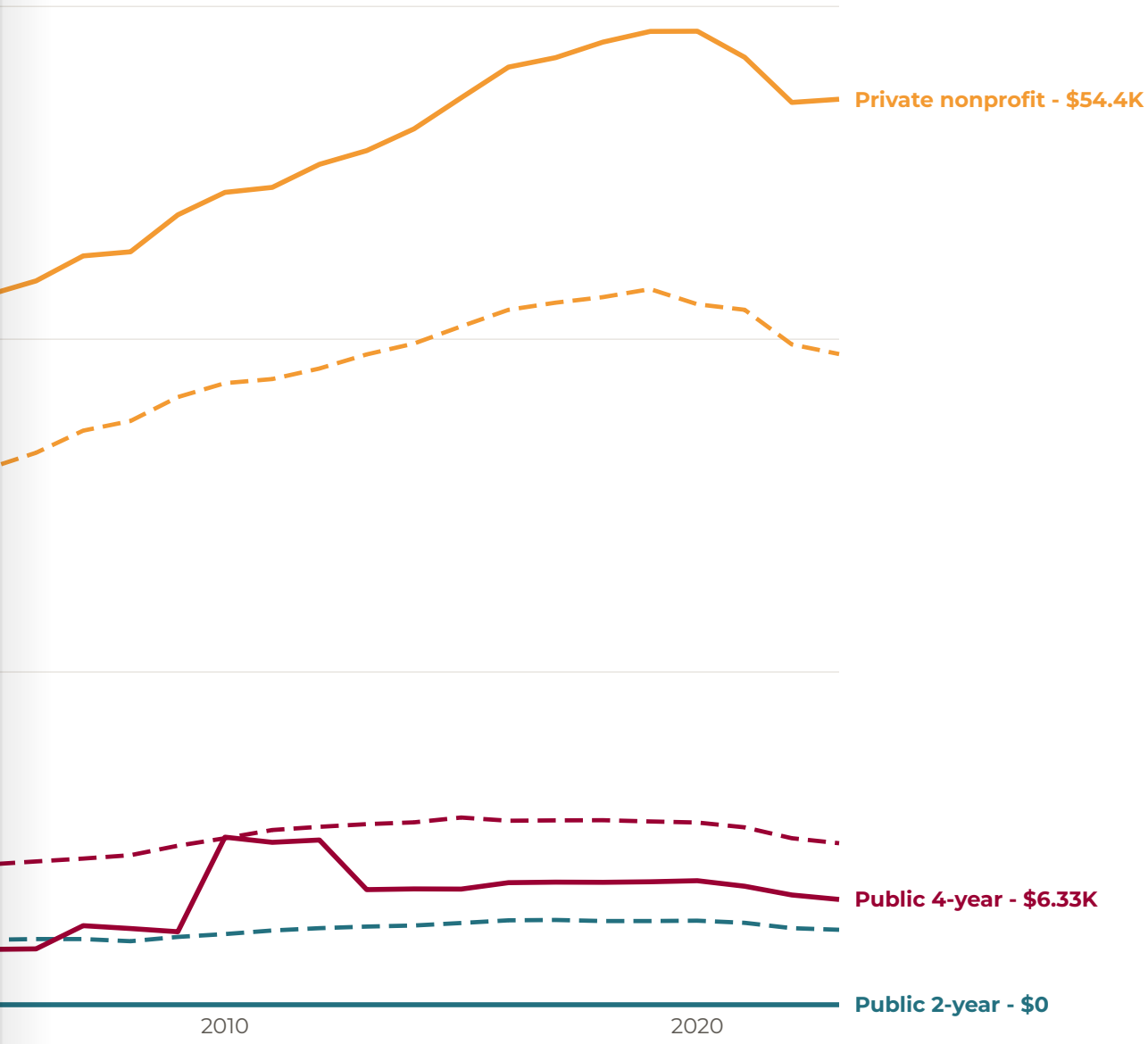
Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at the District of Columbia's public four-year institutions are $6.33K (2023, 2024 dollars), 35% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 49th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $44K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (1st of 51), and net tuition makes up 19% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).



$6.33K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **49th** of 51 · −8.9% since 2015

$44K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **1st** of 51 · +36% since 2015

19%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **50th** of 51 · −10.7 pp since 2015

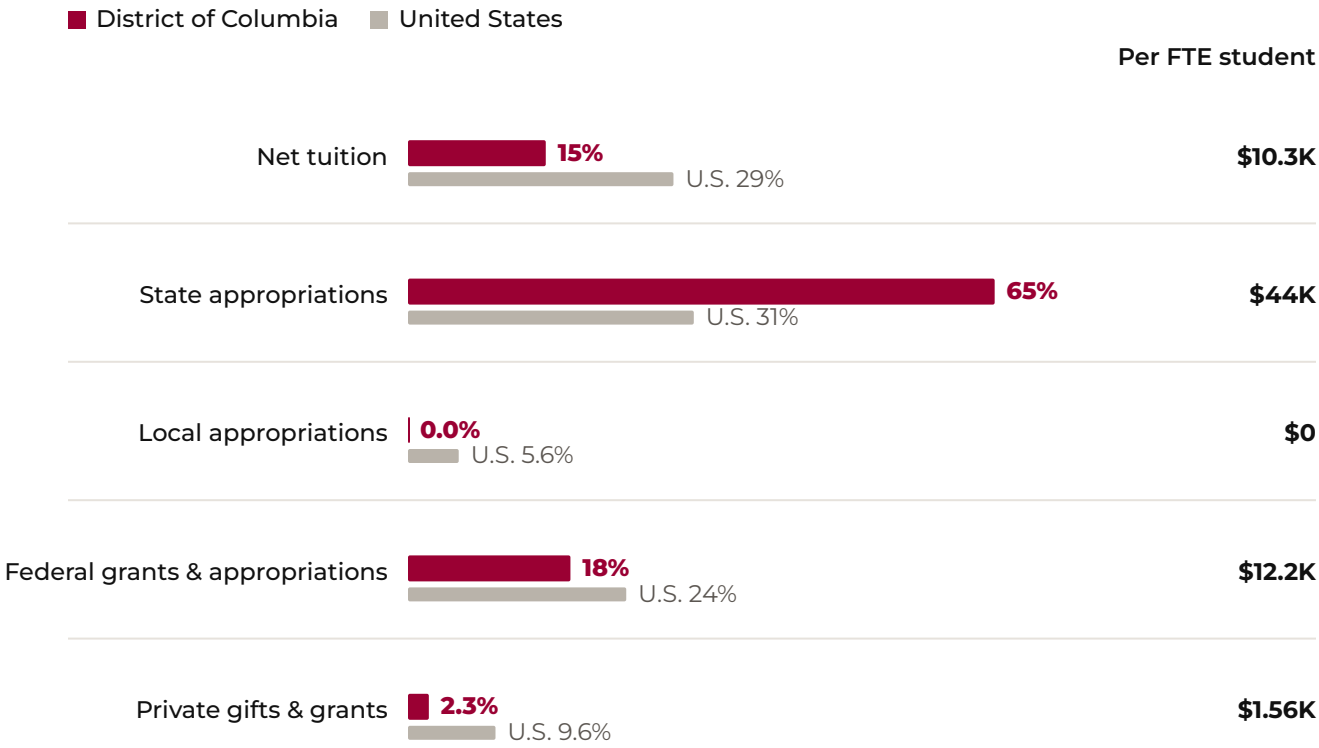
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are the District of Columbia's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of the District of Columbia's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $10.3K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 0.5% from $10.4K in FY2023 and down 24% since FY2015, when it was $13.7K.

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$6.33K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **49th** of 51

$44K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **1st** of 51

19%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **50th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in the District of Columbia: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $6.33K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 49th among the states, down 4.0% from $6.59K in 2022 and down 8.9% since 2015, when it was $6.95K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	District of Columbia	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$6.33K**	$9.71K	49th of 51	−8.9%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$44K**	$11.4K	1st of 51	+36%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**19%**	43%	50th of 51	−10.7 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**79%**	65%	1st of 51	+2.9 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$132K**	$106K	5th of 51	−5.2%

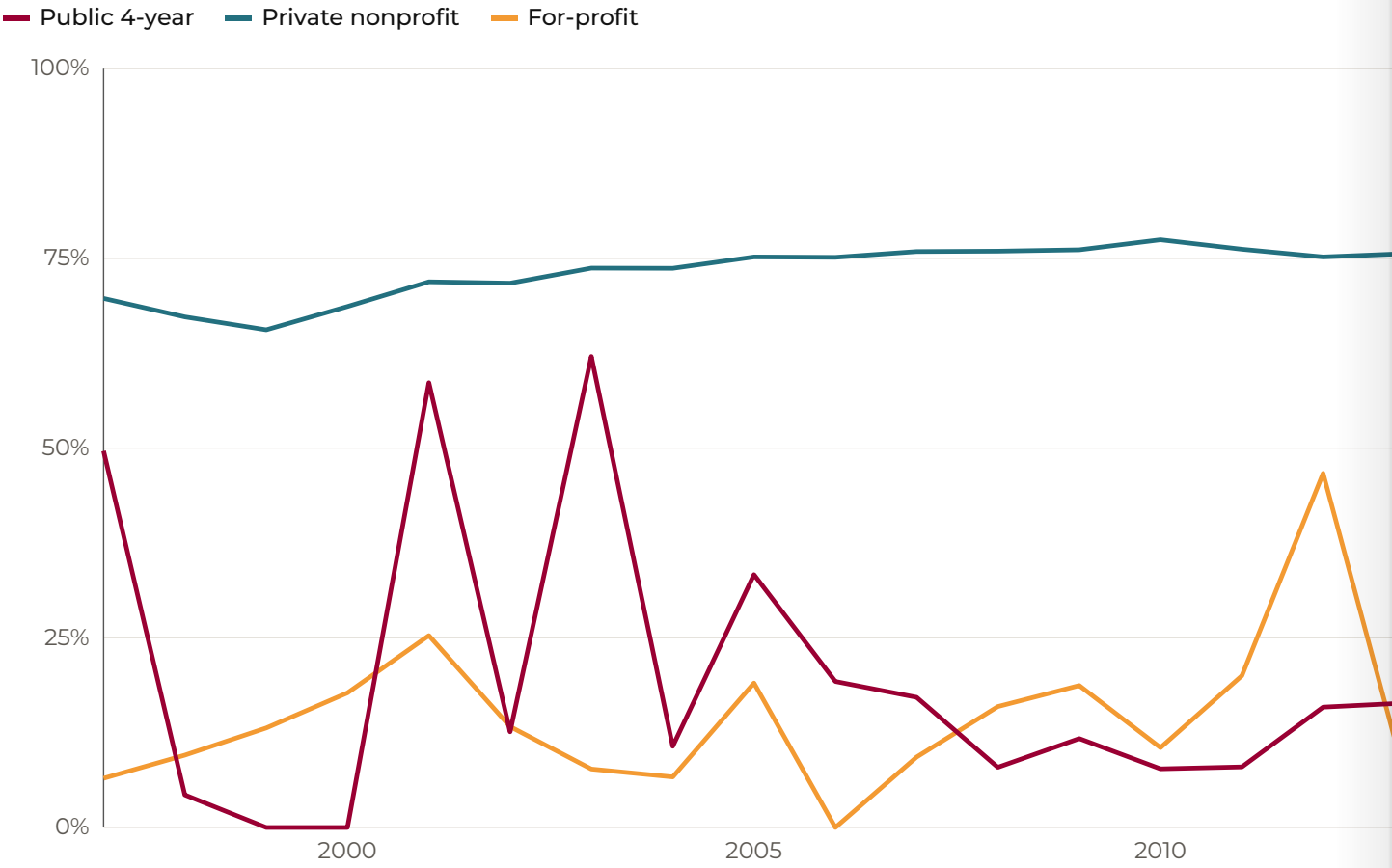
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

The District of Columbia ranks 1st of 51 on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 79% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

79% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in the District of Columbia graduated within six years (2024), 14.0 points above the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 1st of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 44%, private nonprofit 80%, for-profit 19%. At two-year institutions, 70% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).



79%

Six-year graduation rate, 2024

U.S. **65%** · **1st** of 51 · +2.9 pp since 2015

70%

Two-year completion rate, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **1st** of 50 · +8.7 pp since 2016

19.1

Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025

U.S. **12.3** · **1st** of 51 · −0.2 since 2015

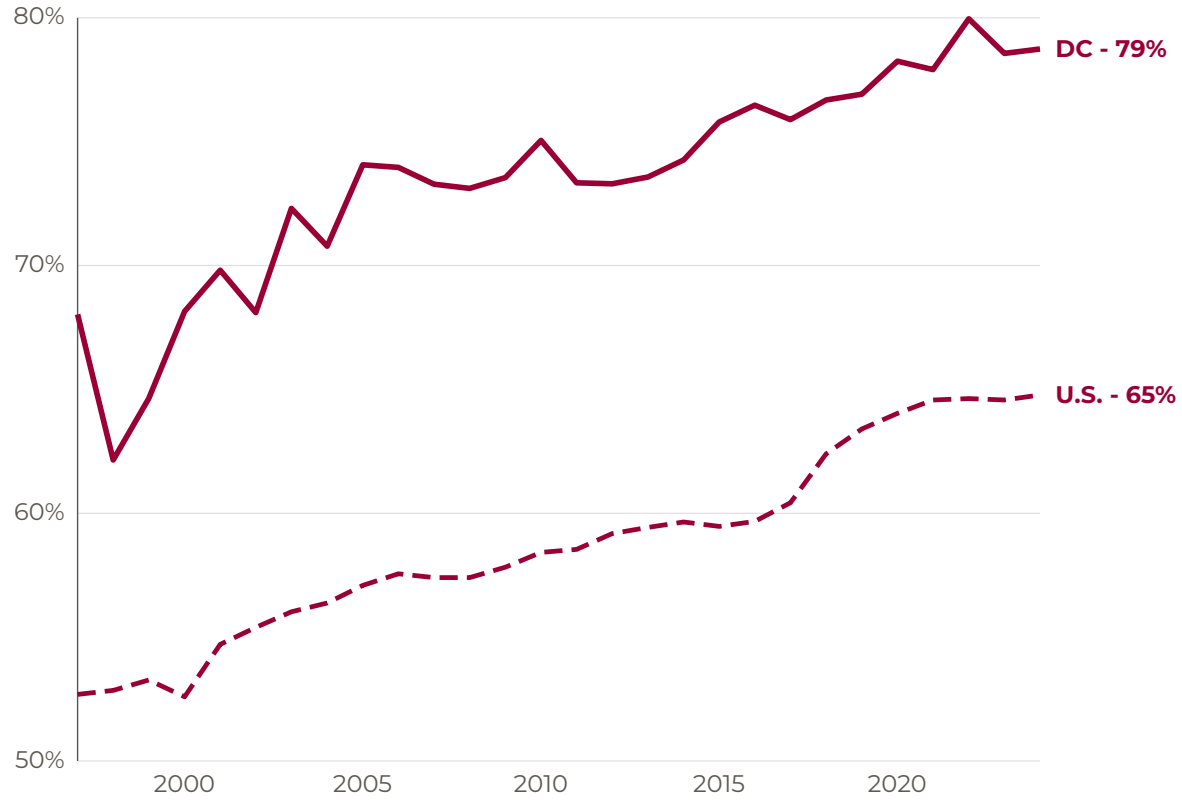
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of the District of Columbia's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at the District of Columbia's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (32% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 79% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., up 0.2 points from 79% in 2023 and up 2.9 points since 2015, when it was 76%.

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

79%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **1st** of 51

70%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **1st** of 50

19.1
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **1st** of 51

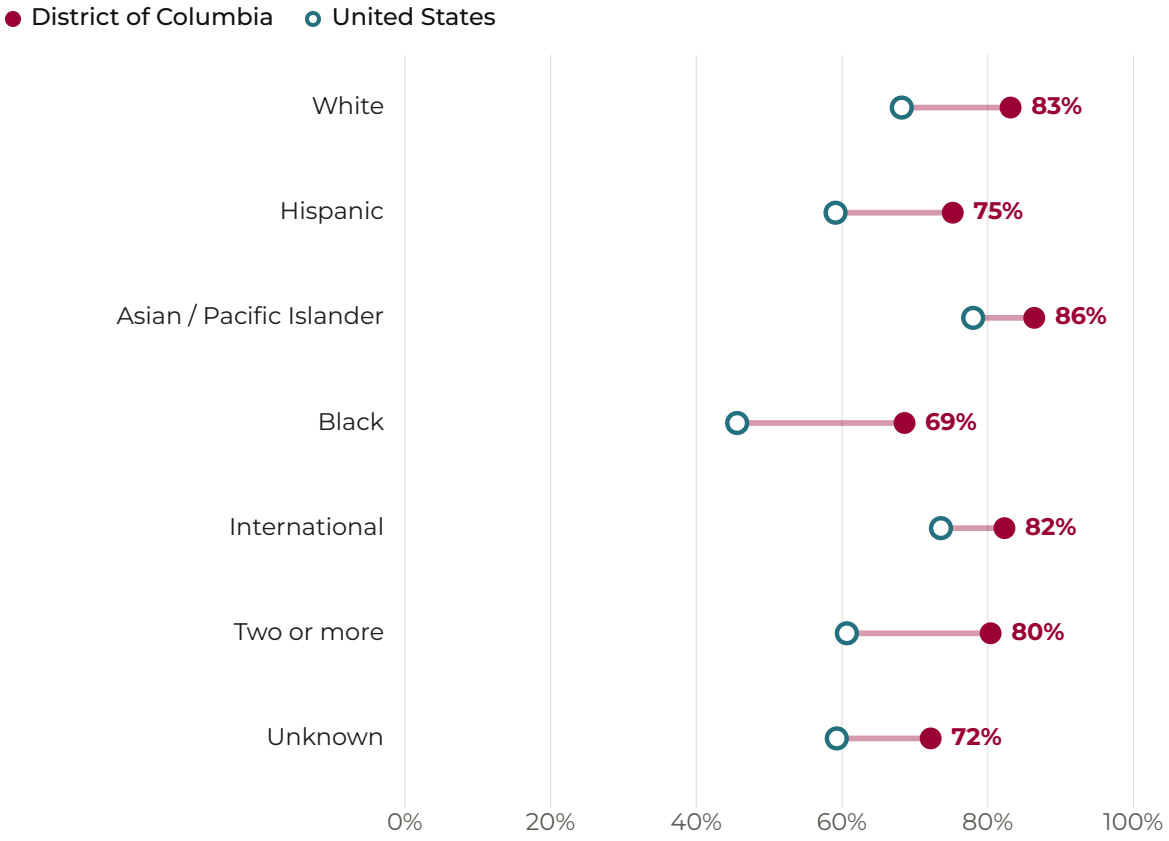
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at the District of Columbia's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 83% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 75% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 86% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



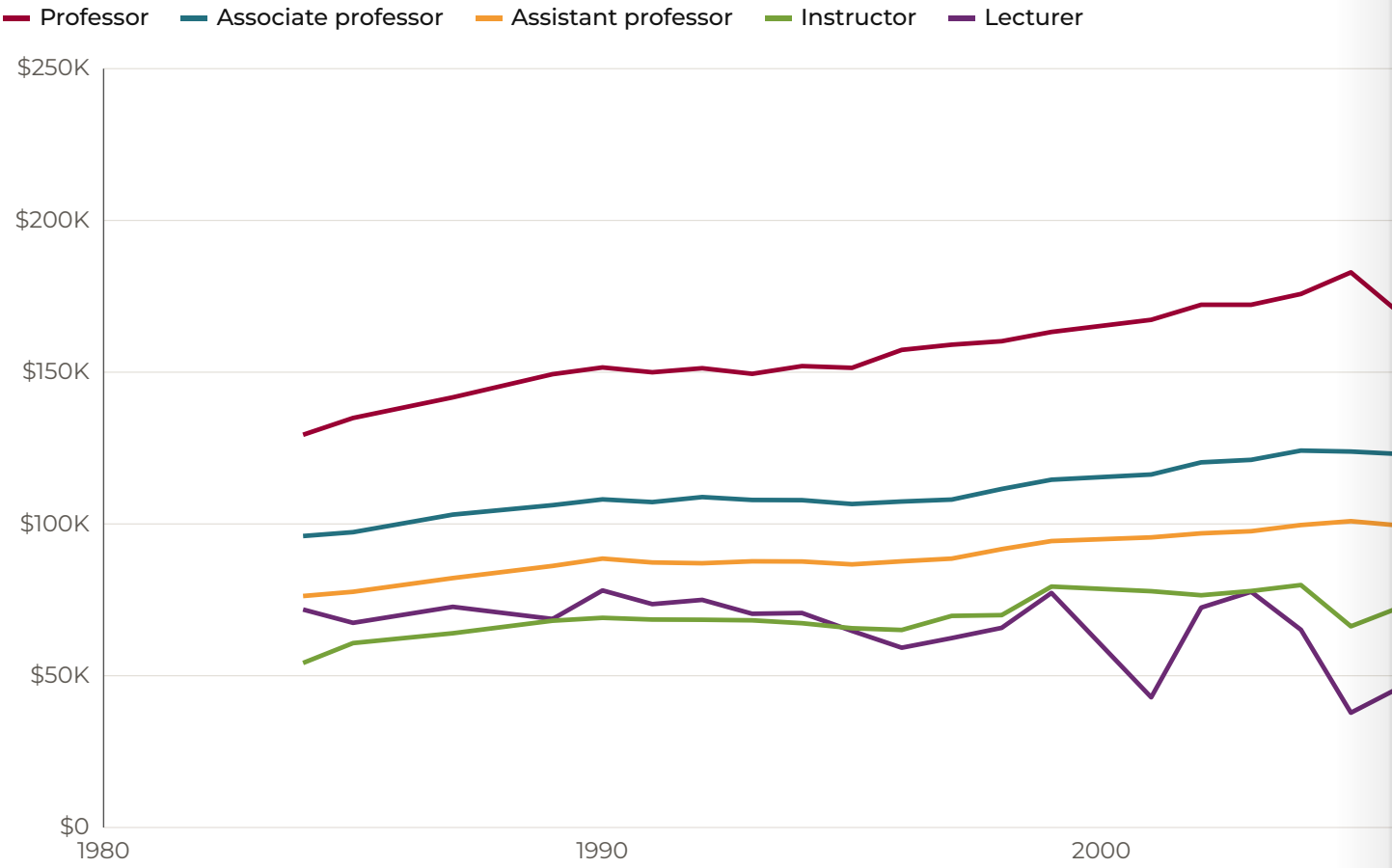
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

The District of Columbia ranks 5th of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $132K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

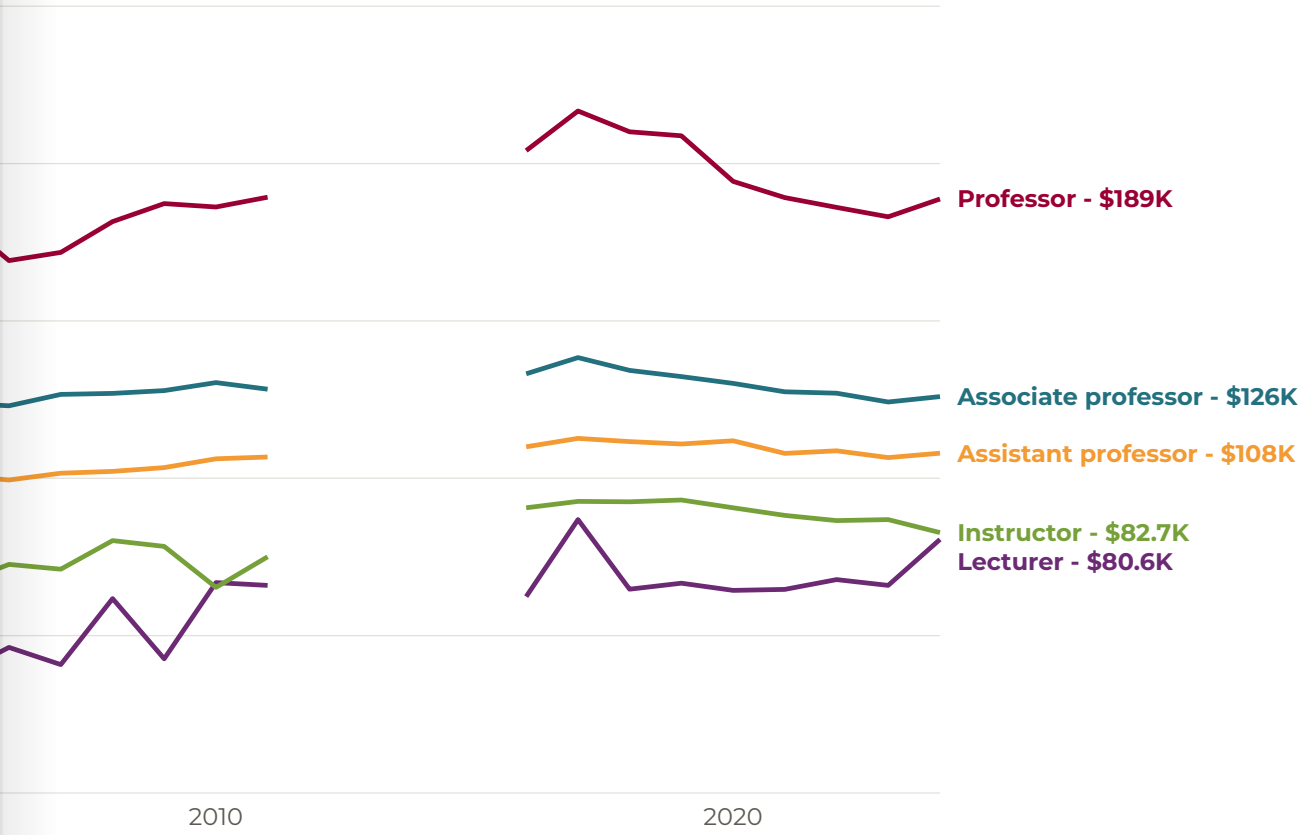
Figure 39 What Do the District of Columbia's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data fro

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at the District of Columbia's institutions earned an average of $132K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 25% above the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 5th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $189K, associate professors $126K, assistant professors $108K, instructors $82.7K, lecturers $80.6K.

The District of Columbia's institutions had 5.53K full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 2% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 5% since 2016.



m NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

$132K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **5th** of 51 · −5.2% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

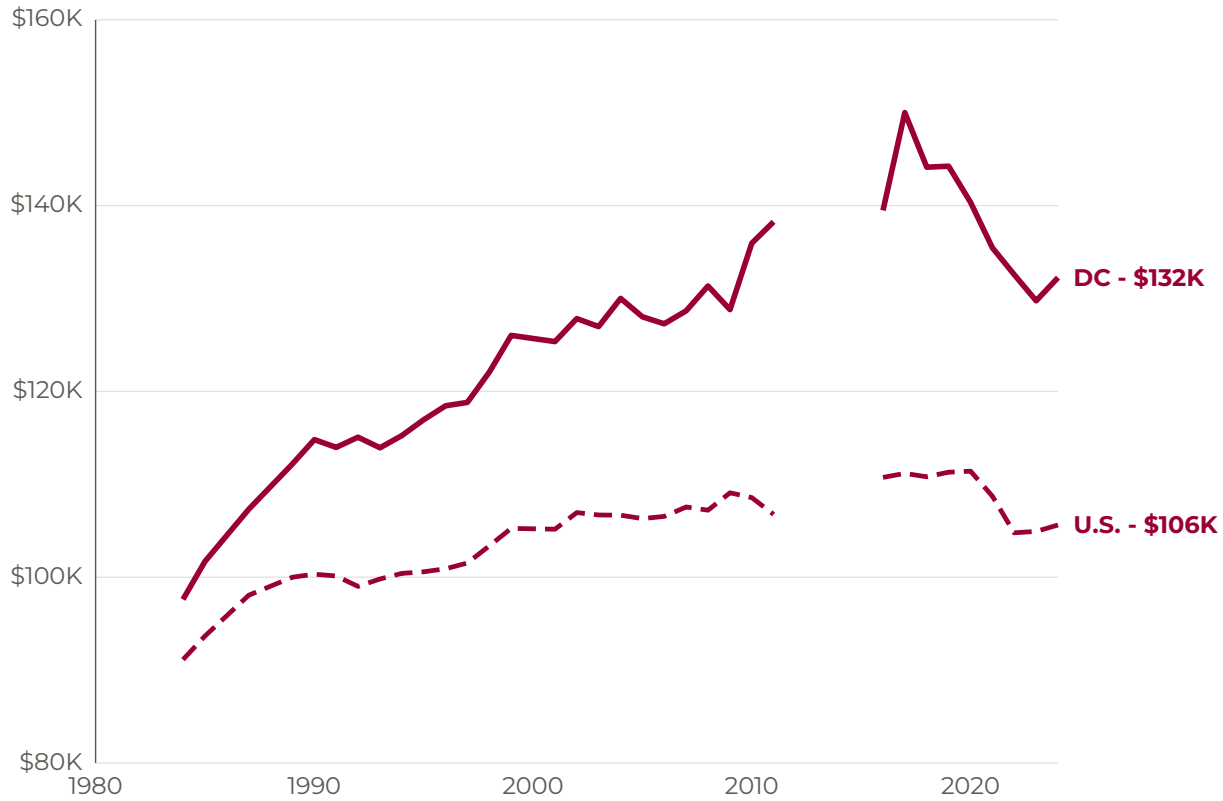
What Do the District of Columbia's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at the District of Columbia's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $132K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 5th among the states, up 1.9% from $130K in 2023 and down 5.2% since 2016, when it was $139K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 5.53K in 2024, down 0.7% from 5.56K in 2023 and down 2.3% since 2015, when it was 5.65K.

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$132K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **5th** of 51

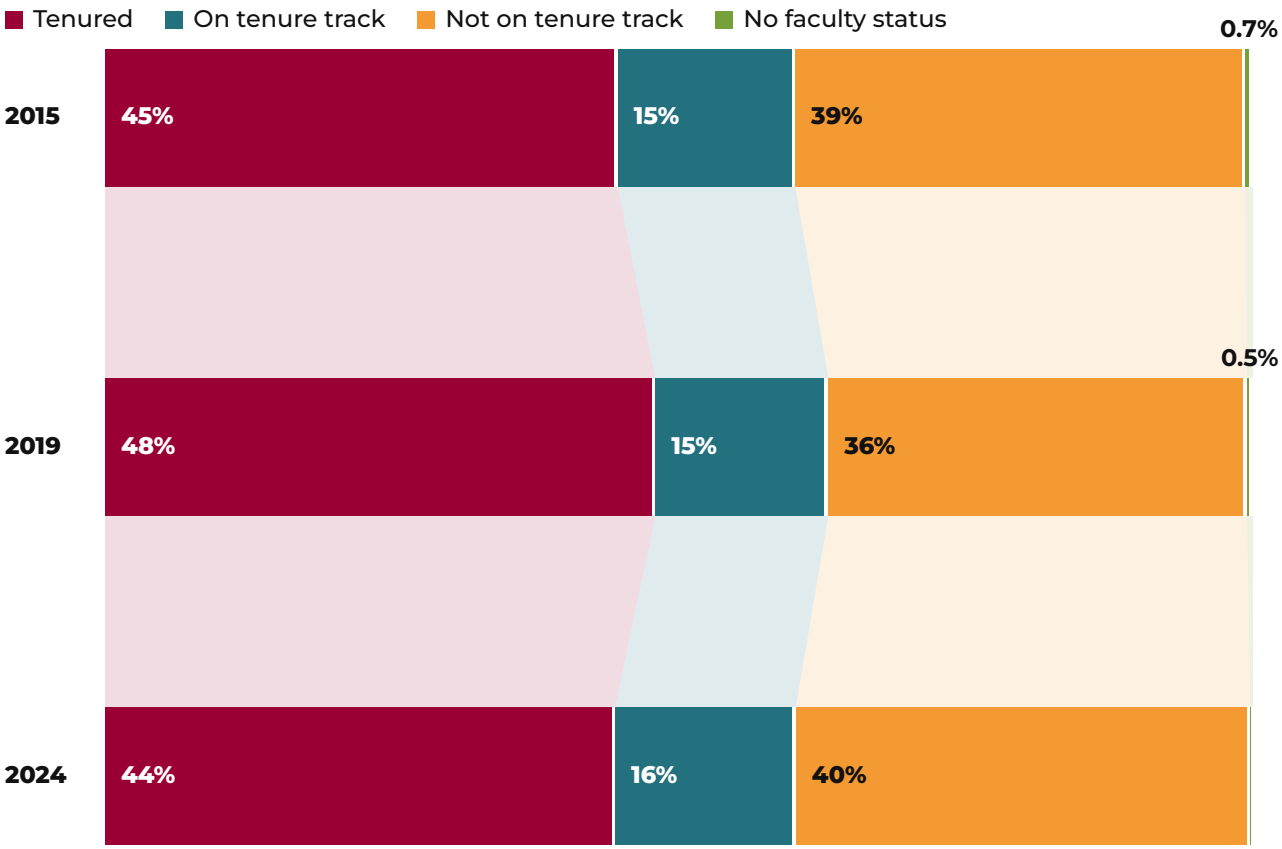
5.53K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

44%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide the District of Columbia's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 44% in 2024, up 0.6 points from 44% in 2023 and down 0.2 points since 2015, when it was 45%.

Figure 41 Tenure Status



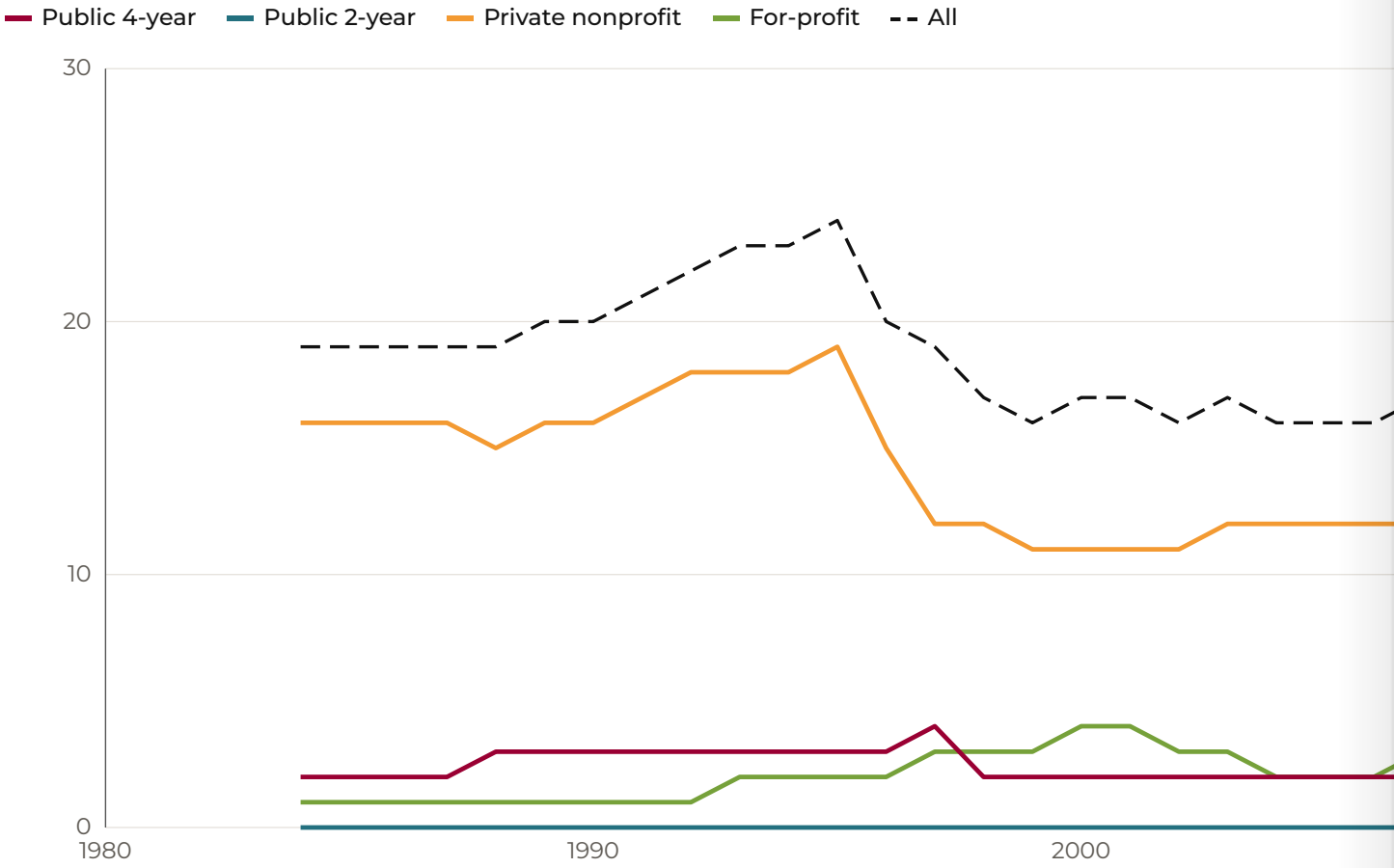
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

The District of Columbia ranks 51st of 51 on the share of enrollment at public institutions, at 4.2% in 2024 against 73% for the U.S.

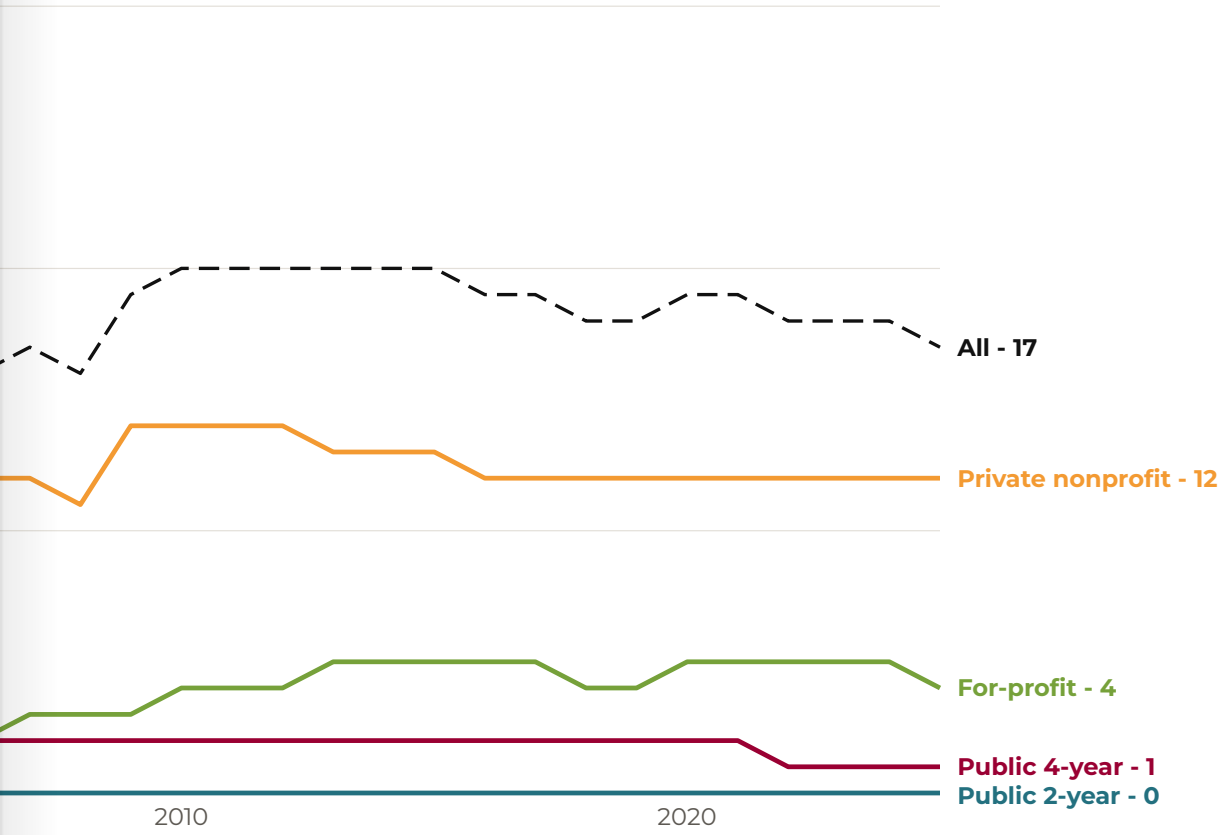
Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does the District of Columbia Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

The District of Columbia has 17 degree-granting institutions:1 public 4-year, 0 public 2-year, 12 private nonprofit, 4 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 15% since 2015. 4.2% of students attend public institutions and 14% attend for-profit ones.



4.2%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **51st** of 51 · −1.3 pp since 2015

14%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **4th** of 51 · +3.6 pp since 2015

23%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **29th** of 51 · +8.6 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in the District of Columbia?

The table ranks institutions in the District of Columbia by the STEM master's degrees and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025, the two counted together. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

Largest. George Washington University (429 international STEM master's degrees and 45 doctorates), Georgetown University (140 international STEM master's degrees and 17 doctorates), and The Catholic University of America (41 international STEM master's degrees and 10 doctorates) awarded the most.

Table 8 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM total	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
George Washington University Washington · Private nonprofit	**474**	429	41%	45	35%
Georgetown University Washington · Private nonprofit	**157**	140	21%	17	35%
The Catholic University of America Washington · Private nonprofit	**51**	41	40%	10	40%
American University Washington · Private nonprofit	**31**	31	38%	–	–%
Howard University Washington · Private nonprofit	**13**	3	9.4%	10	53%
University of the District of Columbia Washington · Public 4-year	**10**	10	37%	–	–
Gallaudet University Washington · Private nonprofit	**2**	2	33%	–	–%

Ranked by the total (shaded) of international STEM master's degrees and research doctorates. Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

17
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

4.2%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **51st** of 51

14%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **4th** of 51

23%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **29th** of 51

The table lists the District of Columbia's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were George Washington University (25.4K students), Georgetown University (20K students), and Howard University (14.9K students).

Table 9 What Are the District of Columbia's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
George Washington University	**25.4K**	20%	429	84%	47%
Georgetown University	**20K**	18%	245	95%	13%
Howard University	**14.9K**	5.9%	499	70%	41%
American University	**12.3K**	13%	215	75%	62%
Strayer University-Global Region	**12.1K**	0.3%	145	–	–
The Catholic University of America	**5.24K**	25%	128	79%	83%
University of the District of Columbia	**4.2K**	7.3%	63	44%	–
Trinity Washington University	**1.95K**	0.7%	12	49%	100%
Gallaudet University	**1.33K**	5.7%	20	47%	58%
University of the Potomac-Washington DC Campus	**1.24K**	19%	1	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

The District of Columbia – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	263	**262**[2024]	−1.5 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#49	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	19%	**20%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#45	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	231	**231**[2024]	−0.7 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#47	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	31%	**33%**[2024]	+2.1 pp ▲	39%	0.0 pp	#44	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	248	**251**[2024]	+3.6 ▲	257	−7.3 ▼	#45	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	19%	**25%**[2024]	+6.2 pp ▲	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#43	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	212	**209**[2024]	−3.1 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#44	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**112**[2011]	–	151	–	#51	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$27K	**$29.5K**[2021]	+9.6% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#2	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	69%	**76%**[2022]	+7.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#49	[3]
Public high school graduates	3.76K	**4.13K**[2024]	+9.7% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#51	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$98.7K	**$90.6K**[2022]	−8.3% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#4	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	12.4	**11.3**[2022]	−1.1 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#50	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	84K	**94.2K**[2024]	+12% ▲	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#49	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	92%	**50%**[2023]	−42.7 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#25	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	7.2%	**11%**[2022]	+4.1 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#9	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	43%	**45%**[2023]	+2.6 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#1	[3]
High schools offering calculus	48%[2016]	**41%**[2024]	−7.5 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#37	[14]
High schools offering physics	97%[2016]	**95%**[2024]	−2.1 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#1	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	100%[2016]	**100%**[2024]	0.0 pp	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#1	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	100%[2016]	**97%**[2024]	−2.6 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#5	[14]
High schools offering computer science	26%[2021]	**67%**[2024]	+40.4 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#19	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	85%[2016]	**82%**[2024]	−2.8 pp ▼	56%	0.0 pp	#4	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	29%[2021]	**44%**[2024]	+14.6 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#8	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	18%[2016]	**85%[2024]**	+66.4 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#12	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	22.4[2016]	**23.2[2024]**	+0.8 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#5	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	3.1[2016]	**3.9[2024]**	+0.8 ▲	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#12	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	17.7[2016]	**16.3[2024]**	−1.4 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#6	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	28.8[2016]	**28.7[2024]**	−0.2 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#6	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	0.0[2016]	**0.0[2024]**	0.0	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#50	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	31%	**31%[2025]**	+0.1 pp ▲	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#37	[15]
Fall enrollment	94K	**100K[2024]**	+6.9% ▲	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#41	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	5.4%	**4.2%[2024]**	−1.3 pp ▼	73%	0.0 pp	#51	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	10%	**14%[2024]**	+3.6 pp ▲	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#4	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	32%	**32%[2024]**	−0.4 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#40	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	46%	**42%[2024]**	−4.5 pp ▼	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#1	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	15%	**23%[2024]**	+8.6 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#29	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	576	**525[2025]**	−8.9% ▼	59K	+7.3% ▲	#29	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	361	**333[2025]**	−7.8% ▼	44.4K	+14% ▲	#32	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	1.0%	**0.9%[2025]**	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#29	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	67	**42[2025]**	−37% ▼	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#40	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	15	**26[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#34	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	10.6	**8.8[2025]**	−1.7 ▼	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#7	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	13%	**16%[2025]**	+2.9 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#51	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	2.3%	**4.4%[2025]**	+2.1 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	2.8%	**2.3%[2025]**	−0.5 pp ▼	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	1.0%	**1.1%[2025]**	+0.1 pp ▲	1.2%	0.0 pp	#19	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	4.5%	**5.5%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#38	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	0.9%	**1.0%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#40	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	7.3%	**8.5%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#46	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	19%	**22%**[2025]	+2.8 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#12	[4]
STEM share of master's	16%	**17%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#37	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	3.6%	**6.0%**[2025]	+2.4 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	4.4%	**3.0%**[2025]	−1.4 pp ▼	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#42	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	1.5%	**0.8%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#31	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	4.9%	**5.1%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#2	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	0.2%	**0.3%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#49	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	10%	**11%**[2025]	+1.2 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#41	[4]
Share of master's in business	22%	**23%**[2025]	+1.7 pp ▲	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#16	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	26%	**26%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#45	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	1.4%	**2.1%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#36	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	10%	**11%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#34	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	0.8%	**1.1%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#39	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	9.3%	**7.6%**[2025]	−1.7 pp ▼	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#42	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	4.5%	**4.2%**[2025]	−0.3 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#44	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	3.0%	**23%**[2025]	+20.5 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#7	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	5.4%	**3.1%**[2025]	−2.4 pp ▼	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#30	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	19.3	**19.1**[2025]	−0.2 ▼	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#1	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	7.2%[2016]	**5.3%**[2024]	−1.9 pp ▼	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#6	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	646	**656**[2025]	+1.5% ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#29	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	1.2%	**0.6%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	–	–	#29	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	7.7%	**5.6%**[2024]	−2.2 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#5	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	14%	**15%**[2024]	+1.0 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#22	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	5.5%	**6.8%**[2025]	+1.2 pp ▲	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#4	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	6.0%	**8.0%**[2025]	+2.0 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#10	[4]
International share of all master's	20%	**22%**[2025]	+2.1 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#16	[4]
International share of STEM master's	36%	**33%**[2025]	−3.2 pp ▼	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#38	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	49%	**45%**[2025]	−3.6 pp ▼	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#35	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	28%	**31%**[2025]	+2.2 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#38	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	73%	**75%**[2025]	+1.9 pp ▲	55%	+6.1 pp ▲	#2	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	26%	**16%**[2025]	−9.7 pp ▼	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#30	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	29%[2016]	**45%**[2025]	+16.2 pp ▲	33%	+3.5 pp ▲	#6	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	18%	**21%**[2025]	+2.9 pp ▲	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#36	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	32%	**36%**[2025]	+3.9 pp ▲	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#37	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	34%	**32%**[2025]	−2.4 pp ▼	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#42	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	17%	**31%**[2025]	+14.7 pp ▲	23%	−4.3 pp ▼	#6	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	21%[2016]	**35%**[2025]	+13.9 pp ▲	38%	−1.5 pp ▼	#25	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	12K	**11.2K**[2026]	−6.4% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#25	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	1.0%	**0.9%**[2026]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#25	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	6.7%	**17%**[2026]	+10.4 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#30	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	32%	**16%**[2026]	−16.2 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#16	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	43%	**33%**[2026]	−10.7 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#34	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	167	**173**[2026]	+3.6% ▲	219	−2.7% ▼	#17	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	3.31K	**3.24K**[2026]	−2.3% ▼	749K	+61% ▲	#34	[20]
Active STEM master's students	1.97K	**1.92K**[2026]	−2.2% ▼	393K	+90% ▲	#27	[20]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Active STEM doctoral students	614	**431**[2026]	−30% ▼	158K	+61% ▲	#43	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	14%	**21%**[2026]	+6.6 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#51	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	5.36K[2017]	**5.4K**[2024]	+0.6% ▲	–	–	#22	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$587M[2018]	**$532M**[2024]	−9.4% ▼	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#21	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	6K[2018]	**3.88K**[2024]	−35% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#21	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	1.2%	**1.3%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#19	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.9%	**1.0%**[2024]	+0.2 pp ▲	–	–	#20	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	2.7%	**2.2%**[2024]	−0.5 pp ▼	–	–	#15	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	11.4K	**6.03K**[2025]	−47% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#17	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	11K	**11.2K**[2016]	+2.2% ▲	620K	+0.4% ▲	#18	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	3.11K	**3.38K**[2016]	+8.7% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#19	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	28%	**30%**[2016]	+1.8 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#33	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	36%	**45%**[2016]	+9.8 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#34	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	243	**230**[2016]	−5.3% ▼	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#32	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	45%	**53%**[2016]	+7.8 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#27	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$559M	**$1.02B**[2024]	+82% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#30	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.8%	**0.9%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#30	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	54%	**45%**[2024]	−9.5 pp ▼	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#43	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	2.0%	**3.4%**[2024]	+1.3 pp ▲	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#31	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	0.9%	**1.1%**[2024]	+0.2 pp ▲	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#46	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$13.8M	**$51.4M**[2024]	3.74× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#23	[6]
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$25.7M	**$55M**[2024]	2.14× ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#44	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	6.88K	**9.65K**[2024]	+40% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#31	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$4.22B	**$10.2B**[2024]	2.41× ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#5	[8]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$225M	**$273M[2024]**	+22% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#33	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$2.39B	**$3.84B[2024]**	+61% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#10	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$231M	**$338M[2024]**	+46% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#27	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$648M	**$451M[2025]**	−30% ▼	$45B	+47% ▲	#26	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$915M	**$1.37B[2026]**	+450.9 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#14	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$43K[2020]	**$44K[2022]**	+2.4% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#38	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$56.5K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#3	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$24.9K	**$22.3K[2024]**	−11% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#3	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$66.9K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#23	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$56.3K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#6	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$66.8K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#26	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$86.6K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#25	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	76%	**79%[2024]**	+2.9 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#1	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	61%[2016]	**70%[2024]**	+8.7 pp ▲	41%	+10.8 pp ▲	#1	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$6.95K	**$6.33K[2023]**	−8.9% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#49	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$32.3K	**$44K[2024]**	+36% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#1	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	30%	**19%[2024]**	−10.7 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#50	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$139K[2016]	**$132K[2024]**	−5.2% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#5	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	31%	**37%[2016]**	+6.1 pp ▲	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#22	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	38%	**39%[2016]**	+0.5 pp ▲	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#36	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	29%	**36%[2016]**	+6.9 pp ▲	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#22	[21]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
OPT retention, STEM graduates	16%	**21%**[2016]	+4.8 pp ▲	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#38	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.78	**0.90**[2016]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#24	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	310	**367**[2016]	+18% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#23	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	41%[2016]	**38%**[2019]	−2.9 pp ▼	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#31	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**31%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#34	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	45%[2016]	**26%**[2019]	−19.2 pp ▼	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#32	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**40%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#36	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**42%**[2016]	–	49%	–	#26	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$51.1K[2016]	**$54K**[2019]	+5.6% ▲	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#3	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$67.6K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#16	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$59.8K[2016]	**$70.2K**[2019]	+17% ▲	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#1	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−22.1	**−15.9**[2025]	+6.2 ▲	–	–	#51	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−1.84K	**+163**[2025]	+2,003.0 ▲	–	–	#28	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	8.9%	**7.5%**[2025]	−1.4 pp ▼	–	–	#1	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	11%	**9.1%**[2025]	−2.0 pp ▼	–	–	#1	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	6.11K	**4.43K**[2025]	−27% ▼	–	–	#29	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	8.4%[2016]	**10%**[2024]	+1.7 pp ▲	–	–	#51	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+149[2016]	**+162**[2024]	+12.9 ▲	–	–	#1	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	82%[2016]	**84%**[2022]	+2.0 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#1	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	5.75K	**3.62K**[2025]	−37% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#27	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.5%	**0.4%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#27	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	73%	**61%**[2025]	−11.6 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#31	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$72K	**$112K**[2025]	+55% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#13	[17]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	39%	**17%**[2025]	−22.3 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#29	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	405	**486**[2025]	+20% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#36	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	23%	**26%**[2024]	+2.4 pp ▲	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#35	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	2.9%	**12%**[2024]	+8.8 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#17	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	63%	**63%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#4	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	55%	**43%**[2025]	−12.0 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#27	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$90K	**$97.2K**[2025]	+8.0% ▲	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#17	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	2.98K	**2.89K**[2024]	−2.9% ▼	1.36M	+30% ▲	#39	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.3%	**0.2%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#39	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	1.68K	**1.93K**[2024]	+15% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#39	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#39	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.3%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#35	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.8%	**0.5%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	–	–	#24	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.4%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#31	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.7%	**0.8%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#16	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	586	**471**[2026]	−20% ▼	127K	+14% ▲	#28	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	725	**867**[2026]	+20% ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#30	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.5%	**0.4%**[2026]	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#28	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	7.4%	**3.9%**[2026]	−3.5 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#18	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	13%	**20%**[2026]	+6.5 pp ▲	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#25	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	40%	**40%**[2026]	+0.7 pp ▲	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#15	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	16%	**20%**[2026]	+4.0 pp ▲	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#43	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	43.3K	**55.5K**[2024]	+28% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#40	[12]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
STEM workers as a share of all workers	12%	**14%**[2024]	+2.5 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#1	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	24%	**17%**[2024]	−7.5 pp ▼	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#20	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	35%	**24%**[2024]	−10.9 pp ▼	41%	+2.2 pp ▲	#32	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	14%	**8.2%**[2024]	−6.0 pp ▼	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#19	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	11%	**5.6%**[2024]	−5.4 pp ▼	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#17	[12]
Share of foreign-born STEM workers born in India	10%[2017]	**6.5%**[2024]	−3.8 pp ▼	28%	−1.2 pp ▼	#30	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	14%	**15%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#14	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	20%	**19%**[2025]	−1.6 pp ▼	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#14	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	79.2K	**81.2K**[2025]	+2.4% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#31	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	1.97	**1.74**[2025]	−0.2 ▼	1.00	0.0	#1	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$104K	**$141K**[2025]	+35% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#2	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$117K[2019]	**$137K**[2025]	+17% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#9	[10]
Software developer jobs	5.43K	**6.12K**[2025]	+13% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#34	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$80.2K	**$111K**[2025]	+39% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#1	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	1.1K	**538**[2025]	−51% ▼	135K	−0.6% ▼	#32	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.8%	**0.4%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	–	–	#32	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	16%	**27%**[2025]	+11.5 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#20	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	30%	**27%**[2025]	−3.2 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#11	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	5.3%	**2.0%**[2025]	−3.3 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#11	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	16%	**15%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#6	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

Sources

[1] Institute of International Education. *Open Doors Report on International Educational Exchange: State Fact Sheets.* Editions 2020–2026. New York: Institute of International Education. https://opendoorsdata.org/. Accessed November 2026.

[2] NAFSA: Association of International Educators. *NAFSA International Student Economic Value Tool*. Academic years 2018–19 to 2024–25. Washington, DC: NAFSA. https://www.nafsa.org/isev. Accessed November 2026.

[3] National Center for Education Statistics. *Digest of Education Statistics*. Editions 1995–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/programs/digest/. Accessed November 2026.

[4] National Center for Education Statistics. *Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS)*. Survey files, 1980–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://nces.ed.gov/ipeds/. Accessed November 2026.

[5] National Center for Education Statistics. *National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP)*. NAEP Data Service, 1990–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Education Sciences. https://www.nationsreportcard.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[6] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Higher Education Research and Development Survey*. Data tables, FY2003–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/higher-education-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[7] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Earned Doctorates*. Data tables, 1994–2025. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/earned-doctorates. Accessed November 2026.

[8] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Federal Funds for Research and Development*. Data tables, FY1985–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/federal-funds-research-development. Accessed November 2026.

[9] National Center for Science and Engineering Statistics. *Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates in Science and Engineering*. Data tables, 1994–2024. Alexandria, VA: National Science Foundation. https://ncses.nsf.gov/surveys/graduate-students-postdoctorates-s-e. Accessed November 2026.

[10] U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. *Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics*. State estimates, 1999–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.bls.gov/oes/. Accessed November 2026.

[11] U.S. Census Bureau, Center for Economic Studies. *Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes (PSEO)*. Release R2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://lehd.ces.census.gov/data/pseo_experimental.html. Accessed November 2026.

[12] U.S. Census Bureau. *American Community Survey*. 1-year estimates and Public Use Microdata Sample, 2010–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Commerce. https://data.census.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[13] U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services. *H-1B Employer Data Hub*. Fiscal years 2009–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.uscis.gov/tools/reports-and-studies/h-1b-employer-data-hub. Accessed November 2026.

[14] U.S. Department of Education, Office for Civil Rights. *Civil Rights Data Collection*. School years 1980–81 to 2023–24. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://civilrightsdata.ed.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[15] U.S. Department of Education. *College Scorecard*. Institution and field-of-study data, 1996–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Education. https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data/. Accessed November 2026.

[16] U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Office of Homeland Security Statistics. *Yearbook of Immigration Statistics*. Fiscal years 1996–2024. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://ohss.dhs.gov/topics/immigration/yearbook. Accessed November 2026.

[17] U.S. Department of Labor, Employment and Training Administration, Office of Foreign Labor Certification. *LCA and PERM Disclosure Data*. Fiscal years 2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Labor. https://www.dol.gov/agencies/eta/foreign-labor/performance. Accessed November 2026.

[18] U.S. Department of State, Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs. *BridgeUSA: Exchange Visitor Program Participants by State*. 2015–2025. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of State. https://j1visa.state.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[19] U.S. Department of the Treasury, Bureau of the Fiscal Service. *USAspending.gov*. Award data, FY2008–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of the Treasury. https://www.usaspending.gov/. Accessed November 2026.

[20] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Student and Exchange Visitor Program. *SEVIS by the Numbers: Data Mapping Tool*. Monthly data, 2014–2026. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://studyinthestates.dhs.gov/sevis-data-mapping-tool. Accessed November 2026.

[21] U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement. *Student and Exchange Visitor Information System (SEVIS) Data*. Freedom of Information Act releases, 2008–2016. Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Homeland Security. https://www.ice.gov/foia/library. Accessed November 2026.

[22] U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. *PatentsView*. Annualized patent data, grant years 1976–2025. Alexandria, VA: U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. https://patentsview.org/. Accessed November 2026.